

ACA Marketplace Shoppers (OEP) — Deep Buyer Research

Health Insurance Ecosystem · the individual or family buying marketplace (Obamacare) coverage · Researched 2026-09-25 · refresh due 2027-03-25 · Live page: <https://vincestars-cloud.github.io/campaign-previews/aca-shoppers/research/>

49,777 documents in the shared corpus · 495 buyer documents in this page's voice · 414 ads to this audience of 2,890 read.

TLDR

- Who: 495 first-person marketplace shoppers (r/HealthInsurance, r/Obamacare, r/personalfinance, early-retirement and self-employed YouTube). The voice is thinner than the Medicare page: marketplace buyers post less, and political comments without a personal plan detail are excluded.
- What they fear: getting sick and not being able to pay (16 documents), the premium they will see this year (8), and the income math that decides the subsidy (41 documents manage their income to keep it).
- What changed: the enhanced premium tax credits expired for 2026; CMS reports 23.1M plan selections (down 4.9%) and ~1.5M improper enrollments removed. The complaint ledger is led by premiums that doubled or tripled (25 documents).
- Who sells to them: 414 active Meta ads to ACA shoppers; '\$0 / low-cost coverage' is the leading hook.
- The read for Vince (hypothesis): ACA leads are cheap to generate but the buyer is price-shocked, income-sensitive and wary of enrollment fraud; agents will pay for consented, verified households, not raw \$0-coverage form fills.

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Tab 1 — Fears

Marketplace buyers post fewer first-person fears than Medicare shoppers; the voice gate removes political comments without a personal plan detail, which leaves this tab smaller.

Theme	Documents
Getting sick and not being able to pay	16
The premium they'll see this year	8

Getting sick and not being able to pay · 16 documents

"My premium increased 590%. Is this normal? I understand without the enhanced subsidies we'd be seeing double or triple premiums next year. However, my premium skyrocketed. In 2025, I paid \$80 and my premiums are set to increase to \$552. The lowest option available was \$300 for catastrophic insurance which wouldn't work for me. I had to go with the \$450 option. I put that my income was \$730 biweekly after deductions. My take home pay is \$1200 a month. My friend in Florida makes the same as me and her premium only increased from \$11 to \$50. My coworker in Wisconsin is also getting a similar low cost option. I am so confused why my premium increased so much. Did anyone else in Illinois experience this? Hearing about our premiums doubling or tripling scared me, but this is another level. Edit: also, my parents are helping to pay part of my premiums for now. Otherwise, I'd be out of luck. Even though I'm grateful, it doesn't feel good having to rely on my parents for this. But knowing my health history I could end up in serious trouble if I go uninsured. Update: After a month on the marketplace plan, I was found eligible for Medicaid so it ended up working out at the end. I was worried since I'd been denied for Medicaid in the past. It looks like the increased premiums finally made me eligible."

— r/HealthInsurance · 152 upvotes · None

"The "Medicaid Gap" is a joke. For context, I live in Mississippi. (And honestly that should already tell you everything you need to know.) (And yes, I already posted this but I didn't realized the rant/vent flair would lock the comments. Whoops! So let's try this again) For the past two years, I've been able to get an affordable marketplace plan with Ambetter. It was the first time I was able to get health insurance since I got knocked off my dad's when I turned 26. (I'm now 31) Without this insurance, I wouldn't have been able to get diagnosed with ADHD, get help with my anxiety and depression, treat my Hypothyroidism and Anemia. Like this has been life changing for me. I work for a small business and unfortunately, I didn't make enough money in 2025 to qualify for the tax credit towards insurance premiums like I have the past couple of years. Which means I'm now expected to pay \$650 every single month for health insurance as a single person with no children. I'm absolutely not doing that because that's not something I can afford. And because Mississippi hates poor people (despite us being the poorest state in the country, but yknow whatever I guess), I now fall into the "Medicaid Gap" as if I was ever eligible for Medicaid in the first place. And because of that, it doesn't seem like there's any kind of affordable options. God forbid we expand Medicaid so the poor people can get health care. GOD FORBID. Luckily it seems like I'll at least be able to continue to afford my thyroid medicine and antidepressants still since I was already on the generic. (Ambetter fully covered Generic and GoodRx says between those two, it shouldn't be too much out of pocket.) But now I won't be able to afford my ADHD medicine and my mental health appointments where I also get my antidepressants and it just fucking sucks, man. I just feel so defeated. I was finally taking better care of myself and now it's about to come to a screeching halt. Anyway, thanks for listening to me vent. I know I'm not the only one in this situation. I'm just hoping something changes for us in the future.



— r/HealthInsurance · 138 upvotes · None

"Got Cancer, and Long Time Insurance Dropped Me TLDR: Got cancer, insurance terminated, I don't know what to do. I was diagnosed with cancer in May - Chronic Myeloid Leukemia, which is very treatable with expensive meds, but 100% fatal if not treated. I've had CareFirst Blue Cross Coverage through the VA Marketplace from 2022-present. CareFirst saw my diagnosis, and promptly cancelled my coverage with a technicality. I've been digging through the bureaucracy with no success, and don't know if I have legal options to restore my coverage and resume foregone cancer treatment. On July 1st CareFirst (CF) cancelled my coverage, which I first learned of from my oncologist 23 days after termination was apparently complete. My credit card had a fraudulent charge, so I replaced it in May - but forgot my premium payments were on the card, and my premium payment didn't process in June. 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Finally I unenrolled with my VA State Marketplace and applied to reenroll with my same program. Then they did the first clear and quick response of this whole mess: They immediately denied my reenrollment. This doesn't just mean I lost one insurer- they now made me ineligible for other insurance without a qualifying life event. (I've been employed for 3 years employed with a decent salary by a small non-profit that offers only a health reimbursement, thus the VA Marketplace ACA coverage). I cannot access cancer treatments, and am forgoing care. The list price on the cancer drug I need, at my current pharmacy, is far higher than my salary. I found a discount pharmacy that lowers it to about my salary. I will continue paying some things out of pocket, and skipping others, hoping I survive until I can restart 2026 ACA coverage. CareFirst says they sent me one letter in June, but I never received any such letter. They also acknowledge that their billing department never called, emailed, or made any effort to contact me. They cancelled my care without ever confirming I had any notification. Then they made me run a gauntlet of impenetrable bureaucratic mess through confusion and clear, blatant errors (I don't think their agent confusion was intentional deception - just incompetence). CareFirst found I have an expensive disease, and illegally cancelled my coverage. I am at the end of my rope. I am trying every approach possible to get my coverage and cancer treatment restored. Can anyone advise on my options? I see an option to request a written appeal, but that feels like asking the executioner to reconsider, given that they clearly are not acting in good faith already. I talked with some other insurance providers, and they told me I'd be rejected unless it was a Marketplace (ACA) plan that requires acceptance. I can only imagine a few options: * I vacate my condo and move to Maryland to get a 'qualifying life event'. But for various reasons, that would be really hard to deal with while already fighting cancer and trying to keep up with a demanding job. * I have access to a large press contact list, so I could try emailing my story to ~310 reporters, but I feel like that's more vengeful than productive. And I don't have the mental energy to be fielding a ton of media interviews. * I can also get a lawyer, but I'm not sure how much that would change. I don't want to be fighting this forever, I just want to get my health care and live my life. Any advice, especially ideas specific to Virginia? Edit: corrected 'deductible' to 'premium'. Update: I'm doing well now, no thanks to 'Carefirst' Blue Cross Blue Shield. I paid out of pocket for expensive chemotherapy for little while. I also fought and fought, tried to get a lawyer, and eventually realized they had no chance of ever getting me back onto the plan. Ironically, they tried to keep my premium payment that I sent via overnight cashier's check as soon as I realized there was a gap. But restoring my coverage? They wouldn't dream of it. The only way I could get back on coverage was to get married. That was already in the works, but it accelerated a courthouse elopement before our actual wedding. I'm now on my

spouse's coverage, and I am continuing the medications I need, and am relatively healthy. I also feel more comfortable because if they try to drop again it would need to go through a large employer's HR, so theoretically they can't unilaterally drop me. I don't know if this was convenient incompetence, weaponized incompetence, or just an active, unwritten rule to get drop high cost patients however they can. I just know that CareFirst doesn't care, and the system we have in the US sucks. It's more expensive, less dependable, and more difficult to navigate than any other developed country. Thankfully, I'm no longer one of the people this system is leaving without care, but I'm more convinced than ever that this system is the worst."

— r/HealthInsurance · 119 upvotes · None

The premium they'll see this year · 8 documents

"My premium increased 590%. Is this normal? I understand without the enhanced subsidies we'd be seeing double or triple premiums next year. However, my premium skyrocketed. In 2025, I paid \$80 and my premiums are set to increase to \$552. The lowest option available was \$300 for catastrophic insurance which wouldn't work for me. I had to go with the \$450 option. I put that my income was \$730 biweekly after deductions. My take home pay is \$1200 a month. My friend in Florida makes the same as me and her premium only increased from \$11 to \$50. My coworker in Wisconsin is also getting a similar low cost option. I am so confused why my premium increased so much. Did anyone else in Illinois experience this? Hearing about our premiums doubling or tripling scared me, but this is another level. Edit: also, my parents are helping to pay part of my premiums for now. Otherwise, I'd be out of luck. Even though I'm grateful, it doesn't feel good having to rely on my parents for this. But knowing my health history I could end up in serious trouble if I go uninsured. Update: After a month on the marketplace plan, I was found eligible for Medicaid so it ended up working out at the end. I was worried since I'd been denied for Medicaid in the past. It looks like the increased premiums finally made me eligible."

— r/HealthInsurance · 152 upvotes · None

"Rule of thumb for freelancers: if a client's first question is "what's your rate?", walk away if you can. Years ago I sold cars (don't hate me, please. I lived in the US and needed health insurance). One thing which got hammered into the salespeople again and again is that the customers who paid the most for their cars were the happiest. It's true. In economics you learn that the value of a good is whatever someone is willing to pay for it: if there's no demand, prices are low. If a customer wanted to buy a car and they just focused on the lowest possible price, they were always a pain in the rear. Those customers who *loved* the car were willing to pay more and scored us higher in customer satisfaction surveys. Every. Damn. Time. There was no significant difference in what they purchased other than the happy customers were ones who focused on the value they were getting. So I learned to sell the heck out of the car and ignore the price. Today I've worked for years with a successful consulting firm and every time we have a potential client, when their first question is "what's your best rate?", they turn out to be a lousy client. They're focused on cutting costs, not building value. When their first questions are about what we can build together, it's awesome! They're thinking about their customers, too, and the value they can provide. When their first question is about price: * Cutting costs is more important than providing value * They may have a tight budget and struggle to pay you * They tend to argue more about invoices and features * They know you're the cheapest bidder and they'll treat you like it Unless you're absolutely desperate for money, there is almost no upside to working for clients focusing on price and not value. It's an underpaid grind. **Update:** One comment I should stress more: I mean clients who open with "cost" and don't discuss value. If cost is mixed in with a discussion of value, that's fine. If cost is their opener and what they're focused on, they're almost always a waste of time unless you sell on price instead of value."

— r/freelance · 98 upvotes · None

"Have used a broker to sign up for the last 2 years - why are his prices higher than the ones listed on the healthcare.gov site? TLDR : the copious info is below but 1) worried a broker is trying to up charge me to sign up through him for 2026 insurance (a more expensive plan I wasn't considering from gov site is actually \$50/month cheaper thru him, the cheaper plan I thought I might pick on the gov site is \$30 more a month from the broker) 2) how can I review the answers I put into my gov 2026 application before I got the info from the insurance broker because I can't seem to find a way to review that on healthcare.gov So..... 2 years ago I signed up through a local insurance broker because I was coming off Medicaid and couldn't get the healthcare.gov website to show me what I'd be getting for a subsidy. I assume it wouldn't give me that info till I was determined ineligible by my states dhhs which is a slow process. I even called them and told them to end my coverage through them on the last day of December hoping that would make it so I was able to see my subsidy but it didn't. So I went through this broker and got signed up cheap (\$45) a month on priority. Last year since he had made the process so painless I went through him again but it went up to \$120 a month which hurt a bit but he had said some program had expired making my insurance more expensive for this past year even tho my income only went up a couple thousand dollars. Looking back now I prob should have delved into that huge increase further. I called him again at the end of October and he said to call him back in a week since he didn't have access to the new numbers yet but after seeing all the people shocked by their increases I decided to fill out an application on healthcare.gov just to see what kind of increase I might be in for. My income also went up so I put in a new estimate (which I don't remember what I put) and if I keep my current plan it will go up to \$215. There's also a cheaper plan I could get instead that will likely fulfill my needs for \$159. The insurance broker sent me an email listing 2 plans neither of which is my current one. It lists one for \$208 but the gov site lists the same plan for \$186. The gov site lists another plan I wasn't even considering due to expense for \$239 but from the broker that same plan is \$183. In order to have complete info I wanted to review my gov application because I don't remember exactly what I put for my income info. For the broker I told him \$28k for the year but I either listed \$28k or \$26,600 on my gov application. I was trying to review my application details again but have been clicking round and round on the gov site and it won't let me review those details anywhere as far as I can see. I need to have those details before I can ask this broker what's up with the different prices and make a selection. Low key worried he may be pulling a fast one on me but I thought these brokers didn't charge for their services (that may have been true under Biden but who knows what rule changes Trump may have made allowing for up charging) Phew, any info appreciated 🙏 "

— r/obamacare · 7 upvotes · None

Tab 2 — Hopes & Dreams

Theme	Documents
A plan they can actually use	10
Affordable coverage that lets them be self-employed or retire early	5

A plan they can actually use · 10 documents

"Husband brings home \$5400 a month, health insurance costs \$1300...family of 4. What the hell. It was \$900 a month and I already felt like we were being stretched thin. I am a stay at home mom to two young children, daycare cost more than my paycheck, and I didn't have a career worth staying in. My husband and I both intend on picking up a side gig, probably DoorDash or something, just to get by. But how can we ever get ahead if health insurance keeps rising like crazy? My husbands job does offer health insurance but it's basically the same price with a higher deductible. The plan we are looking at on the Marketplace has a \$0 health deductible and a \$1500 drug deductible, with max OOP of \$19500 for my family. His health insurance as a \$6000 deductible per person, \$12000 for family and the max OOP is the same. So really the biggest question is do we want a lower deductible or lower max OOP, since the premiums are roughly the same...and we think we want the lower deductible. If 96K a year isn't enough for a family of 4 in Ohio now....then the middle class is fuckin dead."

— r/HealthInsurance · 664 upvotes · None

"Former employer canceled COBRA health insurance policy without notifying me I just found out my former employer in the state of Washington canceled my COBRA health insurance policy. Not because they notified me, but because my pharmacy called me and said my policy was no longer valid. WTF COBRA is supposed to be valid for 18-36 months and I am fully paid up. I just had major surgery and have PT scheduled in 4 days that has already been deferred for 2 weeks (because I was at my yearly limit of PT) if I don't make the appointment I may never correctly recover and regain full use of my arm. Apparently, my former employer is getting rid of Aetna and getting a new Health Insurance plan from a different provider. So my Aetna policy terminated at the beginning of 2025. Neither my former employer nor Aetna notified me about this, is that even legal? My COBRA provider told me over the phone that my coverage is supposed to switch to the new policy, but my former employer didn't send them the correct documents and that plan is not active for me so now I am stuck with no Health Insurance in need of immediate healthcare. What are my options? UPDATE: I contacted my former employer, who didn't have a good answer for why I wasn't notified. But did state that they had gotten a new health insurance policy with a different company. They then gave me a plan number and group number and told me to use that info to create an account on the website on the new insurance provider. I attempted to do so and the web form said that wasn't a valid policy and refused to let me create an account. After an additional back and forth with HR from my old company they said to call the new Health Insurance provider. So after 30 minutes of being on hold with them, they told me the policy number I had been given was for a different person who happened to have a different first name, same last name, different birthday and different address. Apparently that incorrect info was given to the HR lady at my company by their insurance vendor. After contacting four different companies, and spending more than an hour on the phone I am still without health insurance while needing PT to recover from a major surgery and unable to renew my prescriptions. For those that said this was a simple issue that I could clear up with a quick call to my former employer, I'm calling you on your BS. It's not, and there is incompetence up and down the chain of everyone involved here. FURTHER CONTEXT: I have accepted an offer for a new job (one with better health insurance) and should be starting at the end of the month. I only need my COBRA health plan for another month to get through all the post surgery PT, maybe get a Flu and COVID shot and get my prescriptions for this month. And however long it takes to get the new health insurance actually functional. As such it doesn't feel worth it to sign up for an ACA plan for less than a month of coverage and then have to deal with the overhead of cancelling that plan and setting up another new one. I just want the COBRA coverage they told me would be available for a whole year to actually work. UPDATE 2: I got a different (supposedly correct) policy number from my former employers HR, tried to use that to create an account on Regence's website and it still failed. I called Regence (was on hold for a whole hour) gave them the new policy number and was told over the phone I am actually in their system and I SHOULD have an active policy. I also read back the group # I had been given by HR and found out that was also incorrect (way to go former employer 0/2). I have no way to verify it's functional other than going to PT tomorrow and seeing if they can bill Regence. UPDATE 3: I filled a complaint with the state insurance commissioner, not just for the recent fiasco but also for the situation that caused me to quit my job in the first place where I believe the company may have actually acted illegally. I don't expect anything to come of it but maybe future me will be pleasantly surprised."

— r/HealthInsurance · 273 upvotes · None

"Got Cancer, and Long Time Insurance Dropped Me TLDR: Got cancer, insurance terminated, I don't know what to do. I was diagnosed with cancer in May - Chronic Myeloid Leukemia, which is very treatable with expensive meds, but 100% fatal if not treated. I've had CareFirst Blue Cross Coverage through the VA Marketplace from 2022-present. CareFirst saw my diagnosis, and promptly cancelled my coverage with a technicality. I've been digging through the bureaucracy with no success, and don't know if I have legal options to restore my coverage and resume foregone cancer treatment. On July 1st CareFirst (CF) cancelled my coverage, which I first learned of from my oncologist 23 days after termination was apparently complete. My credit card had a fraudulent charge, so I replaced it in May - but forgot my premium payments were on the card, and my premium payment didn't process in June. 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spouse's coverage, and I am continuing the medications I need, and am relatively healthy. I also feel more comfortable because if they try to drop again it would need to go through a large employer's HR, so theoretically they can't unilaterally drop me. I don't know if this was convenient incompetence, weaponized incompetence, or just an active, unwritten rule to get drop high cost patients however they can. I just know that CareFirst doesn't care, and the system we have in the US sucks. It's more expensive, less dependable, and more difficult to navigate than any other developed country. Thankfully, I'm no longer one of the people this system is leaving without care, but I'm more convinced than ever that this system is the worst."

— r/HealthInsurance · 119 upvotes · None

Affordable coverage that lets them be self-employed or retire early · 5 documents

"The ACA was not ever intended for early retirement, so the pain of the enhanced subsidies going away is really self inflicted. Having said that I was really hoping the enhanced subsidies would be extended for the current early retirees but also the ACA was my plan. Now I will just think of another way!"

— YouTube · Retiring Before 65? This Is How People Actually Afford Health Insurance · 5 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=lsxxWGpc_fE&lc=UgzNb723lBr-pBKrcyJ4AaABAg

↳ @chrisforker7487 (1): "Or live on less than 85k a year!"

"Unsubsidized Health Insurance Premiums Ramp Up I know I can just change my age on [healthcare.gov](<http://healthcare.gov>) from now until 64 to get this and adjust for inflation, but does anyone know if the unsubsidized health insurance premium "ramp up" rate is available anywhere? I tried to Google it, but couldn't find any information. I'd like to use this information to estimate health insurance premium for the retirement software for scenarios where I continue to work my self-employed job earning way more than the subsidy "cliff" but also being able to contribute more into my retirement accounts, while my husband retires early."

— r/HealthInsurance · 2 upvotes · None

"Another government program that keeps people poor. I know so many people who won't start working full time because it would cost them more in 'benefits' than the increase in hours would gain them. So they just sit there, barely scraping by, sucking off the taxpayer teet for their whole life. I grew up in poverty and the cycle is atrocious. These programs are awful, the ACA is awful, every government program is fraught with fraud. The number of people I know on disability for 'headaches/migraines' and other made up crap is insane. The entire socialist system is godawful. You can try to convince me that I'm wrong, but you won't. I grew up around it and I've seen it my whole life and I decided to get out of that joke of a system. Now I just pay like 40% of my income to support the BS system. I was self employed when the ACA came out and my premium more than tripled. The only positive to the ACA is pre-existing conditions, which could be a standalone law. The health insurance companies benefited, not the people. Even if I do retire early, hell if I want hardworking taxpayers subsidizing my healthcare when I clearly don't need it."

— YouTube · Retiring Before 65? This Is How People Actually Afford Health Insurance · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=lsxxWGpc_fE&lc=UgyqLrlbAGmgEm0rb14AaABAg

Tab 3 — Relationship Fears

Theme	Documents
Children and dependents on the plan	49

A spouse's job, health or income deciding the coverage	37
Parents or relatives they help with coverage	13

Children and dependents on the plan · 49 documents

"ACA \$1,900 per month on \$5,000 per month income? Is this normal? My husband was laid off last week during the mass tech layoffs. Our insurance was through his company. I own my own business, and net after expenses and taxes \$5,000/month on average. I have variable income. I went onto the ACA marketplace today, entered all of our info, my income, his income zero, our two young children, and I was given a price of \$1,900/month for the cheapest plan with a \$16,000 deductible. How is this affordable on an income of \$5,000? I am not understanding. Should I call? Editing to add that a lot of people responding to my post seem to think I am oblivious to the political situation related to this. Yes, I did write to my representatives weeks ago (but it obviously did nothing because I live in the red state of Kansas. I vote blue and always have because I am a woman who prefers bodily autonomy to the alternative.) I am one person who has zero political power or sway. I am sharing my numbers to see what is happening with others, who are powerless to do anything as well at the federal level to make this better. Just thought I would clarify that for everyone. Also, COBRA for us would be \$3,500/month for a high deductible plan for those who thought this would be a cheaper option."

— r/HealthInsurance · 1,646 upvotes · None

"UHC Denial My son was scheduled to have surgery to correct his pectum excavatum in 2022. His surgeon said he met all the medically required criteria. Two days before the surgery UHC denied the surgery. This was incredibly stressful. Apparently their reasoning was that my 22 year old son had 82% lung capacity based upon th tests due this chronic condition and they only approve patients 80% or less. My son was don't worry mom we'll be ok. He is not angry he was just concerned about me. Later that year my husband lost his job and with it UHC medical insurance. My son(student) and I got coverage through the ACA. The next year with his new insurance ,same doctor he was able to get the surgery. We are blessed. However I still feel traumatized every time I think about the denial from UHC. There are probably lots of other people in the same boat as me. Only a patients doctor should be able to make these life altering decisions not insurance companies."

— r/HealthInsurance · 1,523 upvotes · None

"My daughter is a surg/tech student. The doctor stuck her with a needle during a procedure. My daughter has insurance but not for that hospital. Now she owes \$1800 for getting treated at the hospital where she got stuck. Not sure what to do. My daughter is a surgical tech student. During one of her procedures in February, the doctor accidentally stuck her with a dirty needle. The doctor told her to go down to the triage so she could get the proper care for sticks, which included a blood test (plus a follow-up test 2 weeks later). My daughter has healthcare thru the government (Obamacare, basically). She got a bill from her teaching hospital for her medical care for \$1800. Her insurance is denying it because she isn't covered at the hospital where she works. What should she do? This is such an unusual situation, and I can't find advice anywhere (other than 'call an attorney', which would cost more than the \$1800). Suggestions? (on a good note, the patient was tested for any diseases and came back clean, so no worries on that front)"

— r/HealthInsurance · 929 upvotes · None

A spouse's job, health or income deciding the coverage · 37 documents

"UHC Denial My son was scheduled to have surgery to correct his pectum excavatum in 2022. His surgeon said he met all the medically required criteria. Two days before the surgery UHC denied the surgery. This was incredibly stressful. Apparently their reasoning was that my 22 year old son had 82% lung capacity based upon th tests due this chronic condition and they only approve patients 80% or less. My son was don't worry mom we'll be ok. He is not angry he was just concerned about me. Later that year my husband lost his job and with it UHC medical insurance. My son(student) and I got coverage through the ACA. The next year with his new insurance ,same doctor he was able to get the surgery. We are blessed. However I still feel traumatized every time I think about the denial from UHC. There are probably lots of other people in the same boat as me. Only a patients doctor should be able to make these life altering decisions not insurance companies."

— r/HealthInsurance · 1,523 upvotes · None

"Husband brings home \$5400 a month, health insurance costs \$1300...family of 4. What the hell. It was \$900 a month and I already felt like we were being stretched thin. I am a stay at home mom to two young children, daycare cost more than my paycheck, and I didn't have a career worth staying in. My husband and I both intend on picking up a side gig, probably DoorDash or something, just to get by. But how can we ever get ahead if health insurance keeps rising like crazy? My husbands job does offer health insurance but it's basically the same price with a higher deductible. The plan we are looking at on the Marketplace has a \$0 health deductible and a \$1500 drug deductible, with max OOP of \$19500 for my family. His health insurance as a \$6000 deductible per person, \$12000 for family and the max OOP is the same. So really the biggest question is do we want a lower deductible or lower max OOP, since the premiums are roughly the same...and we think we want the lower deductible. If 96K a year isn't enough for a family of 4 in Ohio now....then the middle class is fuckin dead."

— r/HealthInsurance · 664 upvotes · None

"Just looked at ACA premiums for 2026. There's no way. My husband (28m) and I (26f) are opting to go without health insurance at this time. If by some miracle the federal government decides to extend tax credits in 2026, then we will reconsider, but with the current outlook for premiums we just can't do it. I feel like crying honestly. We both work so hard and make fine money for our age and where we live. But between a mortgage we were forced into entering (long story, had to do with a landlord going bankrupt) and just general expenses, we can't afford even a base insurance plan. The lowest we were eligible for was \$650 a month and a \$20,000 deductible. The math just doesn't work. I see everyone raising alarm bells about going without insurance, having something catastrophic happen, and then going bankrupt. But honestly? Bankruptcy doesn't sound that bad comparatively. We'd go bankrupt with or without health insurance with those deductibles. I'm trying to have a positive outlook here, and I was really banking on being able to get us a catastrophic plan, but even that is not financially feasible for us. I am honestly in disbelief at the way healthcare in this country is handled. I can't even imagine how it is for people who have it so much worse than us."

— r/HealthInsurance · 660 upvotes · None

Parents or relatives they help with coverage · 13 documents

"UHC Denial My son was scheduled to have surgery to correct his pectum excavatum in 2022. His surgeon said he met all the medically required criteria. Two days before the surgery UHC denied the surgery. This was incredibly stressful. Apparently their reasoning was that my 22 year old son had 82% lung capacity based upon th tests due this chronic condition and they only approve patients 80% or less. My son was don't worry mom we'll be ok. He is not angry he was just concerned about me. Later that year my husband lost his job and with it UHC medical insurance. My son(student) and I got coverage through the ACA. The next year with his new insurance ,same doctor he was able to get the surgery. We are blessed. However I still feel traumatized every time I think about the denial from UHC. There are probably lots of other people in the same boat as me. Only a patients doctor should be able to make these life altering decisions not insurance companies."

— r/HealthInsurance · 1,523 upvotes · None

"ACA Subsidies ending Hey all, my mom is losing her insurance at the end of 2025 due to the new bill ending ACA subsidies, raising her monthly payments from \$500 to \$1300 if she loses all the subsidies, which she cannot afford, she can't really afford to lose any of it. Does anyone have any suggestions or weird loopholes on what to do? For some context we are all born in the U.S., we live in Texas, she is in her 50s and is divorced from my father, income less than 62k"

— r/HealthInsurance · 531 upvotes · None

"Former employer canceled COBRA health insurance policy without notifying me I just found out my former employer in the state of Washington canceled my COBRA health insurance policy. Not because they notified me, but because my pharmacy called me and said my policy was no longer valid. WTF COBRA is supposed to be valid for 18-36 months and I am fully paid up. I just had major surgery and have PT scheduled in 4 days that has already been deferred for 2 weeks (because I was at my yearly limit of PT) if I don't make the appointment I may never correctly recover and regain full use of my arm. Apparently, my former employer is getting rid of Aetna and getting a new Health Insurance plan from a different provider. So my Aetna policy terminated at the beginning of 2025. Neither my former employer nor Aetna notified me about this, is that even legal? My COBRA provider told me over the phone that my coverage is supposed to switch to the new policy, but my former employer didn't send them the correct documents and that plan is not active for me so now I am stuck with no Health Insurance in need of immediate healthcare. What are my options? UPDATE: I contacted my former employer, who didn't have a good answer for why I wasn't notified. But did state that they had gotten a new health insurance policy with a different company. They then gave me a plan number and group number and told me to use that info to create an account on the website on the new insurance provider. I attempted to do so and the web form said that wasn't a valid policy and refused to let me create an account. After an additional back and forth with HR from my old company they said to call the new Health Insurance provider. So after 30 minutes of being on hold with them, they told me the policy number I had been given was for a different person who happened to have a different first name, same last name, different birthday and different address. Apparently that incorrect info was given to the HR lady at my company by their insurance vendor. After contacting four different companies, and spending more than an hour on the phone I am still without health insurance while needing PT to recover from a major surgery and unable to renew my prescriptions. For those that said this was a simple issue that I could clear up with a quick call to my former employer, I'm calling you on your BS. It's not, and there is incompetence up and down the chain of everyone involved here. FURTHER CONTEXT: I have accepted an offer for a new job (one with better health insurance) and should be starting at the end of the month. I only need my COBRA health plan for another month to get through all the post surgery PT, maybe get a Flu and COVID shot and get my prescriptions for this month. And however long it takes to get the new health insurance actually functional. As such it doesn't feel worth it to sign up for an ACA plan for less than a month of coverage and then have to deal with the overhead of cancelling that plan and setting up another new one. I just want the COBRA coverage they told me would be available for a whole year to actually work. UPDATE 2: I got a different (supposedly correct) policy number from my former employers HR, tried to use that to create an account on Regence's website and it still failed. I called Regence (was on hold for a whole hour) gave them the new policy number and was told over the phone I am actually in their system and I SHOULD have an active policy. I also read back the group # I had been given by HR and found out that was also incorrect (way to go former employer 0/2). I have no way to verify it's functional other than going to PT tomorrow and seeing if they can bill Regence. UPDATE 3: I filled a complaint with the state insurance commissioner, not just for the recent fiasco but also for the situation that caused me to quit my job in the first place where I believe the company may have actually acted illegally. I don't expect anything to come if it but maybe future me will be pleasantly surprised."

— r/HealthInsurance · 273 upvotes · None

Tab 4 — Relationship Soundbites

Theme	Documents
'Use a broker, it costs nothing'	7
'Watch your income'	6

'Use a broker, it costs nothing' · 7 documents

"Health insurance will cost us almost \$18,000 this year. Please help! My job offers insurance via Aetna and I found out today it's going up again, to almost \$1500/mo for just me, my husband, and my infant. And they already cover 75% of my personal plan, the rest is the family portion. The problem is my husband is self-employed and receives no tax credits or help in the marketplace because a plan is offered through my work. The cheapest crappy plan wouldn't save us all that much, if he were to go get his own plan and leave me and the baby on my work plan. I don't know what to do. That's crippling, it costs more than our mortgage. Should I go down to part time and sacrifice my other job benefits so I'm "no longer eligible" and we can try to get credits/cheaper plan? Do I go without insurance and try to save the money to "cash price" at the doctor? My husband owns a small business so it's not as simple as him just getting another job for the insurance. I have to make a decision in the next two days and I'm so stressed. Location : Georgia, USA Income : \$90,000 UPDATE : if anyone would like an update - we got our health insurance cost down, thankfully. The insurance broker we were working with wasn't as helpful as I expected and told us to mark "no" for tax credits/subsidies. When I did more research (thanks everyone), if it was over 9% of our income, we were eligible for about \$350 credit plus a cheaper plan. When I reached out to the broker to confirm she acted like she didn't realize we'd be eligible 😞 It's only going to cost a little over half what we were looking at after our applications. Moral of the story - do your own research."

— r/HealthInsurance · 165 upvotes · None

"Got Cancer, and Long Time Insurance Dropped Me TLDR: Got cancer, insurance terminated, I don't know what to do. I was diagnosed with cancer in May - Chronic Myeloid Leukemia, which is very treatable with expensive meds, but 100% fatal if not treated. I've had CareFirst Blue Cross Coverage through the VA Marketplace from 2022-present. CareFirst saw my diagnosis, and promptly cancelled my coverage with a technicality. I've been digging through the bureaucracy with no success, and don't know if I have legal options to restore my coverage and resume foregone cancer treatment. On July 1st CareFirst (CF) cancelled my coverage, which I first learned of from my oncologist 23 days after termination was apparently complete. My credit card had a fraudulent charge, so I replaced it in May - but forgot my premium payments were on the card, and my premium payment didn't process in June. I received no notification or calls before the letter from CF dated July 15 (although I didn't open it until later). I overnight mailed a check on July 25, and CareFirst (CF) cashed it July 28th. The VA Marketplace sent a eligibility / reinstatement form on July 24th, which CF told me they would process. The CF agents said it was in processing with the enrollment department. I called a total of 16 times between July 23 and this writing. In the 8th-13th calls to CF agents, they repeated the reenrollment was pending with the enrollment department. In my 14th call, they told me that - actually - I have no enrollment request, and that all of the previous agents were just attaching additional notes on the termination file. All previous agents had made an error, and that I needed to restart with the VA Marketplace. The first 13 calls never even started an appeal or reinstatement request. The CareFirst agent informed me that the only way I can restore coverage is to cancel this and reapply. Finally I unenrolled with my VA State Marketplace and applied to reenroll with my same program. Then they did the first clear and quick response of this whole mess: They immediately denied my reenrollment. This doesn't just mean I lost one insurer- they now made me ineligible for other insurance without a qualifying life event. (I've been employed for 3 years employed with a decent salary by a small non-profit that offers only a health reimbursement, thus the VA Marketplace ACA coverage). I cannot access cancer treatments, and am forgoing care. The list price on the cancer drug I need, at my current pharmacy, is far higher than my salary. I found a discount pharmacy that lowers it to about my salary. I will continue paying some things out of pocket, and skipping others, hoping I survive until I can restart 2026 ACA coverage. CareFirst says they sent me one letter in June, but I never received any such letter. They also acknowledge that their billing department never called, emailed, or made any effort to contact me. They cancelled my care without ever confirming I had any notification. Then they made me run a gauntlet of impenetrable bureaucratic mess through confusion and clear, blatant errors (I don't think their agent confusion was intentional deception - just incompetence). CareFirst found I have an expensive disease, and illegally cancelled my coverage. I am at the end of my rope. I am trying every approach possible to get my coverage and cancer treatment restored. Can anyone advise on my options? I see an option to request a written appeal, but that feels like asking the executioner to reconsider, given that they clearly are not acting in good faith already. I talked with some other insurance providers, and they told me I'd be rejected unless it was a Marketplace (ACA) plan that requires acceptance. I can only imagine a few options: * I vacate my condo and move to Maryland to get a 'qualifying life event'. But for various reasons, that would be really hard to deal with while already fighting cancer and trying to keep up with a demanding job. * I have access to a large press contact list, so I could try emailing my story to ~310 reporters, but I feel like that's more vengeful than productive. And I don't have the mental energy to be fielding a ton of media interviews. * I can also get a lawyer, but I'm not sure how much that would change. I don't want to be fighting this forever, I just want to get my health care and live my life. Any advice, especially ideas specific to Virginia? Edit: corrected 'deductible' to 'premium'. Update: I'm doing well now, no thanks to 'Carefirst' Blue Cross Blue Shield. I paid out of pocket for expensive chemotherapy for little while. I also fought and fought, tried to get a lawyer, and eventually realized they had no chance of ever getting me back onto the plan. Ironically, they tried to keep my premium payment that I sent via overnight cashier's check as soon as I realized there was a gap. But restoring my coverage? They wouldn't dream of it. The only way I could get back on coverage was to get married. That was already in the works, but it accelerated a courthouse elopement before our actual wedding. I'm now on my

spouse's coverage, and I am continuing the medications I need, and am relatively healthy. I also feel more comfortable because if they try to drop again it would need to go through a large employer's HR, so theoretically they can't unilaterally drop me. I don't know if this was convenient incompetence, weaponized incompetence, or just an active, unwritten rule to get drop high cost patients however they can. I just know that CareFirst doesn't care, and the system we have in the US sucks. It's more expensive, less dependable, and more difficult to navigate than any other developed country. Thankfully, I'm no longer one of the people this system is leaving without care, but I'm more convinced than ever that this system is the worst."

— r/HealthInsurance · 119 upvotes · None

"Told it's fraud to have Marketplace and ACA-compliant Employer Insurance at the same time. Is this correct? I'm like a 5 year old when it comes to insurance things. So apologies if this is obvious. I currently have employer-offered health insurance. Per ACA it's considered affordable and it meets the minimum standards. I want to purchase an insurance plan through the Illinois marketplace exchange and have both at the same time. I do not qualify, nor was I trying to get, subsidies, tax credits or discounts. I would be paying whatever is considered full price on the exchange. In trying to get more details from a broker, explaining what I said above, he said that it'd be fraud to have both. A customer service agent through the chat on getcoveredillinois told me that I could only get secondary insurance. That all they offered in the marketplace was primary insurance, and since I had my employer-offered health insurance, and it met the ACA requirements, I could not take on another primary insurance, only secondary. And well they don't offer secondary. Is secondary insurance a different type of insurance? I thought what made it secondary is that I had another plan that was primary, not that it was a specific type of insurance. Is it correct that marketplace insurance plans are primary only? Can I get individual health insurance outside of the marketplace while still having my employer-provided insurance? The enrollment period ends today and have been going back and forth for weeks about this. Thanks!"

— r/HealthInsurance · 28 upvotes · None

'Watch your income' · 6 documents

"Health insurance will cost us almost \$18,000 this year. Please help! My job offers insurance via Aetna and I found out today it's going up again, to almost \$1500/mo for just me, my husband, and my infant. And they already cover 75% of my personal plan, the rest is the family portion. The problem is my husband is self-employed and receives no tax credits or help in the marketplace because a plan is offered through my work. The cheapest crappy plan wouldn't save us all that much, if he were to go get his own plan and leave me and the baby on my work plan. I don't know what to do. That's crippling, it costs more than our mortgage. Should I go down to part time and sacrifice my other job benefits so I'm "no longer eligible" and we can try to get credits/cheaper plan? Do I go without insurance and try to save the money to "cash price" at the doctor? My husband owns a small business so it's not as simple as him just getting another job for the insurance. I have to make a decision in the next two days and I'm so stressed. Location : Georgia, USA Income : \$90,000 UPDATE : if anyone would like an update - we got our health insurance cost down, thankfully. The insurance broker we were working with wasn't as helpful as I expected and told us to mark "no" for tax credits/subsidies. When I did more research (thanks everyone), if it was over 9% of our income, we were eligible for about \$350 credit plus a cheaper plan. When I reached out to the broker to confirm she acted like she didn't realize we'd be eligible 😊 It's only going to cost a little over half what we were looking at after our applications. Moral of the story - do your own research."

— r/HealthInsurance · 165 upvotes · None

"Turning 26, being dropped coverage and can't do State Medicaid I'm turning 26 years old, and I'm being dropped from my parent's health plan. I live in PA and have no income. I'm still in Medical School for 1 more year, and they offer no SHIP/healthcare plans of their own. I qualify for PA State Medicaid, but I will be doing several out of state hospital rotations, and they will not accept that I only have a State Medicaid. What are my options? I went to HealthCare.gov, and as soon as I say I have no income, all they do is redirect me to sign up with State Medicaid?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 44 upvotes · None

"Medi-Cal vs. Covered California / Medi-Cal eligibility I am a working-age California resident. In the first quarter of last year, I left a job voluntarily. Because it was voluntary I did not bother to apply for unemployment. I did not have another job lined up. As I had coverage with Kaiser through my employer, my first call was to them to ask about Cobra. I was pretty quickly transferred to a Kaiser agent who wanted to work through a Covered California application with me. We did that, but at the end of the process they had some technical failure with regard to me verifying my SSN, so they gave up and transferred me to a Covered California agent. I did not quite know how to answer their question about income, because my answer was basically, "I expect to be employed again at some point this year, but it's hard to say when, and so anything I tell you will only be a guesstimate." So the CC agent concluded that since my total 2022 income from the job I just left fell under the limit, and since I did not have any other income, I was eligible for Medi-Cal. This seemed odd to me since my occupation pays fairly well and I did expect to be employed again at some point that year. "Can't I just get subsidies through CC and then pay them back once I'm working again?" I asked. Their answer was that with Medi-Cal, so long as I advise them of any changes to income, I don't actually have to pay anything back. I didn't really expect to use the plan anyway, i.e. I just wanted catastrophic coverage, and so I agreed to do that. So for the past 11 months, I've been on Medi-Cal. I have not used the plan in any way, have not seen a doctor, have not called anyone about anything with the exception of the initial application process. It is time to renew my eligibility, and here is my concern: When I went through the application process last year, they asked about "cash on hand." Now, at the time I did have some money in the bank, but that money was set aside for living expenses like rent and food, which I considered to be priorities that came before health insurance. It felt like the question was more about "disposable cash" and so I reported that no, I did not have cash on hand. Looking back, that was probably the wrong answer. There was zero intent to deceive on my part, however I'm now concerned that I've basically been enrolled in Medi-Cal fraudulently. As it turns out, I am still unemployed. I am very close to being out of cash, am living on credit card advances, and I have a traditional IRA that I will tap into as a last resort. So, unlike last year, I'm pretty sure that I am now legitimately eligible for Medi-Cal. (I don't think my IRA counts as an asset but please correct me if I'm wrong.) Let's say I renew and at some point thereafter I obtain services. Might they do some digging and discover that I did actually have some cash in 2022? My understanding is that if I am eligible for Medi-Cal then I am NOT eligible for CC subsidies, so even though at this point I would feel better about reversing course and getting myself on a CC plan, that may not be financially feasible for me. I would like to have a conversation with someone from Medi-Cal about this, but not sure how wise it would be for me to share what I have shared here. Maybe it would be better to just return my renewal docs and proceed as if I've been eligible all along? Does it even matter since I haven't actually obtained any services? Am I just being paranoid? Apologies for the long-winded post. Just wanted to provide some context so that hopefully someone might have some valuable insight and/or advice. Thanks!"

— r/HealthInsurance · 18 upvotes · None

Tab 5 — Frustrations

Theme	Documents
Insurance companies and the system as a scam	43
Politics deciding their premium	29
Premiums that doubled or tripled	26
Deductibles so high the plan is useless	18

Insurance companies and the system as a scam · 43 documents

"The scariest part... from someone who works at a health insurance company I work at a large health insurance company, and lately all I hear about is the potential end of ACA subsidies, rising premiums, and skyrocketing healthcare costs. But the part no one's talking about? This could become the new normal. When has any industry ever raised prices and then actually brought them back down once people got used to paying more? Even if healthcare costs drop (and that's a big if), what incentive do insurers have to lower premiums when people are already paying the higher rates? It's like gas... people used to complain about \$2.50 a gallon. Now we celebrate it. That's the scary part. Prices rise, we adapt, and eventually we forget what "reasonable" even looked like. Unless wages start catching up, we're all in serious trouble."

— r/HealthInsurance · 2,664 upvotes · None

"UHC Denial My son was scheduled to have surgery to correct his pectum excavatum in 2022. His surgeon said he met all the medically required criteria. Two days before the surgery UHC denied the surgery. This was incredibly stressful. Apparently their reasoning was that my 22 year old son had 82% lung capacity based upon th tests due this chronic condition and they only approve patients 80% or less. My son was don't worry mom we'll be ok. He is not angry he was just concerned about me. Later that year my husband lost his job and with it UHC medical insurance. My son(student) and I got coverage through the ACA. The next year with his new insurance ,same doctor he was able to get the surgery. We are blessed. However I still feel traumatized every time I think about the denial from UHC. There are probably lots of other people in the same boat as me. Only a patients doctor should be able to make these life altering decisions not insurance companies."

— r/HealthInsurance · 1,523 upvotes · None

"Turns out my ACA compliant plan is a phantom/shell company Canceling my family health insurance today- turns out it was a total scam Imperial Health Insurance It turns out the insurance provider I have is essentially a ghost network, a shell plan, a phantom policy. 15,000 deductible. Bought through the official marketplace, supposedly fully 'ACA compliant', a bronze plan. First I discovered the doctors that are listed on our cards do not take our insurance. They said I have to call around and try to convince a doctor for husband and I or a pediatrician to take it. NONE have offered or even entertained this. I cannot take my children to get seen at a pediatrician. They both have ADHD. They had ONE provider listed as a child psychiatrist in their network and it essentially does not exist except on a screen. They have three numbers that all route to a voicemail that never calls back. I looked the doctor up and the practice does not exist. The 'cherry on top'? My son broke his arm and they refused to pay for a dime of it because it turns out there are no emergency providers in my county that take our insurance. WTF?! I asked if there were perhaps some in another county? They said no that would be out of network. WTF again?! The hospital/ER took our insurance card and looked at us like we were trying to pull a fast one or something. Like we were presenting a Monopoly or UNO card perhaps. NO medications are covered, except through a supposed online pharmacy that does not answer phones and has a PO Box for a physical address. Why the HELL was I paying \$600 a month for NOTHING? I feel so STUPID. I feel I have failed my family for making such a stupid decision, but I thought it was the RIGHT thing to do. I could've been saving all that and paying out of pocket for services. I want my money back, can I sue them?! TLDR; it turns out my ACA plan is a complete shell plan, a phantom policy, a ghost network that does NOT exist except to collect premiums. Canceling it TODAY. I WISH our employer covered healthcare. Any advice on how to report these fraudsters? It CAN'T be legal what they are doing. It just can't."

— r/HealthInsurance · 299 upvotes · None

Politics deciding their premium · 29 documents

"My daughter is a surg/tech student. The doctor stuck her with a needle during a procedure. My daughter has insurance but not for that hospital. Now she owes \$1800 for getting treated at the hospital where she got stuck. Not sure what to do. My daughter is a surgical tech student. During one of her procedures in February, the doctor accidentally stuck her with a dirty needle. The doctor told her to go down to the triage so she could get the proper care for sticks, which included a blood test (plus a follow-up test 2 weeks later). My daughter has healthcare thru the government (Obamacare, basically). She got a bill from her teaching hospital for her medical care for \$1800. Her insurance is denying it because she isn't covered at the hospital where she works. What should she do? This is such an unusual situation, and I can't find advice anywhere (other than 'call an attorney', which would cost more than the \$1800). Suggestions? (on a good note, the patient was tested for any diseases and came back clean, so no worries on that front)"

— r/HealthInsurance · 929 upvotes · None

"Girlfriend had \$0 monthly premium; now will be \$890. She doesn't make \$700 a month... We're in Alabama. She has BCBS Blue Standardized Silver EPO. I'm not knowledgeable enough to know why, but I'm assuming her premium shot up because of the ACA subsidy cuts. Apparently she is in the "Medicaid gap"... Not entirely sure what to do except tell her to drop it until we can find a better solution, as much as I hate saying that. We weren't planning on getting married, but I'm beginning to consider it so my employer can get her on family coverage under my policy... Next November..."

— r/HealthInsurance · 780 upvotes · None

"2026 ACA prices are live on Healthcare.gov. Here's our household's official ACA pricing for next year. **Special disclaimer for 2026: Everything in this post assumes that Congress does not extend the COVID subsidy enhancements and that the default ACA subsidy rules return for 2026.** Anyone can now see the 2026 prices and plans in their area with some anonymous data (age/zip/income/etc) in about three minutes at <https://www.healthcare.gov/see-plans/#/>. If you have a local state-run exchange, then you'll be redirected. State exchanges all update on their own schedule, so 2026 prices may or may not be live just yet. For those who may not be familiar with the ACA, below is an actual real-world example of what being on the ACA can be like with the default subsidy systems. The prices below are for a married couple with an average age of 52 and with MAGI under 133% of the Federal Poverty Level (FPL), which qualifies us for the maximum possible amount of ACA subsidies from both the premium tax credit (PTC) subsidy system and cost-sharing reduction (CSR) subsidy system. We have three dependent children as well, one of which will be on our ACA policy, and we live in a non-expansion state, so expansion Medicaid does not apply to us. Keep in mind that the premiums below would be much higher for a couple if they were in their 60s rather than in their 40s/50s like us. Tobacco users can expect to pay up to 50% additional premium on top of the age-rating. If we were both 62, then the unsubsidized Bronze premium below would rise from \$19,140 to \$27,168. Prices also can vary incredibly between states. If we were both 62 and living in West Virginia instead of Texas, then our Bronze premium would rise from \$27,168 to \$49,584. If instead we were living in Minnesota, then our Bronze premium would fall from \$27,168 to \$21,696. I have also included the policy options we would likely take if we were either eligible only for premium subsidies and not also cost-sharing reductions, as well as the plan we would likely take if we were ineligible for any subsidies at all. People who are over 200% FPL should generally avoid Silver plans due to the way states have elected to deal with the loss of federal funding for the cost-sharing reduction subsidy system, so while I have provided the full market price of our Silver plan, please note that almost nobody would want to ever buy that plan at that price as better Bronze and Gold options are available. ____ Our 2026 Silver plan with subsidies and cost-sharing reductions (based purely on MAGI): * \$84 in annual premium * \$0/\$0 deductible (individual/family) * \$0 PCP * \$10 specialist * \$5 urgent care * \$0/\$15 tier1/tier2 scripts * 25% ER coinsurance * \$2,200/\$4,400 MaxOOP (individual/family) ____ Our 2026 Silver plan without subsidies and cost-sharing reductions (full market price): * \$26,892 in annual premium * \$6,000/\$12,000 deductible (individual/family) * \$40 PCP * \$80 specialist * \$60 urgent care * \$20/\$40 tier1/tier2 scripts * 40% ER coinsurance * \$8,900/\$17,800 MaxOOP (individual/family) ____ The 2026 Gold plan we would pick if our MAGI was just above 200% FPL (no meaningful CSRs): * \$2,952 in annual premium * \$2,000/\$4,000 deductible (individual/family) * \$30 PCP * \$60 specialist * \$45 urgent care * \$15/\$30 tier1/tier2 scripts * 25% ER coinsurance * \$8,200/\$16,400 MaxOOP (individual/family) ____ The 2026 HSA-compatible Bronze plan we would pick if we qualified for zero subsidies/CSRs (MAGI above 400% FPL, factoring in max MAGI-reducing HSA contributions) * \$19,140 in annual premium * \$7,500/\$15,000 deductible (individual/family) * \$50 PCP * \$100 specialist * \$75 urgent care * \$25/\$50 tier1/tier2 scripts * 50% ER coinsurance * \$10,000/\$20,000 MaxOOP (individual/family) ____"

— r/obamacare · 571 upvotes · None

Premiums that doubled or tripled · 26 documents

"The scariest part... from someone who works at a health insurance company I work at a large health insurance company, and lately all I hear about is the potential end of ACA subsidies, rising premiums, and skyrocketing healthcare costs. But the part no one's talking about? This could become the new normal. When has any industry ever raised prices and then actually brought them back down once people got used to paying more? Even if healthcare costs drop (and that's a big if), what incentive do insurers have to lower premiums when people are already paying the higher rates? It's like gas... people used to complain about \$2.50 a gallon. Now we celebrate it. That's the scary part. Prices rise, we adapt, and eventually we forget what "reasonable" even looked like. Unless wages start catching up, we're all in serious trouble."

— r/HealthInsurance · 2,664 upvotes · None

"My family's health insurance is set to go from \$170 per month in 2025 to \$1560 in 2026 due to expiring ACA credits. A few clarifying points: - I earn approx \$125k as the sole provider for my family of 4 - I am self employed - This is the cheapest possible plan I could find anywhere - Coverage for this plan is terrible and helps me exactly \$0 with our family's actual health expenses I don't even know how I'm supposed to form thoughts around this. I can barely breathe let alone wrap my mind around this. How the hell am I supposed to survive in this country the way it is now? It seems like the world is actively punishing people who have families, or anyone who is not a multimillionaire. This is just one problem in a cornucopia of financial disasters handed to me as a millennial parent. This is not even mentioning how the new student loan rulings will add hundreds of dollars per month of financial burden, nor how I will forever be priced out of the housing market and am doomed to ever increasing rent month after month, or how food costs have practically doubled for my family over the past 5 years. How bad is it to go without health insurance in the new year? I literally have no idea what else to do..."

— r/HealthInsurance · 776 upvotes · None

"Virginia ACA Rates Posted Today: Share Your Increase In Virginia and rates came up today. Self employed couple 59 & 61. This year our premium was \$1187/month. Same plan next year \$2,109/month. This is more than my mortgage payment and a \$922/month increase brings the total yearly cost to \$50,616. We will have to switch to a high deductible low quality Bronze plan with a \$7,500 deductible EACH with a monthly premium of \$1452/month. This is beyond belief. Continue contacting your elected officials people 🙏 "

— r/obamacare · 584 upvotes · None

Deductibles so high the plan is useless · 18 documents

"Husband brings home \$5400 a month, health insurance costs \$1300...family of 4. What the hell. It was \$900 a month and I already felt like we were being stretched thin. I am a stay at home mom to two young children, daycare cost more than my paycheck, and I didn't have a career worth staying in. My husband and I both intend on picking up a side gig, probably DoorDash or something, just to get by. But how can we ever get ahead if health insurance keeps rising like crazy? My husbands job does offer health insurance but it's basically the same price with a higher deductible. The plan we are looking at on the Marketplace has a \$0 health deductible and a \$1500 drug deductible, with max OOP of \$19500 for my family. His health insurance as a \$6000 deductible per person, \$12000 for family and the max OOP is the same. So really the biggest question is do we want a lower deductible or lower max OOP, since the premiums are roughly the same...and we think we want the lower deductible. If 96K a year isn't enough for a family of 4 in Ohio now....then the middle class is fuckin dead."

— r/HealthInsurance · 664 upvotes · None

"Virginia ACA Rates Posted Today: Share Your Increase In Virginia and rates came up today. Self employed couple 59 & 61. This year our premium was \$1187/month. Same plan next year \$2,109/month. This is more than my mortgage payment and a \$922/month increase brings the total yearly cost to \$50,616. We will have to switch to a high deductible low quality Bronze plan with a \$7,500 deductible EACH with a monthly premium of \$1452/month. This is beyond belief. Continue contacting your elected officials people 🙄"

— r/obamacare · 584 upvotes · None

"My new ACA premiums and deductible - considering just not having health insurance for a few years. So I had a life event last month that required me to get ACA. My monthly premium was \$485 and my deductible was \$7600. Just got an email saying my current health insurance will not be offered next year. Instead my new premium will be about \$560 and my deductible will be about \$11000. Also it seems many of my co-insurance will be higher by about \$70. And I'm not sure what else has changed for the worse. At this point I'm seriously considering not having health insurance for a few years. It seems cheaper to just plan a 3-week trip overseas and get better healthcare for much cheaper. You heard me - better! I just don't want to enable this defunct healthcare system anymore. If I'm in an accident I hope EMTALA saves my broke behind - in both senses of the phrase. I'll pay what I can then declare bankruptcy. If not life threatening, I'll take it overseas. A roundtrip ticket to India costs \$1500, \$1000 if you wait a month or so. That's less than three months premium. Over a year I can save up \$7000 in premiums. Saving up for one year buys me a full check up and a vacation trip. What do you think? Anyone considering the same thing? For those with kids - you have my sympathies."

— r/HealthInsurance · 574 upvotes · None

Tab 6 — Previous Solutions

Theme	Documents
Managing income to keep the subsidy	41
Bronze, silver or gold: picking the tier	37
HealthCare.gov or the state exchange on their own	32
Medicaid, CHIP or going without	32
COBRA or a spouse's employer plan	24
A broker or agent	13

Managing income to keep the subsidy · 41 documents

"ACA \$1,900 per month on \$5,000 per month income? Is this normal? My husband was laid off last week during the mass tech layoffs. Our insurance was through his company. I own my own business, and net after expenses and taxes \$5,000/month on average. I have variable income. I went onto the ACA marketplace today, entered all of our info, my income, his income zero, our two young children, and I was given a price of \$1,900/month for the cheapest plan with a \$16,000 deductible. How is this affordable on an income of \$5,000? I am not understanding. Should I call? Editing to add that a lot of people responding to my post seem to think I am oblivious to the political situation related to this. Yes, I did write to my representatives weeks ago (but it obviously did nothing because I live in the red state of Kansas. I vote blue and always have because I am a woman who prefers bodily autonomy to the alternative.) I am one person who has zero political power or sway. I am sharing my numbers to see what is happening with others, who are powerless to do anything as well at the federal level to make this better. Just thought I would clarify that for everyone. Also, COBRA for us would be \$3,500/month for a high deductible plan for those who thought this would be a cheaper option."

— r/HealthInsurance · 1,646 upvotes · None

"My health insurance just went to \$60,000 a year for a silver PPO Prepare for sticker shock. Just checked the IL exchange today, and my BCBS HDHP went from \$1200 a month after subsidies to \$2925 after subsidies (**the plan cost is 60k per year**) the reasons for this are two-fold 1. Expiration of enhanced subsidies 2. The site allowing junk insurers to claim SLC status (benchmark) with plans no one can use. For my area it is an OSCAR HMO which virtually no hospital system or doctor accepts. OSCAR has a 1 star rating from the BBB and dozens of lawsuits against it for failure to pay claims. so I now have to hunt around for a HMO, and my family will lose its doctors. The PPACA as originally passed prevented insurance premiums from eating up more than a certain percentage of your annual income. At 84k for a family of 4, I would pay 42% of my total income in premium payments so I will lose my doctor(s) at the very least and pay way beyond what the law said I was going to. pretty sure I am seeing why some politicians are saying we should tear up the PPACA altogether, because it clearly isn't working, and made a bad situation worse"

— r/HealthInsurance · 1,000 upvotes · None

"Fuck this country's health insurance I've dislocated both my kneecaps, now they're loose and unstable. I genuinely cannot mentally or emotionally go through that type of pain again. I've been desperately trying to buy health insurance, I missed the united healthcare deadline to enroll for 2025 because I didn't have the fucking money, I don't qualify for medicaid, I have health insurance offered through my job but didn't accept it because the insurance is \$240 (9.02% of my income) at the cheapest, and i'm barely scraping by as it is. But that gives me the kicker of not qualifying for tax credits for healthcare marketplace insurances. I genuinely have not taken my knee braces off for more than 20 minutes in three days, I cry nearly every night because of this shit. I feel like i have no choice or the ones i have are absolute shit. Pay \$300+ in health insurance, pay out of pocket for all healthcare costs and go into medical debt that i can't pay, or wait over six months and just let my knee issues get worse before i can enroll into my jobs health insurance again. I am 20 years old and have done no sports, nothing, absolutely nothing, to cause issues in my knees. And now, i live in constant fucking fear that i will end up screaming on the ground again and apparently can't do shit about it. What in the actual fuck is america"

— r/HealthInsurance · 614 upvotes · None

Bronze, silver or gold: picking the tier · 37 documents

"Virginia ACA Rates Posted Today: Share Your Increase In Virginia and rates came up today. Self employed couple 59 & 61. This year our premium was \$1187/month. Same plan next year \$2,109/month. This is more than my mortgage payment and a \$922/month increase brings the total yearly cost to \$50,616. We will have to switch to a high deductible low quality Bronze plan with a \$7,500 deductible EACH with a monthly premium of \$1452/month. This is beyond belief. Continue contacting your elected officials people 🙄 "

— r/obamacare · 584 upvotes · None

"Someone please explain why I (or anyone) should pay a premium that costs more than the oop max The maths aren't mathing. Someone help me understand what I am missing here. We live in NY. I am a self-employed general contractor. Wife is an attorney and recently left her job to open her own firm so we lost great health insurance through her previous employer. Cobra would cost us around \$7k/ month for 2 healthy adults and our 8yo healthy son. Now we're shopping on the marketplace in what appears to be the worst time in history to be doing so. We make too much for any subsidies, so a silver plan is coming in around \$3k/month. Catastrophic is coming in around \$750/month. After a lot of research I can't understand why I would buy anything other than catastrophic. All ACA plans include the same preventive care at no cost. All ACA plans have the same out of pocket maximum limit. Aside from a catastrophe, we would maybe spend \$1k/ year at most seeking care that isn't covered under ACA preventive care. So why would I pay \$36k/year for a silver plan when I could just buy catastrophic for 1/4 the price and pay out of pocket for everything else, knowing I have the same oop cap as the silver \$36k/year plan?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 577 upvotes · None

"2026 ACA prices are live on Healthcare.gov. Here's our household's official ACA pricing for next year. **Special disclaimer for 2026: Everything in this post assumes that Congress does not extend the COVID subsidy enhancements and that the default ACA subsidy rules return for 2026.** Anyone can now see the 2026 prices and plans in their area with some anonymous data (age/zip/income/etc) in about three minutes at <https://www.healthcare.gov/see-plans/#/>. If you have a local state-run exchange, then you'll be redirected. State exchanges all update on their own schedule, so 2026 prices may or may not be live just yet. For those who may not be familiar with the ACA, below is an actual real-world example of what being on the ACA can be like with the default subsidy systems. The prices below are for a married couple with an average age of 52 and with MAGI under 133% of the Federal Poverty Level (FPL), which qualifies us for the maximum possible amount of ACA subsidies from both the premium tax credit (PTC) subsidy system and cost-sharing reduction (CSR) subsidy system. We have three dependent children as well, one of which will be on our ACA policy, and we live in a non-expansion state, so expansion Medicaid does not apply to us. Keep in mind that the premiums below would be much higher for a couple if they were in their 60s rather than in their 40s/50s like us. Tobacco users can expect to pay up to 50% additional premium on top of the age-rating. If we were both 62, then the unsubsidized Bronze premium below would rise from \$19,140 to \$27,168. Prices also can vary incredibly between states. If we were both 62 and living in West Virginia instead of Texas, then our Bronze premium would rise from \$27,168 to \$49,584. If instead we were living in Minnesota, then our Bronze premium would fall from \$27,168 to \$21,696. I have also included the policy options we would likely take if we were either eligible only for premium subsidies and not also cost-sharing reductions, as well as the plan we would likely take if we were ineligible for any subsidies at all. People who are over 200% FPL should generally avoid Silver plans due to the way states have elected to deal with the loss of federal funding for the cost-sharing reduction subsidy system, so while I have provided the full market price of our Silver plan, please note that almost nobody would want to ever buy that plan at that price as better Bronze and Gold options are available. ____ Our 2026 Silver plan with subsidies and cost-sharing reductions (based purely on MAGI): * \$84 in annual premium * \$0/\$0 deductible (individual/family) * \$0 PCP * \$10 specialist * \$5 urgent care * \$0/\$15 tier1/tier2 scripts * 25% ER coinsurance * \$2,200/\$4,400 MaxOOP (individual/family) ____ Our 2026 Silver plan without subsidies and cost-sharing reductions (full market price): * \$26,892 in annual premium * \$6,000/\$12,000 deductible (individual/family) * \$40 PCP * \$80 specialist * \$60 urgent care * \$20/\$40 tier1/tier2 scripts * 40% ER coinsurance * \$8,900/\$17,800 MaxOOP (individual/family) ____ The 2026 Gold plan we would pick if our MAGI was just above 200% FPL (no meaningful CSRs): * \$2,952 in annual premium * \$2,000/\$4,000 deductible (individual/family) * \$30 PCP * \$60 specialist * \$45 urgent care * \$15/\$30 tier1/tier2 scripts * 25% ER coinsurance * \$8,200/\$16,400 MaxOOP (individual/family) ____ The 2026 HSA-compatible Bronze plan we would pick if we qualified for zero subsidies/CSRs (MAGI above 400% FPL, factoring in max MAGI-reducing HSA contributions) * \$19,140 in annual premium * \$7,500/\$15,000 deductible (individual/family) * \$50 PCP * \$100 specialist * \$75 urgent care * \$25/\$50 tier1/tier2 scripts * 50% ER coinsurance * \$10,000/\$20,000 MaxOOP (individual/family) ____"

— r/obamacare · 571 upvotes · None

HealthCare.gov or the state exchange on their own · 32 documents

"ACA isn't so affordable Long story short, we'll be losing our healthcare come June. My wife has inherited a long list of health issues, and has been hospitalized 5x since January, anywhere from a week to 2 at a time. Essentially she's been hospitalized for 2 of the last 3 months in total. There's no end in sight for this. I make 62,500 a year, and she made 70,000 a year prior to this, providing insurance from her job as well. She'll be down to whatever SSDI is come June, and has made 60% of her normal wages thus far. I estimate our income at about 90k per year after this. My job is for a semi small family company, and our insurance is ok, but asks about pre-existing conditions. I tried marketplace which said if our income was below 108k per year we qualified for discounts! Yeah no. It's at a minimum \$12k per year in premiums, plus \$18k max out of pockets. I don't know about you, but it's a bit difficult paying 30 grand per year on a 90k income BEFORE taxes. And she will absolutely max the out of pocket week one. These stays are ICU stays, we're already in the millions. If you factor out taxes, we're left with about \$70k, giving me 40k for her, myself, and our 1 year old. This sucks. My only other option would be a divorce, and since her only income would be social security she would then qualify for Medicaid, but I guess that takes 2 years after you have a disability."

— r/HealthInsurance · 323 upvotes · None

"Help! Husband lost his job and we can't afford insurance through my employer! UPDATE: It is MUCH less expensive to insure all 3 of us instead of just me and my daughter through the marketplace! I can get insurance for all 3 for closer to 450 a month by adding him on the policy. Who knew? Thank you everyone for your suggestions! My husband lost his job yesterday. Our insurance will end on April 1. We are both 44 and we have a 13 year old daughter. He starts his new job next week BUT his new employer will not offer any benefits assistance. We live in Missouri. I checked with my employer and it will cost 840 a month on our plan. I tried Healthcare.gov and it was going to be 930 for the cheapest plan (for just me and my daughter, my husband is going to go without insurance. We are not eligible for Medicaid. Where can we find affordable insurance?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 159 upvotes · None

"My healthcare.gov insurance went from \$120 a month in 2025 to \$340 in 2026 because I got a \$1/hour raise... what do I do? 27F, entry level job after graduating college, trying to buy a house and start a family. Bit of a rant here... You saw the title. My healthcare.gov insurance went from \$120 a month in 2025 to \$340 in 2026 because I got a \$1/hour raise. I am flabbergasted. I can't afford to pay over \$200/month more for my health insurance because I make an extra \$160/month?!?! In what world does that make sense?! There is a PCP in my area that does not take insurance, but provides most of the services I require for a \$90/month subscription. It's what I want to go with. They suggested I go with a catastrophic health plan in case of car wreck, etc. He said it should be about \$90/month. When I researched catastrophic health plans, the lowest premium is over \$200/month. I can't afford this AND pay rent AND pay car payment AND pay car insurance AND pay all my other bills AND save money for house/ children/ emergencies. It's safe to say I'm panicking. I payed the insurance for January but I couldn't save anything. I can't keep this plan. I'm currently feeling very defeated by a system that seems to be set up to keep the majority down... I'm so tired of this. Where is universal healthcare? What should I do? Where can I find a catastrophic health plan for around \$100 a month?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 137 upvotes · None

Medicaid, CHIP or going without · 32 documents

"Fuck this country's health insurance I've dislocated both my kneecaps, now they're loose and unstable. I genuinely cannot mentally or emotionally go through that type of pain again. I've been desperately trying to buy health insurance, I missed the united healthcare deadline to enroll for 2025 because I didn't have the fucking money, I don't qualify for medicaid, I have health insurance offered through my job but didn't accept it because the insurance is \$240 (9.02% of my income) at the cheapest, and i'm barely scraping by as it is. But that gives me the kicker of not qualifying for tax credits for healthcare marketplace insurances. I genuinely have not taken my knee braces off for more than 20 minutes in three days, I cry nearly every night because of this shit. I feel like i have no choice or the ones i have are absolute shit. Pay \$300+ in health insurance, pay out of pocket for all healthcare costs and go into medical debt that i can't pay, or wait over six months and just let my knee issues get worse before i can enroll into my jobs health insurance again. I am 20 years old and have done no sports, nothing, absolutely nothing, to cause issues in my knees. And now, i live in constant fucking fear that i will end up screaming on the ground again and apparently can't do shit about it. What in the actual fuck is america"

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— r/obamacare · 571 upvotes · None

"Declined my \$10K COBRA plan – how I decided to go uninsured instead I'm 25f in NYC. When I left my previous job in March 2025 to start my own thing, I realized my health insurance premium was over \$10K a year, previously was fully covered by my employer. I decided to decline \$10K COBRA after thinking through this hypothetical scenario: >The Devil tells you there's a 0.5% chance you'll face a life-threatening event this year. If it happens, it could cost \$500K or your life – or both. Would you pay \$10K now just so if that 0.5% hits, you'd only owe \$4K (deductible)? $0.5\% \times \$500,000 - \$10,000 + \$4,000 = \$-3,500$ (P.S. Replace \$500K with whatever major medical cost you'd expect without insurance, and \$10K with your own annual premium. You can probably deduct a few basis points off that 0.5% risk if you're young, eat healthy, and exercise regularly, like me) So well well, I've been uninsured since then. This is how I get by: if you live in the big city, there're urgent cares everywhere. I've self-paid for everything – urgent care (labs, X-ray), annual physical, dental cleaning&exam, OB/GYN, flu shots, prescriptions. My primary care doctor hates insurance, dealing with insurance eats up his patients time, so it was self-paying anyway. I know the risks and I'm certainly not happy about it. But, resonating what others said here previously, I just made the most practical choice I could. We should never accept a system that makes people feel *lucky* to afford treatment for a life-threatening condition... hallelujah"

— r/HealthInsurance · 357 upvotes · None

COBRA or a spouse's employer plan · 24 documents

"Declined my \$10K COBRA plan – how I decided to go uninsured instead I'm 25f in NYC. When I left my previous job in March 2025 to start my own thing, I realized my health insurance premium was over \$10K a year, previously was fully covered by my employer. I decided to decline \$10K COBRA after thinking through this hypothetical scenario: >The Devil tells you there's a 0.5% chance you'll face a life-threatening event this year. If it happens, it could cost \$500K or your life – or both. Would you pay \$10K now just so if that 0.5% hits, you'd only owe \$4K (deductible)? $0.5\% \times \$500,000 - \$10,000 + \$4,000 = \$-3,500$ (P.S. Replace \$500K with whatever major medical cost you'd expect without insurance, and \$10K with your own annual premium. You can probably deduct a few basis points off that 0.5% risk if you're young, eat healthy, and exercise regularly, like me) So well well, I've been uninsured since then. This is how I get by: if you live in the big city, there're urgent cares everywhere. I've self-paid for everything – urgent care (labs, X-ray), annual physical, dental cleaning&exam, OB/GYN, flu shots, prescriptions. My primary care doctor hates insurance, dealing with insurance eats up his patients time, so it was self-paying anyway. I know the risks and I'm certainly not happy about it. But, resonating what others said here previously, I just made the most practical choice I could. We should never accept a system that makes people feel *lucky* to afford treatment for a life-threatening condition... hallelujah"

— r/HealthInsurance · 357 upvotes · None

"Former employer canceled COBRA health insurance policy without notifying me I just found out my former employer in the state of Washington canceled my COBRA health insurance policy. Not because they notified me, but because my pharmacy called me and said my policy was no longer valid. WTF COBRA is supposed to be valid for 18-36 months and I am fully paid up. I just had major surgery and have PT scheduled in 4 days that has already been deferred for 2 weeks (because I was at my yearly limit of PT) if I don't make the appointment I may never correctly recover and regain full use of my arm. Apparently, my former employer is getting rid of Aetna and getting a new Health Insurance plan from a different provider. So my Aetna policy terminated at the beginning of 2025. Neither my former employer nor Aetna notified me about this, is that even legal? My COBRA provider told me over the phone that my coverage is supposed to switch to the new policy, but my former employer didn't send them the correct documents and that plan is not active for me so now I am stuck with no Health Insurance in need of immediate healthcare. What are my options? UPDATE: I contacted my former employer, who didn't have a good answer for why I wasn't notified. But did state that they had gotten a new health insurance policy with a different company. They then gave me a plan number and group number and told me to use that info to create an account on the website on the new insurance provider. I attempted to do so and the web form said that wasn't a valid policy and refused to let me create an account. After an additional back and forth with HR from my old company they said to call the new Health Insurance provider. So after 30 minutes of being on hold with them, they told me the policy number I had been given was for a different person who happened to have a different first name, same last name, different birthday and different address. Apparently that incorrect info was given to the HR lady at my company by their insurance vendor. After contacting four different companies, and spending more than an hour on the phone I am still without health insurance while needing PT to recover from a major surgery and unable to renew my prescriptions. For those that said this was a simple issue that I could clear up with a quick call to my former employer, I'm calling you on your BS. It's not, and there is incompetence up and down the chain of everyone involved here. FURTHER CONTEXT: I have accepted an offer for a new job (one with better health insurance) and should be starting at the end of the month. I only need my COBRA health plan for another month to get through all the post surgery PT, maybe get a Flu and COVID shot and get my prescriptions for this month. And however long it takes to get the new health insurance actually functional. As such it doesn't feel worth it to sign up for an ACA plan for less than a month of coverage and then have to deal with the overhead of cancelling that plan and setting up another new one. I just want the COBRA coverage they told me would be available for a whole year to actually work. UPDATE 2: I got a different (supposedly correct) policy number from my former employers HR, tried to use that to create an account on Regence's website and it still failed. I called Regence (was on hold for a whole hour) gave them the new policy number and was told over the phone I am actually in their system and I SHOULD have an active policy. I also read back the group # I had been given by HR and found out that was also incorrect (way to go former employer 0/2). I have no way to verify it's functional other than going to PT tomorrow and seeing if they can bill Regence. UPDATE 3: I filled a complaint with the state insurance commissioner, not just for the recent fiasco but also for the situation that caused me to quit my job in the first place where I believe the company may have actually acted illegally. I don't expect anything to come if it but maybe future me will be pleasantly surprised."

— r/HealthInsurance · 273 upvotes · None

"As a 59 years old retiree, I pay \$2264 per month for COBRA health insurance for me and my wife. I just checked ACA rates for us, it was over \$1000 per month more. I don't qualify for subsidies. Something is wrong with the ACA when its so much more costly without government subsidies."

— YouTube · Retiring Before 65? This Is How People Actually Afford Health Insurance · 29 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=IsxxWGpc_fE&lc=UgznxjuSyfTqcBbN1kp4AaABAg

↳ @beautyandplay (3): "probably better with private plans."

↳ @nata3467 (0): "how much are you and your wife making ?"

↳ @acevers (0): "That's because you were a productive person before retirement. Only bums and disabled people get deals and freebies, and your taxes pay for it. Sucks."

A broker or agent · 13 documents

"Got Cancer, and Long Time Insurance Dropped Me TLDR: Got cancer, insurance terminated, I don't know what to do. I was diagnosed with cancer in May - Chronic Myeloid Leukemia, which is very treatable with expensive meds, but 100% fatal if not treated. I've had CareFirst Blue Cross Coverage through the VA Marketplace from 2022-present. CareFirst saw my diagnosis, and promptly cancelled my coverage with a technicality. I've been digging through the bureaucracy with no success, and don't know if I have legal options to restore my coverage and resume foregone cancer treatment. On July 1st CareFirst (CF) cancelled my coverage, which I first learned of from my oncologist 23 days after termination was apparently complete. My credit card had a fraudulent charge, so I replaced it in May - but forgot my premium payments were on the card, and my premium payment didn't process in June. I received no notification or calls before the letter from CF dated July 15 (although I didn't open it until later). I overnight mailed a check on July 25, and CareFirst (CF) cashed it July 28th. The VA Marketplace sent a eligibility / reinstatement form on July 24th, which CF told me they would process. The CF agents said it was in processing with the enrollment department. I called a total of 16 times between July 23 and this writing. In the 8th-13th calls to CF agents, they repeated the reenrollment was pending with the enrollment department. In my 14th call, they told me that - actually - I have no enrollment request, and that all of the previous agents were just attaching additional notes on the termination file. All previous agents had made an error, and that I needed to restart with the VA Marketplace. The first 13 calls never even started an appeal or reinstatement request. The CareFirst agent informed me that the only way I can restore coverage is to cancel this and reapply. Finally I unenrolled with my VA State Marketplace and applied to reenroll with my same program. Then they did the first clear and quick response of this whole mess: They immediately denied my reenrollment. This doesn't just mean I lost one insurer- they now made me ineligible for other insurance without a qualifying life event. (I've been employed for 3 years employed with a decent salary by a small non-profit that offers only a health reimbursement, thus the VA Marketplace ACA coverage). I cannot access cancer treatments, and am forgoing care. The list price on the cancer drug I need, at my current pharmacy, is far higher than my salary. I found a discount pharmacy that lowers it to about my salary. I will continue paying some things out of pocket, and skipping others, hoping I survive until I can restart 2026 ACA coverage. CareFirst says they sent me one letter in June, but I never received any such letter. They also acknowledge that their billing department never called, emailed, or made any effort to contact me. They cancelled my care without ever confirming I had any notification. Then they made me run a gauntlet of impenetrable bureaucratic mess through confusion and clear, blatant errors (I don't think their agent confusion was intentional deception - just incompetence). CareFirst found I have an expensive disease, and illegally cancelled my coverage. I am at the end of my rope. I am trying every approach possible to get my coverage and cancer treatment restored. Can anyone advise on my options? I see an option to request a written appeal, but that feels like asking the executioner to reconsider, given that they clearly are not acting in good faith already. I talked with some other insurance providers, and they told me I'd be rejected unless it was a Marketplace (ACA) plan that requires acceptance. I can only imagine a few options: * I vacate my condo and move to Maryland to get a 'qualifying life event'. But for various reasons, that would be really hard to deal with while already fighting cancer and trying to keep up with a demanding job. * I have access to a large press contact list, so I could try emailing my story to ~310 reporters, but I feel like that's more vengeful than productive. And I don't have the mental energy to be fielding a ton of media interviews. * I can also get a lawyer, but I'm not sure how much that would change. I don't want to be fighting this forever, I just want to get my health care and live my life. Any advice, especially ideas specific to Virginia? Edit: corrected 'deductible' to 'premium'. Update: I'm doing well now, no thanks to 'Carefirst' Blue Cross Blue Shield. I paid out of pocket for expensive chemotherapy for little while. I also fought and fought, tried to get a lawyer, and eventually realized they had no chance of ever getting me back onto the plan. Ironically, they tried to keep my premium payment that I sent via overnight cashier's check as soon as I realized there was a gap. But restoring my coverage? They wouldn't dream of it. The only way I could get back on coverage was to get married. That was already in the works, but it accelerated a courthouse elopement before our actual wedding. I'm now on my

spouse's coverage, and I am continuing the medications I need, and am relatively healthy. I also feel more comfortable because if they try to drop again it would need to go through a large employer's HR, so theoretically they can't unilaterally drop me. I don't know if this was convenient incompetence, weaponized incompetence, or just an active, unwritten rule to get drop high cost patients however they can. I just know that CareFirst doesn't care, and the system we have in the US sucks. It's more expensive, less dependable, and more difficult to navigate than any other developed country. Thankfully, I'm no longer one of the people this system is leaving without care, but I'm more convinced than ever that this system is the worst."

— r/HealthInsurance · 119 upvotes · None

"Crazy idea - what do you think? Hi, there. Without being too wordy (happy to elaborate if needed), I wanted to ask for input on this idea I have. We make too much money to qualify for ANY subsidies next year (we're not "rich", but we're above the cutoff). Because of this, our health insurance is going to go from \$900 a month for the two of us (already outrageously expensive for the high deductible, bronze plan we have) to \$3,500 PER MONTH. Yes, per month. That comes to \$42,000 per year. And again, that's before paying for any of the actual medical expenses we may incur. I have confirmed this with an insurance agent so it's not just me miscalculating (and yes, I plan to discuss this with the agent as well, but I love the Reddit forums so here I am). I'm thinking there might be something I'm not understanding, but here's my idea - couldn't we just not have health insurance and if something catastrophic comes up (cancer diagnosis, for example), we could move (we have the option to change residency because we do own a home in another state) and then use the special enrollment period to get insurance? I mean, remember - we're talking \$42,000 per year otherwise - and that's before anything even happens. Thanks for your input."

— r/HealthInsurance · 24 upvotes · None

"Health Insurance Carrier strongly recommending that I don't purchase insurance through healthcare.gov I just got off the phone with sales agent of the largest health insurance carrier in my state. I had previously applied through healthcare.gov and confirmed that I was ineligible for any tax credits/subsidies but found a plan I like. I then contact the health insurer directly to see if there was any difference in premiums by applying directly through them. The price is identical but I was told to purchase the plan directly anyway because there could be "miscommunication" between the marketplace exchange and the insurer. That seemed odd to me. As someone who supports the ACA and wants to ensure it lasts and improves, I would like to enroll through healthcare.gov. My thinking is that the program's success is measured in part by the number of users who shop/purchase through healthcare.gov. Is there any real downside to using the marketplace exchange?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 16 upvotes · None

Tab 7 — Solution Soundbites

Theme	Documents
Wishing premiums matched what they can pay	10

Wishing premiums matched what they can pay · 10 documents

"My health insurance just went to \$60,000 a year for a silver PPO Prepare for sticker shock. Just checked the IL exchange today, and my BCBS HDHP went from \$1200 a month after subsidies to \$2925 after subsidies (**the plan cost is 60k per year**) the reasons for this are two-fold 1. Expiration of enhanced subsidies 2. The site allowing junk insurers to claim SLC status (benchmark) with plans no one can use. For my area it is an OSCAR HMO which virtually no hospital system or doctor accepts. OSCAR has a 1 star rating from the BBB and dozens of lawsuits against it for failure to pay claims. so I now have to hunt around for a HMO, and my family will lose its doctors. The PPACA as originally passed prevented insurance premiums from eating up more than a certain percentage of your annual income. At 84k for a family of 4, I would pay 42% of my total income in premium payments so I will lose my doctor(s) at the very least and pay way beyond what the law said I was going to. pretty sure I am seeing why some politicians are saying we should tear up the PPACA altogether, because it clearly isn't working, and made a bad situation worse"

— r/HealthInsurance · 1,000 upvotes · None

"My income should have no relevance to the cost of my health insurance. My premiums exceed \$2000/month and I'm completely healthy. Those commercials of people saying they have a plan for \$53/month infuriates me!! This is back door redistribution of wealth and simply evil."

— YouTube · Health Insurance for Self Employed: Beyond Marketplace Insurance! · 43 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=allOvX_0uhs&lc=Ugwmv_5XeJls_p5gABt4AaABAg

↳ @iHealthBrokers (3): "Brent, have you considered a short term medical plan? If you are completely healthy, you may be able to get a plan with a MUCH lower premium that still meets your needs."

↳ @johnafagerquist8235 (1): "@iHealthBrokers You are the first person explaining health insurance options, that I've seen, who did not say to stay away from short term coverage as though it was an active serial killer. I am 55 (today 😊) and striking out on my own. I want to have health insurance for my wife and my son in college, as we move forward. That's why I'm researching."

↳ @iHealthBrokers (1): "@johnafagerquist8235 Hahaha! Yes, they have improved dramatically in the past few years. People usually have strong opinions because your experience with STM is really based on your needs. i.e. if you want to become pregnant, they are not a great option because they won't cover pregnancy! Feel free to give us a call if you'd like to discuss all of your options as you prepare to make to leap! 888-410-0344. Best of luck with your new business!"

"Health insurance Canceled Me I am seeking urgent legal assistance regarding a serious issue with my health insurance coverage through the Marketplace and Oscar Health. I maintained active health insurance coverage throughout 2025 with Oscar Health and paid all monthly premiums on time without any lapse. In May 2025, I also reported a salary change to the Marketplace, and no issues were identified at that time. On December 31, 2025, I was unexpectedly charged \$529 after already paying my premium. When I contacted the insurance company, I was told this was due to a failure to apply my premium tax credit through HealthCare.gov. I was later informed that this was an error and that my correct monthly premium should have been approximately \$35. I was told the overcharge would be refunded. Shortly after, I had a medically necessary procedure scheduled related to a prior kidney condition and surgery. During that same week, I was informed by the provider that my insurance was inactive. I immediately contacted the insurer and explained the billing error. The following day, I was instructed to pay \$157 to reinstate my coverage, which I did in good faith because I required ongoing medical care. I was told the issue had been resolved. However, shortly thereafter, I began receiving notifications that my claims including hospital care, surgery, and procedures were denied. I was then informed that my coverage for 2025 had been retroactively voided. Additionally, my Form 1095-A has been marked as voided, creating significant tax implications. I have now been dealing with this issue for nearly 30 days. I am receiving medical bills and collection calls stating that I had no insurance coverage for all of 2025, despite having paid premiums me consistently and followed all instructions given to me. At no point did I provide false or misleading information. The issue appears to stem from a subsidy/tax credit error that was acknowledged and supposedly corrected. Despite this, my coverage has been retroactively terminated, and I am now facing substantial financial and medical consequences. They are saying I didn't have coverage on 2025. Speaking with market place and Oscar they don't know the answers...."

— r/HealthInsurance · 19 upvotes · None

Tab 8 — Desired Outcomes

Theme	Documents
Care that worked when it mattered	25
Covered and affordable for the year	13
Free to work for themselves or retire early	5

Care that worked when it mattered · 25 documents

"2026 ACA prices are live on Healthcare.gov. Here's our household's official ACA pricing for next year. **Special disclaimer for 2026: Everything in this post assumes that Congress does not extend the COVID subsidy enhancements and that the default ACA subsidy rules return for 2026.** Anyone can now see the 2026 prices and plans in their area with some anonymous data (age/zip/income/etc) in about three minutes at <https://www.healthcare.gov/see-plans/#/>. If you have a local state-run exchange, then you'll be redirected. State exchanges all update on their own schedule, so 2026 prices may or may not be live just yet. For those who may not be familiar with the ACA, below is an actual real-world example of what being on the ACA can be like with the default subsidy systems. The prices below are for a married couple with an average age of 52 and with MAGI under 133% of the Federal Poverty Level (FPL), which qualifies us for the maximum possible amount of ACA subsidies from both the premium tax credit (PTC) subsidy system and cost-sharing reduction (CSR) subsidy system. We have three dependent children as well, one of which will be on our ACA policy, and we live in a non-expansion state, so expansion Medicaid does not apply to us. Keep in mind that the premiums below would be much higher for a couple if they were in their 60s rather than in their 40s/50s like us. Tobacco users can expect to pay up to 50% additional premium on top of the age-rating. If we were both 62, then the unsubsidized Bronze premium below would rise from \$19,140 to \$27,168. Prices also can vary incredibly between states. If we were both 62 and living in West Virginia instead of Texas, then our Bronze premium would rise from \$27,168 to \$49,584. If instead we were living in Minnesota, then our Bronze premium would fall from \$27,168 to \$21,696. I have also included the policy options we would likely take if we were either eligible only for premium subsidies and not also cost-sharing reductions, as well as the plan we would likely take if we were ineligible for any subsidies at all. People who are over 200% FPL should generally avoid Silver plans due to the way states have elected to deal with the loss of federal funding for the cost-sharing reduction subsidy system, so while I have provided the full market price of our Silver plan, please note that almost nobody would want to ever buy that plan at that price as better Bronze and Gold options are available. ____ Our 2026 Silver plan with subsidies and cost-sharing reductions (based purely on MAGI): * \$84 in annual premium * \$0/\$0 deductible (individual/family) * \$0 PCP * \$10 specialist * \$5 urgent care * \$0/\$15 tier1/tier2 scripts * 25% ER coinsurance * \$2,200/\$4,400 MaxOOP (individual/family) ____ Our 2026 Silver plan without subsidies and cost-sharing reductions (full market price): * \$26,892 in annual premium * \$6,000/\$12,000 deductible (individual/family) * \$40 PCP * \$80 specialist * \$60 urgent care * \$20/\$40 tier1/tier2 scripts * 40% ER coinsurance * \$8,900/\$17,800 MaxOOP (individual/family) ____ The 2026 Gold plan we would pick if our MAGI was just above 200% FPL (no meaningful CSRs): * \$2,952 in annual premium * \$2,000/\$4,000 deductible (individual/family) * \$30 PCP * \$60 specialist * \$45 urgent care * \$15/\$30 tier1/tier2 scripts * 25% ER coinsurance * \$8,200/\$16,400 MaxOOP (individual/family) ____ The 2026 HSA-compatible Bronze plan we would pick if we qualified for zero subsidies/CSRs (MAGI above 400% FPL, factoring in max MAGI-reducing HSA contributions) * \$19,140 in annual premium * \$7,500/\$15,000 deductible (individual/family) * \$50 PCP * \$100 specialist * \$75 urgent care * \$25/\$50 tier1/tier2 scripts * 50% ER coinsurance * \$10,000/\$20,000 MaxOOP (individual/family) ____"

— r/obamacare · 571 upvotes · None

"Former employer canceled COBRA health insurance policy without notifying me I just found out my former employer in the state of Washington canceled my COBRA health insurance policy. Not because they notified me, but because my pharmacy called me and said my policy was no longer valid. WTF COBRA is supposed to be valid for 18-36 months and I am fully paid up. I just had major surgery and have PT scheduled in 4 days that has already been deferred for 2 weeks (because I was at my yearly limit of PT) if I don't make the appointment I may never correctly recover and regain full use of my arm. Apparently, my former employer is getting rid of Aetna and getting a new Health Insurance plan from a different provider. So my Aetna policy terminated at the beginning of 2025. Neither my former employer nor Aetna notified me about this, is that even legal? My COBRA provider told me over the phone that my coverage is supposed to switch to the new policy, but my former employer didn't send them the correct documents and that plan is not active for me so now I am stuck with no Health Insurance in need of immediate healthcare. What are my options? UPDATE: I contacted my former employer, who didn't have a good answer for why I wasn't notified. But did state that they had gotten a new health insurance policy with a different company. They then gave me a plan number and group number and told me to use that info to create an account on the website on the new insurance provider. I attempted to do so and the web form said that wasn't a valid policy and refused to let me create an account. After an additional back and forth with HR from my old company they said to call the new Health Insurance provider. So after 30 minutes of being on hold with them, they told me the policy number I had been given was for a different person who happened to have a different first name, same last name, different birthday and different address. Apparently that incorrect info was given to the HR lady at my company by their insurance vendor. After contacting four different companies, and spending more than an hour on the phone I am still without health insurance while needing PT to recover from a major surgery and unable to renew my prescriptions. For those that said this was a simple issue that I could clear up with a quick call to my former employer, I'm calling you on your BS. It's not, and there is incompetence up and down the chain of everyone involved here. FURTHER CONTEXT: I have accepted an offer for a new job (one with better health insurance) and should be starting at the end of the month. I only need my COBRA health plan for another month to get through all the post surgery PT, maybe get a Flu and COVID shot and get my prescriptions for this month. And however long it takes to get the new health insurance actually functional. As such it doesn't feel worth it to sign up for an ACA plan for less than a month of coverage and then have to deal with the overhead of cancelling that plan and setting up another new one. I just want the COBRA coverage they told me would be available for a whole year to actually work. UPDATE 2: I got a different (supposedly correct) policy number from my former employers HR, tried to use that to create an account on Regence's website and it still failed. I called Regence (was on hold for a whole hour) gave them the new policy number and was told over the phone I am actually in their system and I SHOULD have an active policy. I also read back the group # I had been given by HR and found out that was also incorrect (way to go former employer 0/2). I have no way to verify it's functional other than going to PT tomorrow and seeing if they can bill Regence. UPDATE 3: I filled a complaint with the state insurance commissioner, not just for the recent fiasco but also for the situation that caused me to quit my job in the first place where I believe the company may have actually acted illegally. I don't expect anything to come of it but maybe future me will be pleasantly surprised."

— r/HealthInsurance · 273 upvotes · None

"Health Insurance 101 - Start here! Hi All! We've put together the following wiki as an attempt to help out with general questions as we approach open enrollment. Topics: * What is the ACA * What is Open Enrollment? * Why Do We Have Open Enrollment? * Why Do You Need Health Insurance * What is the marketplace? * Who is in my household? * What is the APTC And who is eligible? * What is FPL? * FPL and the APTC * How do I know if my state expanded medicaid? * What happens if I don't enroll in health insurance? * What about the tax penalty? * Let's talk about plan structures * What is a Deductible? * Coinsurance? * Copayment * Out of Pocket Maximum * How to pay for your deductible * Short Term Health Plans

What is the ACA? The comprehensive health care reform law enacted in March 2010 (sometimes known as ACA, PPACA, or "Obamacare"). The law has 3 primary goals: 1) Make affordable health insurance available to more people. The law provides consumers with subsidies ("premium tax credits") that lower costs for households with incomes between 100% and 400% of the federal poverty level. 2) Expand the Medicaid program to cover all adults with income below 138% of the federal poverty level. (Not all states have expanded their Medicaid programs.) 3) Support innovative medical care delivery methods designed to lower the costs of health care generally. With regard to your employer, if your employer has over 50 employees, they are required to provide you compliant insurance that meets Minimum Essential Coverage and Minimum Value standards. Your employer also must subsidize at least 50% of the premium to enroll the employees.

What is Open Enrollment? <https://www.healthcare.gov/quick-guide/dates-and-deadlines> <https://www.healthcare.gov/glossary/open-enrollment-period/> The yearly period when people can enroll in a health insurance plan. Open Enrollment for 2021 runs from November 1 through December 15, 2020. Insurance plans elected during Open Enrollment will start as early as Jan 1, 2021. Outside the Open Enrollment Period, you generally can enroll in a health insurance plan only if you qualify for a Special Enrollment Period. You're eligible if you have certain life events, like getting married, having a baby, or losing other health coverage. The follow states have permanently adopted expanded enrollment periods: California: November 1 to January 31 Colorado: November 1 to January 15 District of Columbia: November 1 to January 31 Massachusetts: November 1, 2020 to January 23, 2021. Minnesota: November 1 to December 22, 2020. New Jersey: November 1, 2020 to January 31, 2021. New York: November 1, 2020 to January 31, 2021. Nevada: November 1, 2020, to January 15, 2021. Pennsylvania: November 1, 2020, to January 15, 2021 Rhode Island: November 1, 2020 to January 23, 2021. Washington: November 1, 2020, to January 15, 2021.

Why do we have Open Enrollment (OE)? OE is designed for anyone eligible to purchase on the marketplace to make their elections for 2021. With the introduction of the ACA legislation, you cannot buy insurance whenever you want – this prevents people from enrolling only when they know they need the health insurance, which drives up prices for everyone.

Why do you need health insurance? Medical costs are the leading cause for bankruptcy in the US, and everyone is always healthy until they are not. By enrolling in an ACA compliant healthcare plan, you receive the benefits of a provider network, contracted negotiated rates on services, an out of pocket max which caps your personal spending each year, and other state/federal protections on your healthcare experience.

What is the marketplace and who can use it? Any US citizen or qualifying immigration status (<https://www.healthcare.gov/immigrants/immigration-status/>) may purchase off of the marketplace, even if you have employer insurance.

Who is in my Household? Household = you, spouse, tax dependents. It is not necessarily who you physically live with.

What is the APTC and who is eligible? The APTC stands for Advanced Premium Tax Credit and is a subsidy provided to people with incomes between 100 – 400% FPL if your state has not expanded Medicaid or 138 – 400% FPL if your state has expanded Medicaid. You are eligible for the APTC if your income falls in this range and you have no employer insurance available. If you are Medicaid eligible, you should apply there as you will not qualify for the APTC; however, you are welcome to purchase a full price marketplace plan instead if you prefer.

What is FPL? A measure of income issued every year by the Department of Health and Human Services (HHS). Federal poverty levels are used to determine your eligibility for certain programs and benefits, including savings on Marketplace health insurance, and Medicaid and CHIP coverage. The 2020 federal poverty level (FPL) income numbers below are used to calculate eligibility for Medicaid and the Children's Health Insurance

Program (CHIP). Household Size 100% 138% 250% 400% Income: \$12,760 \$17,609 \$31,900 \$51,040
 \$17,240 \$23,792 \$43,100 \$68,960 \$21,720 \$29,974 \$54,300 \$86,880
 \$26,200 \$36,156 \$65,500 \$104,800 \$30,680 \$42,339 \$76,700 \$122,720
 \$35,160 \$48,521 \$87,900 \$140,640 **FPL and the APTC:** Income between 100% and 400% FPL: If your income is in this range, in all states you qualify for premium tax credits that lower your monthly premium for a Marketplace health insurance plan. Income below 138% FPL: If your income is below 138% FPL and your state has expanded Medicaid coverage, you qualify for Medicaid based only on your income. Income below 100% FPL: If your income falls below 100% FPL, you probably won't qualify for savings on a Marketplace health insurance plan or for income-based Medicaid. "Income" above refers to "modified adjusted gross income" (MAGI). For most people, it's the same or very similar to "adjusted gross income" (AGI). MAGI isn't a number on your tax return. If your income is between 100%/138% to 250%, you may qualify for additional Cost Saving Reduction credits if you enroll in a Silver Tier plan. **How do I know if my state expanded medicaid?** To date, 39 states (including DC) have adopted the Medicaid expansion and 12 states have not adopted the expansion. The following states have not adopted a Medicaid expansion: Wyoming, South Dakota, Wisconsin, Kansas, Texas, Tennessee, North Carolina, South Carolina, Georgia, Alabama, Missouri, Florida. *Special notes:* Wisconsin: Although Wisconsin has not expanded Medicaid under the guidelines laid out in the Affordable Care Act (ACA), the state's Medicaid program (which is called BadgerCare) does cover all legally present residents with incomes under the poverty level. Wisconsin is the only non-Medicaid-expansion state that does not have a coverage gap; all low-income residents either have access to Medicaid or subsidies to help them purchase private coverage in the exchange. Missouri: Missouri voters approved a ballot measure on August 4, 2020 which adds Medicaid expansion to the state's constitution. The amendment requires the state to submit all SPAs necessary to implement expansion to CMS no later than March 1, 2021 and for expansion coverage to begin July 1, 2021. Language in the amendment prohibits the imposition of any additional burdens or restrictions on eligibility or enrollment for the expansion population. Oklahoma: Oklahoma voters approved a ballot measure on June 30, 2020 which adds Medicaid expansion to the state's Constitution. The amendment requires the Oklahoma Health Care Authority to submit a SPA and other necessary documents to CMS within 90 days of the ballot measure's approval, and for expansion coverage to begin no later than July 1, 2021. Language in the approved measure prohibits the imposition of any additional burdens or restrictions on eligibility or enrollment for the expansion population. **What happens if I don't enroll in a plan during open enrollment?** If you don't enroll in an ACA-compliant health insurance plan by the end of open enrollment (December 15 in most states), your buying options will likely be very limited for the coming year. Open enrollment won't come around again until November 2021, with coverage effective the first of the following year. But depending on the circumstances, you might still be able to get coverage after open enrollment ends: * Medicaid and CHIP enrollment are available year-round for those who qualify. * Native Americans can enroll year-round * Special enrollment period if you have a qualifying event **What about the tax penalty?** There is no federal government penalty for being uninsured in 2021. People who are uninsured will not face a penalty, unless they're in a state that has its own individual mandate and a penalty for non-compliance. Four states and DC impose tax penalties for not having h"

— r/HealthInsurance · 269 upvotes · None

Covered and affordable for the year · 13 documents

"2026 ACA prices are live on Healthcare.gov. Here's our household's official ACA pricing for next year. **Special disclaimer for 2026: Everything in this post assumes that Congress does not extend the COVID subsidy enhancements and that the default ACA subsidy rules return for 2026.** Anyone can now see the 2026 prices and plans in their area with some anonymous data (age/zip/income/etc) in about three minutes at <https://www.healthcare.gov/see-plans/#/>. If you have a local state-run exchange, then you'll be redirected. State exchanges all update on their own schedule, so 2026 prices may or may not be live just yet. For those who may not be familiar with the ACA, below is an actual real-world example of what being on the ACA can be like with the default subsidy systems. The prices below are for a married couple with an average age of 52 and with MAGI under 133% of the Federal Poverty Level (FPL), which qualifies us for the maximum possible amount of ACA subsidies from both the premium tax credit (PTC) subsidy system and cost-sharing reduction (CSR) subsidy system. We have three dependent children as well, one of which will be on our ACA policy, and we live in a non-expansion state, so expansion Medicaid does not apply to us. Keep in mind that the premiums below would be much higher for a couple if they were in their 60s rather than in their 40s/50s like us. Tobacco users can expect to pay up to 50% additional premium on top of the age-rating. If we were both 62, then the unsubsidized Bronze premium below would rise from \$19,140 to \$27,168. Prices also can vary incredibly between states. If we were both 62 and living in West Virginia instead of Texas, then our Bronze premium would rise from \$27,168 to \$49,584. If instead we were living in Minnesota, then our Bronze premium would fall from \$27,168 to \$21,696. I have also included the policy options we would likely take if we were either eligible only for premium subsidies and not also cost-sharing reductions, as well as the plan we would likely take if we were ineligible for any subsidies at all. People who are over 200% FPL should generally avoid Silver plans due to the way states have elected to deal with the loss of federal funding for the cost-sharing reduction subsidy system, so while I have provided the full market price of our Silver plan, please note that almost nobody would want to ever buy that plan at that price as better Bronze and Gold options are available. ____ Our 2026 Silver plan with subsidies and cost-sharing reductions (based purely on MAGI): * \$84 in annual premium * \$0/\$0 deductible (individual/family) * \$0 PCP * \$10 specialist * \$5 urgent care * \$0/\$15 tier1/tier2 scripts * 25% ER coinsurance * \$2,200/\$4,400 MaxOOP (individual/family) ____ Our 2026 Silver plan without subsidies and cost-sharing reductions (full market price): * \$26,892 in annual premium * \$6,000/\$12,000 deductible (individual/family) * \$40 PCP * \$80 specialist * \$60 urgent care * \$20/\$40 tier1/tier2 scripts * 40% ER coinsurance * \$8,900/\$17,800 MaxOOP (individual/family) ____ The 2026 Gold plan we would pick if our MAGI was just above 200% FPL (no meaningful CSRs): * \$2,952 in annual premium * \$2,000/\$4,000 deductible (individual/family) * \$30 PCP * \$60 specialist * \$45 urgent care * \$15/\$30 tier1/tier2 scripts * 25% ER coinsurance * \$8,200/\$16,400 MaxOOP (individual/family) ____ The 2026 HSA-compatible Bronze plan we would pick if we qualified for zero subsidies/CSRs (MAGI above 400% FPL, factoring in max MAGI-reducing HSA contributions) * \$19,140 in annual premium * \$7,500/\$15,000 deductible (individual/family) * \$50 PCP * \$100 specialist * \$75 urgent care * \$25/\$50 tier1/tier2 scripts * 50% ER coinsurance * \$10,000/\$20,000 MaxOOP (individual/family) ____"

— r/obamacare · 571 upvotes · None

"Insurance carriers increased rates on ACA plans with based off the expectation of lower enrollment due to the expiring ACA subsidies. If subsidies are put back in, what happens to the now jacked up rates that were already approved by states and sold during open-enrollment? Carriers have increased full cost rates ahead of schedule because they expect a drop in enrollment due to the expiring ACA subsidies. If subsidies are reinstated, what happens to the already inflated rates? Each insurance carrier must get its rate increase approved by the state annually, often months before open enrollment. This year, carriers justified rate hikes primarily by citing: 1. Lower projected enrollment numbers due to expiring ACA subsidies 2. The rising cost of GLP-1 weight loss drugs (even though most ACA marketplace plans don't cover these) I'm re-emphasizing because I fear people will still confuse the question. I am not talking about increases people are seeing based off loss of their personal subsidy, I am talking about the plan's actual cost. Aka, what someone would pay if they didn't receive subsidy. My state approved my insurance company for a 27% increase for 2026. They have again applied that increase disproportionately, increasing the individual plans more than their group plans. My personal non-subsidized cheapest HSA eligible ACA plan went up 40% on just the premium, with increases in the cost-sharing amounts as well. This is about average across my local market. Their group rate plans only went up by single digit amounts. Even if the government reinstates subsidies, I'm not hearing anyone addressing the issue of rate increases that relied on inaccurate enrollment projections. Open enrollment has already begun. Will these companies be forced to rework their approved plans retroactively? Are we going to get refunds? I don't see it happening. If they don't, the insurance companies will profit even more from this political situation. This event has allowed them to quickly raise plan costs beyond their actual expenses. If it's too late for 2026, what's the chances they'll actually lower rates even for 2027?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 229 upvotes · None

"My premium increased 590%. Is this normal? I understand without the enhanced subsidies we'd be seeing double or triple premiums next year. However, my premium skyrocketed. In 2025, I paid \$80 and my premiums are set to increase to \$552. The lowest option available was \$300 for catastrophic insurance which wouldn't work for me. I had to go with the \$450 option. I put that my income was \$730 biweekly after deductions. My take home pay is \$1200 a month. My friend in Florida makes the same as me and her premium only increased from \$11 to \$50. My coworker in Wisconsin is also getting a similar low cost option. I am so confused why my premium increased so much. Did anyone else in Illinois experience this? Hearing about our premiums doubling or tripling scared me, but this is another level. Edit: also, my parents are helping to pay part of my premiums for now. Otherwise, I'd be out of luck. Even though I'm grateful, it doesn't feel good having to rely on my parents for this. But knowing my health history I could end up in serious trouble if I go uninsured. Update: After a month on the marketplace plan, I was found eligible for Medicaid so it ended up working out at the end. I was worried since I'd been denied for Medicaid in the past. It looks like the increased premiums finally made me eligible."

— r/HealthInsurance · 152 upvotes · None

Free to work for themselves or retire early · 5 documents

"Reasons why I love the freelancing hiring process So I just finished my first project and I'm in consideration for three more. This journey started after another round of disappointing job interviews plagued by office politics, nepotism and cheapskates. Say what you will about certain clients freelancing, but at least most are being upfront from the get go. Before freelancing I spent a good portion of the past five years applying to jobs and I believe that process is ultimately broken beyond repair. You won't get anywhere these days unless you have a network, and even if you do have an established network at some corporation, the nephew of the CEO could still get the job over you. Here are a couple of reasons I find freelancing a much better fit for me and my personality:

- * Things move much more quickly and everything is out in the open
- * You know the rate (salary) range!!!!
- * I was pretty aggressive applying to full time jobs and I find it quite easy to find freelancing opportunities that fit my skillset and pays well.
- * You don't have to wait weeks or even months to get hired
- * You don't have to go through skills assessments and personality exams
- * You set your rates and clients honor it
- * Clients don't try re-negotiate or go for a cheaper option like what's happened to me in the job hiring process
- * You generally know where you are in the hiring process and how many people you are competing against. I seem to have to pry this information out of people in the job hiring process and it always changes
- * Freelancing helps you build out your skills and gets you in touch with that missing network
- * If clients like you they will continue to give you work
- * If you don't fit the culture, no big deal you know the contract is temporary
- * You get paid for the work you do, I constantly find projects for a couple of hundred dollars that I would have done at my salary job for free just so that I can "impress the boss," these little projects around the office would not have netted a raise. I was always afraid of contract positions because I wouldn't get benefits, but even that freedom of not having health insurance tied to a corporation is pleasing to me on some level. I'm looking forward to saying sayonara to my dehumanizing and dangerous retail job by the end of the month."

— r/freelance · 68 upvotes · None

"Feel like I've failed I feel like a failure. I've been self employed with a part time job for the past couple years (the part time job is very part time and I love it too much to quit). I've recently hit a very rough point in my life and the lack of health insurance has finally become too much. I'm talking to a recruiting agency about a contract job and then I may have them find me a permanent job. I know it means giving up what I love doing and I feel like I've failed. I've made the mistake of shifting my focus as other people suggested to me. I should have stuck to what I know I can do and do well. I still don't know how I'd handle the lack of health insurance, but it'd be easier to figure out, at least. Anybody else hit a point like this?"

— r/freelance · 65 upvotes · None

"This is a phenomenal video as I quit my job and am going self-employed full time. I was offered COBRA for over \$1,000 a month which seems excessive. I'm 28 years old with no major health issues and live a pretty healthy lifestyle. Do you recommend the DPC + Ancillary? Or the DPC + super high deductible plan + Ancillary? Are DPC and Ancillary tax deductible for the business? Or is it just PPO plans? Ideally I'd like to save as much as possible insurance-wise. Thanks for the fantastic informative video!"

— YouTube · How To Get Better Health Insurance If You're Self Employed I TIPS TO SAVE ON YOUR MEDICAL · 4 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0eQnHCaWhT8&lc=UgziSV3pZsrOnR-oKh4AaABAg>

↳ @7Tcfisher (2): "If you are still in this same situation I specialize in relatively healthy families/individuals as well as self employed/ small business owners as a 28 year old male you should pay no more than \$250 for a low deductible as well as a PPO network because you are a low risk. If you'd like to hear more about options tailored towards your situation to get the best possible rate and most coverage at the same time let me know!"

↳ @VictoriaDorsano (1): "Great questions! If I were in your shoes, I'd either go for DPC + Ancillary (which is a little higher risk, but lower monthly cost), or super high deductible HMO plan + ancillary (lower risk, but higher monthly cost usually). If there's an independent health insurance agent in your area - might be worth consulting with them :) I'm not 100% sure on DPC or ancillary being tax deductible, but since you're going self-employed - you will probably need an accountant anyways - so I'd check in with them on that question. Here's an article from DPC frontier on tax treatment: <https://www.dpcfrontier.com/tax-treatment> For ancillary insurance - this is what I used: <https://natgenhealth.com/individual.php#accident-and-critical-illness> . If you call them, they can advise you if it may be tax deductible as well. Hope this helps!"

↳ @YugiohTube (1): "@VictoriaDorsano This was absolutely fantastic thank you so much. Lastly, have you heard of HSAs and would you recommend I use a HSA with the super high deductible plan? I've heard a lot of good stuff regarding HSAs...again thank you so much for your help. You've definitely got my subscription!"

Tab 9 — Typical Day

Theme	Documents
Working around the coverage	20
Checking the marketplace and doing the math	17

Working around the coverage · 20 documents

"WOW! Looking at my 2026 insurance, its half my rent! I was covered thru work previously, just looked at 2026 for california with parital subsidy and for a single person, my monthly premium is \$1300! (cheapest was \$1100 - up to \$1800) that's half my already very expensive rent! Estimated income of \$80k Its a hit, but i don't know how people affords this! All the people getting new premiums in the mail in 2 weeks are in for a rude awakening as i was"

— r/HealthInsurance · 777 upvotes · None

"What you can do if your marketplace premiums for 2026 are too high I've seen this topic come up in recent weeks and want to offer some advice for folks on marketplace plans with premium hikes. This could also work for folks with employer group plans. I realize that this won't work for everyone in every situation but if you've come to a place where you need to consider alternative ways to approach your healthcare costs, this may be helpful. 1. switch to the least expensive marketplace ACA-compliant bronze-level high deductible HSA-eligible insurance plan to cover only catastrophic events like hospitalization. Use this the way you would use your car insurance: sparingly or not at all. Note that going without insurance is a very, very bad idea for reasons that are covered in this sub on a regular basis. 2. Open and contribute to an HSA to get tax savings on money you'll spend toward medical expenses. 3. SKIP DENTAL AND VISION INSURANCE. Honestly this applies to everyone on marketplace plans but dental and vision "insurance" are just glorified payment plans. They are not regulated the same way as ACA health insurance plans so insurers are allowed to charge premiums on those products that guarantee profit margins > 20%. Instead, work with your favorite local dentist and optometrist to pay directly for all your services, and put the money you would have spent on these premiums into your HSA. 4. If you need care: 4a. If you are someone who needs more than 1-3 office visits a year, shop around for a direct primary care provider in your area. Memberships for these are generally pretty reasonable when you factor in what you might have spent toward premiums on a silver or gold tier marketplace plan. 4b. Google specialty care options. For example, Cove offers a monthly membership for treatment of migraines that, when you add it up, is less expensive than a single trip to the neurologist plus a monthly RX from Walgreens. Companies like this exist for nearly everything. 4c. Become a smart shopper for your rxs. There are so many options outside of traditional insurance that can help you save money: GoodRx, Mark Cuban Cost Plus, LillyDirect, Hers/Hims, Nurx. 4d: Think of memberships you may already have that come with pharmacy or healthcare benefits: Costco is an obvious one but comb through other areas of your life. For example, my electric company is a co-op and offers members a discount program for dental, prescriptions, and gym memberships. 4e. Ask your current providers about direct pay arrangements. If you're paying \$200/month in premiums so that your therapist is in-network, but your therapist will happily take \$150 cash per monthly session, you'll come out \$50/month ahead by paying directly. If anyone has other suggestions, because I'm sure I've missed plenty, add them!"

— r/HealthInsurance · 372 upvotes · None

"Health Insurance 101 - Start here! Hi All! We've put together the following wiki as an attempt to help out with general questions as we approach open enrollment. Topics: * What is the ACA * What is Open Enrollment? * Why Do We Have Open Enrollment? * Why Do You Need Health Insurance * What is the marketplace? * Who is in my household? * What is the APTC And who is eligible? * What is FPL? * FPL and the APTC * How do I know if my state expanded medicaid? * What happens if I don't enroll in health insurance? * What about the tax penalty? * Let's talk about plan structures * What is a Deductible? * Coinsurance? * Copayment * Out of Pocket Maximum * How to pay for your deductible * Short Term Health Plans

What is the ACA? The comprehensive health care reform law enacted in March 2010 (sometimes known as ACA, PPACA, or "Obamacare"). The law has 3 primary goals: 1) Make affordable health insurance available to more people. The law provides consumers with subsidies ("premium tax credits") that lower costs for households with incomes between 100% and 400% of the federal poverty level. 2) Expand the Medicaid program to cover all adults with income below 138% of the federal poverty level. (Not all states have expanded their Medicaid programs.) 3) Support innovative medical care delivery methods designed to lower the costs of health care generally. With regard to your employer, if your employer has over 50 employees, they are required to provide you compliant insurance that meets Minimum Essential Coverage and Minimum Value standards. Your employer also must subsidize at least 50% of the premium to enroll the employees.

What is Open Enrollment? <https://www.healthcare.gov/quick-guide/dates-and-deadlines> <https://www.healthcare.gov/glossary/open-enrollment-period/> The yearly period when people can enroll in a health insurance plan. Open Enrollment for 2021 runs from November 1 through December 15, 2020. Insurance plans elected during Open Enrollment will start as early as Jan 1, 2021. Outside the Open Enrollment Period, you generally can enroll in a health insurance plan only if you qualify for a Special Enrollment Period. You're eligible if you have certain life events, like getting married, having a baby, or losing other health coverage. The follow states have permanently adopted expanded enrollment periods: California: November 1 to January 31 Colorado: November 1 to January 15 District of Columbia: November 1 to January 31 Massachusetts: November 1, 2020 to January 23, 2021. Minnesota: November 1 to December 22, 2020. New Jersey: November 1, 2020 to January 31, 2021. New York: November 1, 2020 to January 31, 2021. Nevada: November 1, 2020, to January 15, 2021. Pennsylvania: November 1, 2020, to January 15, 2021 Rhode Island: November 1, 2020 to January 23, 2021. Washington: November 1, 2020, to January 15, 2021.

Why do we have Open Enrollment (OE)? OE is designed for anyone eligible to purchase on the marketplace to make their elections for 2021. With the introduction of the ACA legislation, you cannot buy insurance whenever you want – this prevents people from enrolling only when they know they need the health insurance, which drives up prices for everyone.

Why do you need health insurance? Medical costs are the leading cause for bankruptcy in the US, and everyone is always healthy until they are not. By enrolling in an ACA compliant healthcare plan, you receive the benefits of a provider network, contracted negotiated rates on services, an out of pocket max which caps your personal spending each year, and other state/federal protections on your healthcare experience.

What is the marketplace and who can use it? Any US citizen or qualifying immigration status (<https://www.healthcare.gov/immigrants/immigration-status/>) may purchase off of the marketplace, even if you have employer insurance.

Who is in my Household? Household = you, spouse, tax dependents. It is not necessarily who you physically live with.

What is the APTC and who is eligible? The APTC stands for Advanced Premium Tax Credit and is a subsidy provided to people with incomes between 100 – 400% FPL if your state has not expanded Medicaid or 138 – 400% FPL if your state has expanded Medicaid. You are eligible for the APTC if your income falls in this range and you have no employer insurance available. If you are Medicaid eligible, you should apply there as you will not qualify for the APTC; however, you are welcome to purchase a full price marketplace plan instead if you prefer.

What is FPL? A measure of income issued every year by the Department of Health and Human Services (HHS). Federal poverty levels are used to determine your eligibility for certain programs and benefits, including savings on Marketplace health insurance, and Medicaid and CHIP coverage. The 2020 federal poverty level (FPL) income numbers below are used to calculate eligibility for Medicaid and the Children's Health Insurance

Program (CHIP). Household Size 100% 138% 250% 400% Income: \$12,760 \$17,609 \$31,900 \$51,040
 \$17,240 \$23,792 \$43,100 \$68,960 \$21,720 \$29,974 \$54,300 \$86,880
 \$26,200 \$36,156 \$65,500 \$104,800 \$30,680 \$42,339 \$76,700 \$122,720
 \$35,160 \$48,521 \$87,900 \$140,640 **FPL and the APTC:** Income between 100% and 400% FPL: If your income is in this range, in all states you qualify for premium tax credits that lower your monthly premium for a Marketplace health insurance plan. Income below 138% FPL: If your income is below 138% FPL and your state has expanded Medicaid coverage, you qualify for Medicaid based only on your income. Income below 100% FPL: If your income falls below 100% FPL, you probably won't qualify for savings on a Marketplace health insurance plan or for income-based Medicaid. "Income" above refers to "modified adjusted gross income" (MAGI). For most people, it's the same or very similar to "adjusted gross income" (AGI). MAGI isn't a number on your tax return. If your income is between 100%/138% to 250%, you may qualify for additional Cost Saving Reduction credits if you enroll in a Silver Tier plan. **How do I know if my state expanded medicaid?** To date, 39 states (including DC) have adopted the Medicaid expansion and 12 states have not adopted the expansion. The following states have not adopted a Medicaid expansion: Wyoming, South Dakota, Wisconsin, Kansas, Texas, Tennessee, North Carolina, South Carolina, Georgia, Alabama, Missouri, Florida. *Special notes:* Wisconsin: Although Wisconsin has not expanded Medicaid under the guidelines laid out in the Affordable Care Act (ACA), the state's Medicaid program (which is called BadgerCare) does cover all legally present residents with incomes under the poverty level. Wisconsin is the only non-Medicaid-expansion state that does not have a coverage gap; all low-income residents either have access to Medicaid or subsidies to help them purchase private coverage in the exchange. Missouri: Missouri voters approved a ballot measure on August 4, 2020 which adds Medicaid expansion to the state's constitution. The amendment requires the state to submit all SPAs necessary to implement expansion to CMS no later than March 1, 2021 and for expansion coverage to begin July 1, 2021. Language in the amendment prohibits the imposition of any additional burdens or restrictions on eligibility or enrollment for the expansion population. Oklahoma: Oklahoma voters approved a ballot measure on June 30, 2020 which adds Medicaid expansion to the state's Constitution. The amendment requires the Oklahoma Health Care Authority to submit a SPA and other necessary documents to CMS within 90 days of the ballot measure's approval, and for expansion coverage to begin no later than July 1, 2021. Language in the approved measure prohibits the imposition of any additional burdens or restrictions on eligibility or enrollment for the expansion population. **What happens if I don't enroll in a plan during open enrollment?** If you don't enroll in an ACA-compliant health insurance plan by the end of open enrollment (December 15 in most states), your buying options will likely be very limited for the coming year. Open enrollment won't come around again until November 2021, with coverage effective the first of the following year. But depending on the circumstances, you might still be able to get coverage after open enrollment ends: * Medicaid and CHIP enrollment are available year-round for those who qualify. * Native Americans can enroll year-round * Special enrollment period if you have a qualifying event **What about the tax penalty?** There is no federal government penalty for being uninsured in 2021. People who are uninsured will not face a penalty, unless they're in a state that has its own individual mandate and a penalty for non-compliance. Four states and DC impose tax penalties for not having h"

— r/HealthInsurance · 269 upvotes · None

Checking the marketplace and doing the math · 17 documents

"ACA \$1,900 per month on \$5,000 per month income? Is this normal? My husband was laid off last week during the mass tech layoffs. Our insurance was through his company. I own my own business, and net after expenses and taxes \$5,000/month on average. I have variable income. I went onto the ACA marketplace today, entered all of our info, my income, his income zero, our two young children, and I was given a price of \$1,900/month for the cheapest plan with a \$16,000 deductible. How is this affordable on an income of \$5,000? I am not understanding. Should I call? Editing to add that a lot of people responding to my post seem to think I am oblivious to the political situation related to this. Yes, I did write to my representatives weeks ago (but it obviously did nothing because I live in the red state of Kansas. I vote blue and always have because I am a woman who prefers bodily autonomy to the alternative.) I am one person who has zero political power or sway. I am sharing my numbers to see what is happening with others, who are powerless to do anything as well at the federal level to make this better. Just thought I would clarify that for everyone. Also, COBRA for us would be \$3,500/month for a high deductible plan for those who thought this would be a cheaper option."

— r/HealthInsurance · 1,646 upvotes · None

"Dropping our ACA plan Today is the day my family is dropping our ACA plan. Our options were to stay on our same plan and be financially strained, or switch to a different plan with an absurdly high deductible. Neither option made sense for us. Luckily, my family is healthy right now. I'm just posting this for solidarity with all the other individuals and families in the same boat. Obviously, not having health insurance comes with a risk, but for us, that risk made more sense than continuing to pay into a broken system. We found a Direct Primary Care (DPC) provider near us, so we know we'll at least have basic, and great care. We are exploring other alternatives as well. Oh, and for those of you who are also exiting the marketplace this year, you must proactively do this or you will be automatically re-enrolled. Happy last day to enroll everyone!"

— r/HealthInsurance · 763 upvotes · None

"Healthcare.gov's Cheapest option is HALF the yearly income?! [Healthcare.gov](<http://Healthcare.gov>) is quoting my partner for their cheapest monthly option being \$605 a MONTH. That comes out to almost half her yearly income. We aren't married yet, so my yearly income isn't factored. There is no way that this is something normal people are paying???"

— r/HealthInsurance · 360 upvotes · None

Tab 10 — Buyer Summary

Who they are (measured)

- 495 first-person documents: self-employed and freelance buyers, early retirees managing income until 65, and families who lost employer coverage or Medicaid.

What they believe

- Read of Tabs 5 and 7: coverage should not depend on a job; premiums and deductibles make the plan hard to use; politics sets their price (the subsidy expiry is named directly).

The moment it changes

- Open enrollment and the renewal notice with the new premium; losing a job, Medicaid or a spouse's coverage; retiring before 65; a medical event.

What stops them

- Price (26 documents).
- Deductibles too high to use the plan (18).
- The income math and repayment risk (41 documents manage income to keep the subsidy).

Where they are and how to reach them

- r/HealthInsurance and r/Obamacare; early-retirement and self-employed finance YouTube; HealthCare.gov and state exchanges (20 documents say they went there themselves).

Segments to write to

- Self-employed and 1099 households priced out after the subsidy change.
- Early retirees 55–64 bridging to Medicare.
- Families who lost employer or Medicaid coverage mid-year.

Segments not to write to

- Medicaid-eligible households (different enrollment path).
- Employer-plan members complaining about their employer coverage (excluded by the voice gate).

The frame that works (hypothesis)

- Hypothesis: 'See your real 2027 price after the subsidy change, with a licensed agent, and nothing enrolled without your say' answers the price shock and the fraud fear at once.

Buyer voices: aca self 495

Headlines

1. "Hearing about our premiums doubling or tripling scared me, but this is another level." — Getting sick and not being able to pay (16) · None
2. "Hearing about our premiums doubling or tripling scared me, but this is another level." — The premium they'll see this year (8) · None
3. "So really the biggest question is do we want a lower deductible or lower max OOP, since the premiums are roughly the same...and we think we want the lower deductible." — A plan they can actually use (10) · None
4. "Having said that I was really hoping the enhanced subsidies would be extended for the current early retirees but also the ACA was my plan." — Affordable coverage that lets them be self-employed or retire early (5) · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=lsxxWGpc_fE&lc=UgzNb723lBr-pBKrcyJ4AaABAg
5. "I went onto the ACA marketplace today, entered all of our info, my income, his income zero, our two young children, and I was given a price of \$1,900/month for the cheapest plan with a \$16,000 deductible." — Children and dependents on the plan (49) · None
6. "Later that year my husband lost his job and with it UHC medical insurance." — A spouse's job, health or income deciding the coverage (37) · None
7. "The insurance broker we were working with wasn't as helpful as I expected and told us to mark "no" for tax credits/subsidies." — 'Use a broker, it costs nothing' (7) · None

8. "The insurance broker we were working with wasn't as helpful as I expected and told us to mark "no" for tax credits/subsidies." — 'Watch your income' (6) · None
9. "The scariest part... from someone who works at a health insurance company" — Insurance companies and the system as a scam (43) · None
10. "My daughter has healthcare thru the government (Obamacare, basically)." — Politics deciding their premium (29) · None
11. "We will have to switch to a high deductible low quality Bronze plan with a \$7,500 deductible EACH with a monthly premium of \$1452/month." — Bronze, silver or gold: picking the tier (37) · None
12. "At 84k for a family of 4, I would pay 42% of my total income in premium payments" — Wishing premiums matched what they can pay (10) · None
13. "I was covered thru work previously, just looked at 2026 for california with parital subsidy and for a single person, my monthly premium is \$1300!" — Working around the coverage (20) · None
14. "I went onto the ACA marketplace today, entered all of our info, my income, his income zero, our two young children, and I was given a price of \$1,900/month for the cheapest plan with a \$16,000 deductible." — Checking the marketplace and doing the math (17) · None

Frequency Ranking

#	Theme	Documents	Where
1	Children and dependents on the plan	49	Tab 3
2	Insurance companies and the system as a scam	43	Tab 5
3	Managing income to keep the subsidy	41	Tab 6
4	A spouse's job, health or income deciding the coverage	37	Tab 3
5	Bronze, silver or gold: picking the tier	37	Tab 6
6	HealthCare.gov or the state exchange on their own	32	Tab 6
7	Medicaid, CHIP or going without	32	Tab 6
8	Going without coverage and hoping nothing happens	32	Private worry
9	Premiums they can't pay (subsidy loss, doubling)	30	Private worry
10	Politics deciding their premium	29	Tab 5
11	Lost the job, COBRA too expensive, early retirement	28	Private worry
12	A plan they can't use: deductibles and networks	27	Private worry
13	Premiums that doubled or tripled	26	Tab 5
14	Care that worked when it mattered	25	Tab 8
15	Premiums they can't pay after the subsidy loss	25	Dislike
16	COBRA or a spouse's employer plan	24	Tab 6
17	Working around the coverage	20	Tab 9
18	HealthCare.gov or the state exchange	20	Lead source
19	Deductibles so high the plan is useless	18	Tab 5
20	Checking the marketplace and doing the math	17	Tab 9
21	Getting sick and not being able to pay	16	Tab 1
22	Deductibles too high to use the plan	16	Dislike
23	Parents or relatives they help with coverage	13	Tab 3
24	A broker or agent	13	Tab 6
25	Covered and affordable for the year	13	Tab 8

26	The carrier directly (Ambetter, Oscar, BCBS...)	11	Lead source
27	A plan they can actually use	10	Tab 2
28	Wishing premiums matched what they can pay	10	Tab 7
29	An agent or broker	10	Lead source
30	Employer / COBRA / spouse's plan	10	Lead source
31	The premium they'll see this year	8	Tab 1
32	Paying the subsidy back at tax time	8	Private worry
33	Medicaid / CHIP	8	Lead source
34	Owing money back at tax time	8	Dislike
35	'Use a broker, it costs nothing'	7	Tab 4
36	'Watch your income'	6	Tab 4
37	Affordable coverage that lets them be self-employed or retire early	5	Tab 2
38	Free to work for themselves or retire early	5	Tab 8
39	Plan switched or enrolled without consent	4	Private worry
40	Lost Medicaid or earn too much for it	3	Private worry
41	Health sharing ministries and short-term plans	3	Lead source
42	Narrow networks and doctors who don't take the plan	3	Dislike
43	Google and online research	1	Lead source

Awareness → Offer Map

Unaware

Hypothesis: 'Your 2027 price changed — check it before January 15.'

Problem aware

Hypothesis: lead with the income cliff and what counts as income.

Solution aware

Hypothesis: bronze vs silver with the deductible spelled out.

Product aware

Hypothesis: 'keep your doctor' network check.

Most aware

Hypothesis: consented enrollment with the agent named, no plan changes without their signature.

Silent Searches

What the ACA / marketplace health insurance shopper types, watches and is sold, measured side by side (typed = autocomplete that still names the worry; watched = YouTube videos whose title names it; spoke = own-voice documents; sold = ads to this audience).

Worry	Typed	Videos	Views	Spoke	Ads
Premiums they can't pay (subsidy loss, doubling)	48	39	320,593	30	57
Paying the subsidy back at tax time	35	54	160,469	8	43
Going without coverage and hoping nothing happens	10	9	94,809	32	6
Plan switched or enrolled without consent	0	24	301,205	4	10
A plan they can't use: deductibles and networks	11	71	6,008,399	27	3
Lost Medicaid or earn too much for it	16	52	488,325	3	4
Lost the job, COBRA too expensive, early retirement	46	84	4,088,716	28	4

Premiums they can't pay (subsidy loss, doubling)

Typed: can afford health insurance · can no longer afford health insurance · can t afford employer health insurance · can t afford employer health insurance reddit · can t afford health insurance · can t afford health insurance 2026 reddit · can t afford health insurance and don t qualify for medicaid · can t afford health insurance anymore · can t afford health insurance but don t qualify for medicaid · can t afford health insurance but make too much for medicaid · can t afford health insurance don t qualify for medicaid · can t afford health insurance for 2026 · can t afford health insurance for my child · can t afford health insurance in 2026 · can t afford health insurance in california · can t afford health insurance reddit · can t afford health insurance through employer · can t afford health insurance what do i do

Watched: Retiring Before 65? This Is How People Actually Afford Health Insurance (249,275 views) https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=lsxxWGpc_fE · The U.S. Health Insurance System is Broken I I Can't Afford Health Insurance and I'm Not Alone (21,105 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a75qe8VdFLQ> · Many cannot afford to retire at age 62 because of the cost of private health insurance (13,817 views) https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=dTkOE6_xA_4 · Can't Afford Your ACA Plan? 2026 FIXES & CHEAPER OPTIONS! (11,329 views) https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=9J_Ols9z_rY · Healthcare FAQ: What if I can't afford health insurance? (5,134 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=tcGgJY3QG5E>

Paying the subsidy back at tax time

Typed: do i have to pay back a premium tax credit · do i have to pay back advance premium tax credit · do i have to pay back excess advance premium tax credit · do i have to pay back health insurance tax credit · do i have to pay back insurance tax credit · do i have to pay back monthly advance payment of premium tax credit · do i have to pay back my premium tax credit · do i have to pay back premium tax credit · do i have to pay back premium tax credit for health insurance · do i have to pay back tax credit for health insurance · do i have to pay back the advance premium tax credit · do i have to pay back the health insurance tax credit · do i have to pay back the monthly advance payment of premium tax credit · do i have to pay back the premium tax credit · do you have to pay back advance premium tax credit · do you have to pay back health insurance tax credit · do you have to pay back health insurance tax credit reddit · do you have to pay back insurance tax credit

Watched: IRS Form 8962 Premium Tax Credit and the IRS Form 1095-A (48,878 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=w8Xz4V0k-7A> · Premium Tax Credit: Changes in Circumstances - Introduction (15,308 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=XNveUOx4mIA> · Health Insurance Subsidy Flow of 1095A onto form 8962 federal tax return (13,877 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=oi8HCvgefjl> · How Premium Tax Credit Works (Health Insurance Subsidies) (13,093 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=3cCHSywftlg> · Form 8962 for 2025 - Premium Tax Credit & Form 1095-A (9,718 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0SfM2qXP7Ss>

Going without coverage and hoping nothing happens

Typed: going without health insurance · going without health insurance 2026 · going without health insurance between jobs · going without health insurance for a month · going without health insurance for a month reddit · going without health insurance for a year · going without health insurance pros and cons · going without health insurance reddit · living without health insurance · living without health insurance on purpose pros and cons

Watched: If you have no health insurance prior to applying for Medicare at age 65 there is no problem (47,772 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=QupCURgX4hY> · How to Survive Without HEALTH INSURANCE in Today's World (29,144 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=LYCLf236lZc> · Emergency Room Without Health Insurance: Will you be turned away? (6,030 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Pkt0L-wjKW4> · If you CAN'T Afford Health Insurance...WATCH THIS. (3,748 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Dt19QC1rJCM> · The cost of having a baby in America without health insurance (2,486 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=xaVkYZmt5jk>

Plan switched or enrolled without consent

Watched: Vance: 750K booted from ACA over fraud (154,162 views) https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=mt4pvvQq_VE · BOMBSHELL REPORT: Obamacare fraud scheme costing taxpayers BILLIONS (127,592 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=nVj9R34nnao> · Vance, Oz to announce crackdown on alleged Obamacare fraud (6,243 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=sl9NSZTvRSU> · Finding fraud: White House says more than 760,000 Obamacare accounts meet the mark (2,091 views) https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=dbZsCV7q_Fk · Vance Kicks 750,000 Off Obamacare For Never Going To The Doctor. Cries Fraud. (1,556 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=emh5JQhAbYk>

A plan they can't use: deductibles and networks

Typed: bronze price per kg · health insurance deductible · health insurance deductible explained · health insurance deductible too high · how does a health insurance deductible work · how health insurance deductible works · is 1000 deductible too high health insurance · my health insurance deductible is too high · what is a high insurance deductible · why is health insurance deductible so high · why is my insurance deductible so high

Watched: NECK Training Is... Not Worth It (2,899,548 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=GW65zG0fIE> · A quality muzzle brake is worth it! (870,692 views) https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=nAb_mw8H-Sg · How Health Insurance Works I What is a Deductible? Coinsurance? Copay? Premium? (440,527 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=xs7MNNqdN-o> · Health Insurance Plans Explained- compare bronze, silver, gold and platinum for 2024 (California) (236,806 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=jW6-BKpAruE> · How insurance premiums and deductibles work (211,418 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hcMDaMhJanM>

Lost Medicaid or earn too much for it

Typed: how much is too much income for medicaid in arkansas · how much is too much income for medicaid in florida · how to replace lost medicaid card · how to report a lost medicaid card · i lost medicaid now what · i lost my medicaid now what · i lost my medicaid what do i do now · lost medicaid coverage now what · lost medicaid now what · lost medicaid what to do · make too much money for medicaid · too much income for medicaid · too much money for medicaid · what happens if i lost my medicaid card · what is considered too much income for medicaid · what should i do if i lost my medicaid card

Watched: How new Medicaid work requirements could affect families with disabled children (201,473 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=UPCFSjnQ8xg> · Dr. Oz tries to justify Medicaid work requirements starting in 2027. #healthcare #medicaid #doctor (156,811 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=pZL3-aFh-Q> · Medicaid work requirements will begin in 2027 (26,765 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Uhmhz21Ej5Y> · 150,000

Arizonans have lost Medicaid coverage (23,969 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=fp64IM2YvG8> · Medicaid Work Requirements/NO JOBS (13,530 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KFO9Knp-e7g>

Lost the job, COBRA too expensive, early retirement

Typed: clint false water cobra · cobra clint's reptiles · cobra false bite · cobra insurance too expensive · cobra is expensive · cobra man ray hunter · cobra rat · cobra so expensive · cobra too expensive · cobra too expensive reddit · health insurance if i lost my job · health insurance marketplace lost job · health insurance when lost job · husband lost job need health insurance · i lost my job and health insurance what do i do · i lost my job health insurance · i lost my job and need health insurance for my child · is cobra expensive insurance

Watched: Early Retiree Shares Truth About Retiring Early (2,205,116 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=X3Vsaj-j6ek> · Retiring Before 65? Here's How To Afford Health Insurance (256,482 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Q-0gmK2mR8E> · Retiring Before 65? This Is How People Actually Afford Health Insurance (249,275 views) https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=lsxxWGpc_fE · Health Insurance For Early Retirement! (All You Need to Know) (236,761 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=BykvoxJEWGo> · Learn EVERYTHING About Early Retiree Healthcare In 29 Minutes (183,724 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Hr4uV9axw8o>

Private Worries

Measured absence: 0 first-person sentences say they keep something from their spouse, parents or employer.

Premiums they can't pay (subsidy loss, doubling) · 30 documents

"Just looked at ACA premiums for 2026. There's no way. My husband (28m) and I (26f) are opting to go without health insurance at this time. If by some miracle the federal government decides to extend tax credits in 2026, then we will reconsider, but with the current outlook for premiums we just can't do it. I feel like crying honestly. We both work so hard and make fine money for our age and where we live. But between a mortgage we were forced into entering (long story, had to do with a landlord going bankrupt) and just general expenses, we can't afford even a base insurance plan. The lowest we were eligible for was \$650 a month and a \$20,000 deductible. The math just doesn't work. I see everyone raising alarm bells about going without insurance, having something catastrophic happen, and then going bankrupt. But honestly? Bankruptcy doesn't sound that bad comparatively. We'd go bankrupt with or without health insurance with those deductibles. I'm trying to have a positive outlook here, and I was really banking on being able to get us a catastrophic plan, but even that is not financially feasible for us. I am honestly in disbelief at the way healthcare in this country is handled. I can't even imagine how it is for people who have it so much worse than us."

— HealthInsurance · 660 upvotes · None

"Healthcare Premiums to Skyrocket (Who Can Afford it?) Premium tax credits are set to expire at the end of 2025, which means premiums will be skyrocketing. How can anyone afford this? Premiums are already so high that so many families have trouble affording them, now they will be even higher? Who here can afford an increase in their premiums? All that this will mean is less people will be insured because they can't afford premiums. Subsidies will be reduced a great deal as well for those at or near the poverty line. The subsidies were allowing folks to be insured because premiums were discounted. Remove or reduce the discount, and those people won't be able to be insured. Healthcare is prohibitively expensive already, and it's about to become even more expensive. How can anyone afford this? My guess is that most people can't. Does the gov know what this will do to families' bottom lines? Concerned,"

— HealthInsurance · 293 upvotes · None

"Help! Husband lost his job and we can't afford insurance through my employer! UPDATE: It is MUCH less expensive to insure all 3 of us instead of just me and my daughter through the marketplace! I can get insurance for all 3 for closer to 450 a month by adding him on the policy. Who knew? Thank you everyone for your suggestions! My husband lost his job yesterday. Our insurance will end on April 1. We are both 44 and we have a 13 year old daughter. He starts his new job next week BUT his new employer will not offer any benefits assistance. We live in Missouri. I checked with my employer and it will cost 840 a month on our plan. I tried Healthcare.gov and it was going to be 930 for the cheapest plan (for just me and my daughter, my husband is going to go without insurance. We are not eligible for Medicaid. Where can we find affordable insurance?"

— HealthInsurance · 159 upvotes · None

Paying the subsidy back at tax time · 8 documents

"Paying for ACA (Obamacare) We're about to go on ACA with no subsidies, it'll be about \$20k a year, \$1600 a month. [Healthcare.gov](<http://healthcare.gov/>) hands the billing off to the insurance carrier (e.g., Blue Cross, Oscar, United, Kaiser). Does anyone have experience using a credit card for full yearly prepayment, or split monthly payments (for example using multiple cards to split the monthly payment) with specific carriers?"

— HealthInsurance · 13 upvotes · None

"Need clarification on underestimating income I plan on enrolling my mother in law for 2026 but not sure how to approach her income. I had spoken to broker and I was informed she should show 22k before deductions to get tax credit for 2026. Before I was able to show her income as 2400 a year and get the aca credits. I read posts saying that the repayments of credits are for those who overestimate income not underestimate. Also read the other way around. If I were to sign her up saying her income projected is 22k but let's say at end of 2026 it's 3k. Since the income was underestimated will she need to payback the subsidies? she doesn't qualify for medicaid because she been in USA 2.5 years and you need to be living 5 years to qualify for that"

— obamacare · 5 upvotes · None

"Questions about how to file taxes with premium tax credits for a dependent? My taxes have always been super simple and straightforward. I work full time and have 2 kids, but I don't have employer health benefits and have had Medicaid for all 3 of us since my divorce. My 19 year old son was dropped from Medicaid coverage and I signed him up for an ACA policy through a broker who told me it wouldn't affect my taxes. My son is autistic and is a full time college student. He lives at home and I've always claimed him as a dependent. He doesn't have a job, but did have a little income from a summer internship. But since he has this policy does he have to file taxes? He didn't make enough money last year to meet the FPL for an individual and I didn't earn enough to meet the FPL for a family of 3. I think as far as the federal government is concerned he should still have Medicaid, but we live in a red state that didn't expand Medicaid, so there's no coverage for 18-24 year old students who don't have children. Do I file my taxes as usual with my children as dependents and then file taxes for him with his 1095-a and put that he can be claimed as a dependent? Do I not claim him as a dependent even though he is most definitely a dependent? He's the only one with an ACA policy and I do not know what I'm doing and I'm afraid since he didn't make enough money that he'll have to pay back thousands of dollars in subsidies. Thanks for any advice!"

— obamacare · 1 upvotes · None

Going without coverage and hoping nothing happens · 32 documents

"My family's health insurance is set to go from \$170 per month in 2025 to \$1560 in 2026 due to expiring ACA credits. A few clarifying points: - I earn approx \$125k as the sole provider for my family of 4 - I am self employed - This is the cheapest possible plan I could find anywhere - Coverage for this plan is terrible and helps me exactly \$0 with our family's actual health expenses I don't even know how I'm supposed to form thoughts around this. I can barely breathe let alone wrap my mind around this. How the hell am I supposed to survive in this country the way it is now? It seems like the world is actively punishing people who have families, or anyone who is not a multimillionaire. This is just one problem in a cornucopia of financial disasters handed to me as a millennial parent. This is not even mentioning how the new student loan rulings will add hundreds of dollars per month of financial burden, nor how I will forever be priced out of the housing market and am doomed to ever increasing rent month after month, or how food costs have practically doubled for my family over the past 5 years. How bad is it to go without health insurance in the new year? I literally have no idea what else to do..."

— HealthInsurance · 776 upvotes · None

"Just looked at ACA premiums for 2026. There's no way. My husband (28m) and I (26f) are opting to go without health insurance at this time. If by some miracle the federal government decides to extend tax credits in 2026, then we will reconsider, but with the current outlook for premiums we just can't do it. I feel like crying honestly. We both work so hard and make fine money for our age and where we live. But between a mortgage we were forced into entering (long story, had to do with a landlord going bankrupt) and just general expenses, we can't afford even a base insurance plan. The lowest we were eligible for was \$650 a month and a \$20,000 deductible. The math just doesn't work. I see everyone raising alarm bells about going without insurance, having something catastrophic happen, and then going bankrupt. But honestly? Bankruptcy doesn't sound that bad comparatively. We'd go bankrupt with or without health insurance with those deductibles. I'm trying to have a positive outlook here, and I was really banking on being able to get us a catastrophic plan, but even that is not financially feasible for us. I am honestly in disbelief at the way healthcare in this country is handled. I can't even imagine how it is for people who have it so much worse than us."

— HealthInsurance · 660 upvotes · None

"What you can do if your marketplace premiums for 2026 are too high I've seen this topic come up in recent weeks and want to offer some advice for folks on marketplace plans with premium hikes. This could also work for folks with employer group plans. I realize that this won't work for everyone in every situation but if you've come to a place where you need to consider alternative ways to approach your healthcare costs, this may be helpful. 1. switch to the least expensive marketplace ACA-compliant bronze-level high deductible HSA-eligible insurance plan to cover only catastrophic events like hospitalization. Use this the way you would use your car insurance: sparingly or not at all. Note that going without insurance is a very, very bad idea for reasons that are covered in this sub on a regular basis. 2. Open and contribute to an HSA to get tax savings on money you'll spend toward medical expenses. 3. SKIP DENTAL AND VISION INSURANCE. Honestly this applies to everyone on marketplace plans but dental and vision "insurance" are just glorified payment plans. They are not regulated the same way as ACA health insurance plans so insurers are allowed to charge premiums on those products that guarantee profit margins > 20%. Instead, work with your favorite local dentist and optometrist to pay directly for all your services, and put the money you would have spent on these premiums into your HSA. 4. If you need care: 4a. If you are someone who needs more than 1-3 office visits a year, shop around for a direct primary care provider in your area. Memberships for these are generally pretty reasonable when you factor in what you might have spent toward premiums on a silver or gold tier marketplace plan. 4b. Google specialty care options. For example, Cove offers a monthly membership for treatment of migraines that, when you add it up, is less expensive than a single trip to the neurologist plus a monthly RX from Walgreens. Companies like this exist for nearly everything. 4c. Become a smart shopper for your rxs. There are so many options outside of traditional insurance that can help you save money: GoodRx, Mark Cuban Cost Plus, LillyDirect, Hers/Hims, Nurx. 4d: Think of memberships you may already have that come with pharmacy or healthcare benefits: Costco is an obvious one but comb through other areas of your life. For example, my electric company is a co-op and offers members a discount program for dental, prescriptions, and gym memberships. 4e. Ask your current providers about direct pay arrangements. If you're paying \$200/month in premiums so that your therapist is in-network, but your therapist will happily take \$150 cash per monthly session, you'll come out \$50/month ahead by paying directly. If anyone has other suggestions, because I'm sure I've missed plenty, add them!"

— HealthInsurance · 372 upvotes · None

Plan switched or enrolled without consent · 4 documents

"My employer fired me after I challenged them of taking me off the health care insurance Hey everyone. I don't normally post stuff like this, but this whole situation has been insane and I could really use some outside perspective. I also want people to know how easily something like this can happen to them and the. The outcome of having health issues later. I worked for a company called Diamond Blade Warehouse (main office in Vernon Hills, IL, with multiple locations around the country). I was with them for almost three years. I left a different job to work there because I thought it'd be a good fit. Like any job, there were parts I liked good people on the sales side, some solid customers , but behind the curtain, it was a mess. I was a commission-based W-2 employee, meaning if I didn't hit commissions, I didn't get paid. No hourly, no base, no nothing. Just straight commission on a W-2... which already didn't sit right, but I needed the income. Earlier this year, out of nowhere, I was told I'd be switched to 1099. No paperwork, no conversation, no explanation. Just "you're 1099. "They just wanted the "benefits" of a contractor without actually making me one. Then on September 3rd, 2025, I got an email from accounting saying my health insurance coverage would end because they weren't applying my wages to the premium anymore. I replied, politely, that I wanted to keep my coverage and would pay out of pocket. I even jokingly said " I think you'd have to fire me to take away my benefits like that." Within ONE HOUR, my company email was disabled and I got a text message saying I was being terminated for "low sales." Convenient timing, right? And here's where it gets even worse. That same day, the COBRA plan administrator sent me a COBRA election notice that looked like it was printed off Google Images, wrong dates, wrong termination info, wrong deadlines. I tried responding, but their spam blocker was set so strict that my replies bounced. I literally had to switch email accounts just to contact them. They sent me a second COBRA notice the same day, also wrong. I asked for a corrected one and the administrator replied in ALL CAPS, basically yelling at me, demanding multiple months of payment upfront... even though the dates were wrong. Instead of fixing the spam blocker so I could communicate normally, management started relaying messages through my sales manager via text. It was like a weird game of corporate telephone. Completely unprofessional and honestly, absolutely ridiculous. Then comes the cherry on top: Months earlier, my manager texted me saying that the CFO, Bronwyn Jacobson, "didn't want me on the company's insurance" and was sweating him about it. In mid-August, she asked again if it was "ok to take me off." I never agreed. Two weeks later... terminated. I've already filed a complaint with the U.S. Department of Labor (EBSA) for COBRA violations, ERISA interference, retaliation, and misclassification. They're reviewing everything. I'm physically exhausted, financially strained, and emotionally worn down from dealing with this, but I'm speaking up because people deserve to know what companies pull when they think no one's looking. If any Redditors have advice, legal, emotional, or just practical, on navigating this, please drop it below. And if anyone's been through something similar, you're not alone. This one messed me up, and I don't want it happening to someone else."

— HealthInsurance · 105 upvotes · None

"Insurance Bill I Never Signed Up For So I just did my 2025 taxes, and when I first submitted them they got rejected for not including a 1095. I have insurance through my husband's job so this was weird, but I did check my Marketplace eligibility but never signed up for a plan. I ended up including a letter in my taxes that said I checked my eligibility but did not receive coverage from the marketplace. Fast forward to last night. I went to dinner with my mom and she brought me some mail I got from her house. They were bills and delinquency notices from the insurance company Ambetter. Somehow I was signed up for this insurance and these bills were sent to my mom's house, I have not lived there for 6 years. I did some googling and I'm not the only person that has been signed up for insurance without my consent. My question is what the hell do I do?"

— HealthInsurance · 27 upvotes · None

"There are a few parts of this that will cause issues. 1. There were clearly fraudulent brokers who enrolled "fake" people in order to get commissions. It seems like they identified policies that were submitted without a SSN, had never filed a claim, and did not respond to communication. 2. Because of this they are not allowing new brokers/agent to register and enroll people. This is going to cause a massive bottleneck in people who need help enrolling 3. They are adding more hoops to jump through in order to be someones agent and submit applications for them My theory.....they are adding hoops and removing resources in order to cause issues with the federal marketplace in hopes to destroy the program or reduce enrollments."

— HealthInsurance · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wodklt/please_explain_the_vanceoz_announcement_yesterday/pbm67px/

A plan they can't use: deductibles and networks · 27 documents

"ACA \$1,900 per month on \$5,000 per month income? Is this normal? My husband was laid off last week during the mass tech layoffs. Our insurance was through his company. I own my own business, and net after expenses and taxes \$5,000/month on average. I have variable income. I went onto the ACA marketplace today, entered all of our info, my income, his income zero, our two young children, and I was given a price of \$1,900/month for the cheapest plan with a \$16,000 deductible. How is this affordable on an income of \$5,000? I am not understanding. Should I call? Editing to add that a lot of people responding to my post seem to think I am oblivious to the political situation related to this. Yes, I did write to my representatives weeks ago (but it obviously did nothing because I live in the red state of Kansas. I vote blue and always have because I am a woman who prefers bodily autonomy to the alternative.) I am one person who has zero political power or sway. I am sharing my numbers to see what is happening with others, who are powerless to do anything as well at the federal level to make this better. Just thought I would clarify that for everyone. Also, COBRA for us would be \$3,500/month for a high deductible plan for those who thought this would be a cheaper option."

— HealthInsurance · 1,646 upvotes · None

"Dropping our ACA plan Today is the day my family is dropping our ACA plan. Our options were to stay on our same plan and be financially strained, or switch to a different plan with an absurdly high deductible. Neither option made sense for us. Luckily, my family is healthy right now. I'm just posting this for solidarity with all the other individuals and families in the same boat. Obviously, not having health insurance comes with a risk, but for us, that risk made more sense than continuing to pay into a broken system. We found a Direct Primary Care (DPC) provider near us, so we know we'll at least have basic, and great care. We are exploring other alternatives as well. Oh, and for those of you who are also exiting the marketplace this year, you must proactively do this or you will be automatically re-enrolled. Happy last day to enroll everyone!"

— HealthInsurance · 763 upvotes · None

"Virginia ACA Rates Posted Today: Share Your Increase In Virginia and rates came up today. Self employed couple 59 & 61. This year our premium was \$1187/month. Same plan next year \$2,109/month. This is more than my mortgage payment and a \$922/month increase brings the total yearly cost to \$50,616. We will have to switch to a high deductible low quality Bronze plan with a \$7,500 deductible EACH with a monthly premium of \$1452/month. This is beyond belief. Continue contacting your elected officials people 🙏 "

— obamacare · 584 upvotes · None

Lost Medicaid or earn too much for it · 3 documents

"Girlfriend had \$0 monthly premium; now will be \$890. She doesn't make \$700 a month... We're in Alabama. She has BCBS Blue Standardized Silver EPO. I'm not knowledgeable enough to know why, but I'm assuming her premium shot up because of the ACA subsidy cuts. Apparently she is in the "Medicaid gap"... Not entirely sure what to do except tell her to drop it until we can find a better solution, as much as I hate saying that. We weren't planning on getting married, but I'm beginning to consider it so my employer can get her on family coverage under my policy... Next November...."

— HealthInsurance · 780 upvotes · None

"The "Medicaid Gap" is a joke. For context, I live in Mississippi. (And honestly that should already tell you everything you need to know.) (And yes, I already posted this but I didn't realized the rant/vent flair would lock the comments. Whoops! So let's try this again) For the past two years, I've been able to get an affordable marketplace plan with Ambetter. It was the first time I was able to get health insurance since I got knocked off my dad's when I turned 26. (I'm now 31) Without this insurance, I wouldn't have been able to get diagnosed with ADHD, get help with my anxiety and depression, treat my Hypothyroidism and Anemia. Like this has been life changing for me. I work for a small business and unfortunately, I didn't make enough money in 2025 to qualify for the tax credit towards insurance premiums like I have the past couple of years. Which means I'm now expected to pay \$650 every single month for health insurance as a single person with no children. I'm absolutely not doing that because that's not something I can afford. And because Mississippi hates poor people (despite us being the poorest state in the country, but yknow whatever I guess), I now fall into the "Medicaid Gap" as if I was ever eligible for Medicaid in the first place. And because of that, it doesn't seem like there's any kind of affordable options. God forbid we expand Medicaid so the poor people can get health care. GOD FORBID. Luckily it seems like I'll at least be able to continue to afford my thyroid medicine and antidepressants still since I was already on the generic. (Ambetter fully covered Generic and GoodRx says between those two, it shouldn't be too much out of pocket.) But now I won't be able to afford my ADHD medicine and my mental health appointments where I also get my antidepressants and it just fucking sucks, man. I just feel so defeated. I was finally taking better care of myself and now it's about to come to a screeching halt. Anyway, thanks for listening to me vent. I know I'm not the only one in this situation. I'm just hoping something changes for us in the future.

💙 "

— HealthInsurance · 138 upvotes · None

"Questions about how to file taxes with premium tax credits for a dependent? My taxes have always been super simple and straightforward. I work full time and have 2 kids, but I don't have employer health benefits and have had Medicaid for all 3 of us since my divorce. My 19 year old son was dropped from Medicaid coverage and I signed him up for an ACA policy through a broker who told me it wouldn't affect my taxes. My son is autistic and is a full time college student. He lives at home and I've always claimed him as a dependent. He doesn't have a job, but did have a little income from a summer internship. But since he has this policy does he have to file taxes? He didn't make enough money last year to meet the FPL for an individual and I didn't earn enough to meet the FPL for a family of 3. I think as far as the federal government is concerned he should still have Medicaid, but we live in a red state that didn't expand Medicaid, so there's no coverage for 18-24 year old students who don't have children. Do I file my taxes as usual with my children as dependents and then file taxes for him with his 1095-a and put that he can be claimed as a dependent? Do I not claim him as a dependent even though he is most definitely a dependent? He's the only one with an ACA policy and I do not know what I'm doing and I'm afraid since he didn't make enough money that he'll have to pay back thousands of dollars in subsidies. Thanks for any advice!"

— obamacare · 1 upvotes · None

Lost the job, COBRA too expensive, early retirement · 28 documents

"ACA \$1,900 per month on \$5,000 per month income? Is this normal? My husband was laid off last week during the mass tech layoffs. Our insurance was through his company. I own my own business, and net after expenses and taxes \$5,000/month on average. I have variable income. I went onto the ACA marketplace today, entered all of our info, my income, his income zero, our two young children, and I was given a price of \$1,900/month for the cheapest plan with a \$16,000 deductible. How is this affordable on an income of \$5,000? I am not understanding. Should I call? Editing to add that a lot of people responding to my post seem to think I am oblivious to the political situation related to this. Yes, I did write to my representatives weeks ago (but it obviously did nothing because I live in the red state of Kansas. I vote blue and always have because I am a woman who prefers bodily autonomy to the alternative.) I am one person who has zero political power or sway. I am sharing my numbers to see what is happening with others, who are powerless to do anything as well at the federal level to make this better. Just thought I would clarify that for everyone. Also, COBRA for us would be \$3,500/month for a high deductible plan for those who thought this would be a cheaper option."

— HealthInsurance · 1,646 upvotes · None

"Former employer canceled COBRA health insurance policy without notifying me I just found out my former employer in the state of Washington canceled my COBRA health insurance policy. Not because they notified me, but because my pharmacy called me and said my policy was no longer valid. WTF COBRA is supposed to be valid for 18-36 months and I am fully paid up. I just had major surgery and have PT scheduled in 4 days that has already been deferred for 2 weeks (because I was at my yearly limit of PT) if I don't make the appointment I may never correctly recover and regain full use of my arm. Apparently, my former employer is getting rid of Aetna and getting a new Health Insurance plan from a different provider. So my Aetna policy terminated at the beginning of 2025. Neither my former employer nor Aetna notified me about this, is that even legal? My COBRA provider told me over the phone that my coverage is supposed to switch to the new policy, but my former employer didn't send them the correct documents and that plan is not active for me so now I am stuck with no Health Insurance in need of immediate healthcare. What are my options? UPDATE: I contacted my former employer, who didn't have a good answer for why I wasn't notified. But did state that they had gotten a new health insurance policy with a different company. They then gave me a plan number and group number and told me to use that info to create an account on the website on the new insurance provider. I attempted to do so and the web form said that wasn't a valid policy and refused to let me create an account. After an additional back and forth with HR from my old company they said to call the new Health Insurance provider. So after 30 minutes of being on hold with them, they told me the policy number I had been given was for a different person who happened to have a different first name, same last name, different birthday and different address. Apparently that incorrect info was given to the HR lady at my company by their insurance vendor. After contacting four different companies, and spending more than an hour on the phone I am still without health insurance while needing PT to recover from a major surgery and unable to renew my prescriptions. For those that said this was a simple issue that I could clear up with a quick call to my former employer, I'm calling you on your BS. It's not, and there is incompetence up and down the chain of everyone involved here. FURTHER CONTEXT: I have accepted an offer for a new job (one with better health insurance) and should be starting at the end of the month. I only need my COBRA health plan for another month to get through all the post surgery PT, maybe get a Flu and COVID shot and get my prescriptions for this month. And however long it takes to get the new health insurance actually functional. As such it doesn't feel worth it to sign up for an ACA plan for less than a month of coverage and then have to deal with the overhead of cancelling that plan and setting up another new one. I just want the COBRA coverage they told me would be available for a whole year to actually work. UPDATE 2: I got a different (supposedly correct) policy number from my former employers HR, tried to use that to create an account on Regence's website and it still failed. I called Regence (was on hold for a whole hour) gave them the new policy number and was told over the phone I am actually in their system and I SHOULD have an active policy. I also read back the group # I had been given by HR and found out that was also incorrect (way to go former employer 0/2). I have no way to verify it's functional other than going to PT tomorrow and seeing if they can bill Regence. UPDATE 3: I filled a complaint with the state insurance commissioner, not just for the recent fiasco but also for the situation that caused me to quit my job in the first place where I believe the company may have actually acted illegally. I don't expect anything to come if it but maybe future me will be pleasantly surprised."

— HealthInsurance · 273 upvotes · None

"No longer eligible for medicaid I've (26m) had illinois medicaid for the past 3/4ish years. My redetermination period was to be completed by Aug 2025. I've submitted the redetermination letter through mail last month and called the automated number today to check the status for them to tell my benefits have ended because of exceeding income. I've always done the medicaid application/redetermination including my parents in my household with their income (retirement, neither of them work anymore). Prior to this year, only my father had income through retirement. However, this/last year my mother also started getting retirement benefits which apparently pushed the household income past the medicaid income cap for 3 people. So now I am no longer eligible for medicaid. Have I been fucking up this whole time when doing the redetermination including them in my household? They don't have to file taxes because their total income from unemployment benefits is still low enough where they don't have to so I'm not claimed as a dependent or anything. What do I do moving forward? Do I start an entirely new application on the website with only my information and none of my parents'? Or am I screwed now and have to buy health insurance through marketplace now? Edit: Thanks for the replies/help; I'll reapply without their information. Also, I guess I didn't really specify my financial situation in the original post like I thought I did. I left my job a couple months prior to this whole thing. I then moved back in with my parents shortly after and have been living very modestly though my savings. I don't have an income as of this very moment."

— Medicaid · 30 upvotes · None

Lead Sources

Source	Documents	Worked	Burned
HealthCare.gov or the state exchange	20	0	0
The carrier directly (Ambetter, Oscar, BCBS...)	11	0	0
An agent or broker	10	1	0
Employer / COBRA / spouse's plan	10	0	0
Medicaid / CHIP	8	0	0
Health sharing ministries and short-term plans	3	0	0
Google and online research	1	0	0
Navigators and assisters	0	0	0
HealthSherpa and quote sites	0	0	0

Threads & Competitors

Group	Name	Documents	Positive	Negative
carriers	Blue Cross Blue Shield	28	1	1
platforms & tools	HealthCare.gov	28	0	0
carriers	Wellcare / Centene / Ambetter	15	0	1
carriers	Aetna / CVS	10	0	1
carriers	Oscar	9	0	1
carriers	UnitedHealthcare / AARP	8	0	1
carriers	Kaiser	8	0	0
carriers	Anthem / Elevance / Wellpoint	5	0	1
platforms & tools	SHIP counselors	3	0	0

Competitor Ads

Lead-generation funnels and third-party marketers · 118 ads · 49 advertisers

Advertiser	Ads	Longest (days)	Destination	Opening line
Canada Benefit Group	2	1562	none captured	Have you heard of the Disability Tax Credit? It was designed to assist Canadians of all ages and income levels. This tax credit program is I
National Help Resources	1	918	trustedhealthfinder.com	We can help you find an affordable health insurance plan. Plans may be available for less than \$115 per month premium. Click the link below
Array Medical Center Surprise	1	529	none captured	Struggling with chronic pain, stiffness, or mobility issues? Finding it hard to enjoy life without discomfort? We have solutions that could
USA Health Insurance Rates	2	494	usbluequotes.com	 DON'T WAIT! THESE 3 REASONS COULD SAVE YOU THOUSANDS  You may qualify for a LOW-COST health program in 2024 that can save you thousands! St
Atlas Health & Life	2	387	atlashealthandlife.com	 Upgrade Your Health, Save Money! - Claim Your Free Quote NOW!  Do you crave quality health coverage without breaking the bank? Our exclus
Atticare	1	345	none captured	Hey New York Homeowners!  Tap into NY's \$1,200 Insulation Tax Credit and transform your attic—no more rodents, no more drafts! At Atticare,
Insurance Benefits of America	1	304	none captured	Ensure you and your family are protected with comprehensive health insurance.  Fast Approval Process!  Coverage Starts Within 24 Hours  C
Compare Health Quotes	5	284	none captured	Looking for affordable health insurance? Get Blue Cross coverage as low as \$79/month! Fast, free quotes are just a click away. Secure your h
Forever Family Coverage	4	271	aca.foreverfamilycoverage.com	The Affordable Care Act allows 4 out of 5 Americans to have HIGHLY REDUCED COST or NO COST HEALTH INSURANCE! See if you qualify by clicking
ACA Community Center	6	260	none captured	\$0 Health Insurance Plans Now Available In Your Area. See If You Qualify Today! FREE Health Insurance See if you qualify Apply Now
All-Weather Seal Co., Inc.	1	248	none captured	 50 MICHIGAN HOMEOWNERS NEEDED  Get full home window replacement for as low as \$97/mnth* through our 2026 NS Program!  With lifetime war
Self Employed Health Insurance	35	246	go.selfemployedhi.com	Self-Employed? Own Your Health Coverage in 2025 If you're a small business owner or independent contractor, finding the right health insuran
GROWING DAYS CHILDCARE AND LEARNING CENTER	1	232	none captured	 NOW ENROLLING – VPK & KINDERGARTEN  It's that time! If you're searching for the best place for your child to learn, grow, and thrive—your
Daniel M Smith HealthMarkets Insurance	1	211	fb.com	Health Insurance for everyone! FB.COM Chat in Messenger Everyone Covered Here Get quote
CYCLERIE	1	207	store.cyclerie.net	 Aventon Pace 4 Step-Through Sale is ON at Cyclerie! Get the silky-smooth cruiser everyone's raving about: • \$200 OFF the regular price • F

CoverME.gov	1	175	none captured	When you lose your health insurance, you don't have to wait until Open Enrollment. Act now to stay covered for what's next with a Special En
Hunter Life & Health	1	162	www.hunterlifehealth.com	Just released — new PPO plans with real coverage and zero nonsense. These aren't your typical health insurance plans. ✅ Low deductibles ✅ \$0
Euro-Tech, Inc.	1	147	none captured	50 HOMEOWNERS NEEDED 🏠 Upgrade your home with NEW Energy-Efficient Windows starting from \$147/mnth through our 2025 OFS Program ✅ Windows, a
Healthcare.com	2	113	healthcare.com	Looking for 2026 Kaiser Permanente health plans? You may be eligible for ACA Marketplace plans starting at just \$50/month*. Check your ZIP c
Presidio Healthcare	1	95	presidiocare.com	You take care of your health. Your insurance should reward that. Presidio Healthcare is licensed health insurance — not a government plan, n
Empire Solar Solutions	7	85	save.empiresolarny.com	New York homeowners have access to an exclusive program that can: ✅ Reduce electric bills by up to 93%. ✅ Protect you from future rate incre
Future Fortress Insurance	1	73	www.futurefortressinsurance.com	🌟 Upgrade Your Health, Save Money! - Claim Your Free Quote NOW! 🌟 Do you crave quality health coverage without breaking the bank? Our exclus
Get Covered NJ	4	72	none captured	Recently had a major life change or lost your health insurance? You may qualify for a Special Enrollment Period through #GetCoveredNJ. GETCO
STL Medicare Benefits	1	68	none captured	Did your Missouri Medicaid (MO HealthNet) end? You're not alone. Many Missourians are losing Medicaid due to renewal changes. The good news
Health Plan Helpdesk	1	67	none captured	Members of federally recognized tribes and ANCSA shareholders have coverage protections most people never hear about. If your household inco
Trust4Life	2	66	none captured	Are you looking for affordable, comprehensive health coverage? With the Affordable Care Act (ACA), you could qualify for a plan at NO COST!
Global ADC Insurance	1	65	none captured	💙 Tu salud no debería esperar. Miles de familias podrían calificar para seguro médico desde \$0 al mes. Descubre si eres elegible para: ✅ Oba
Better Choice Health Plans	1	62	none captured	Health insurance costs have increased again this year, but many individuals and families may still qualify for lower monthly premiums than t
Insurance Medics Health	1	55	none captured	Uninsured? Lost your job coverage? Self-employed? You may qualify for a health insurance plan with \$0 monthly premiums through the ACA Marke
Jay Insurance	1	50	none captured	Finding affordable health insurance doesn't have to be complicated. Whether you're self-employed, between jobs, or simply exploring better c
Private Health Care	4	47	privatehealthcareoptions.com	Your best health insurance options are waiting! Compare & save! 📱 ⚡ Stop overpaying for health coverage! Private Health Care compares top car
James' Lifestyle & Fitness with HealthCare.gov	1	46	ad.doubleclick.net	#Ad Moving comes with a lot of updates — including having to possibly update your health coverage. If you've recently moved or experienced a
Grace Lemire with HealthCare.gov	1	46	ad.doubleclick.net	#ad I can't believe it's been a whole year since I moved to Florida 😭 I just renewed my lease at my

				apartment and it has me thinking so much
ACA Health Coverage Help with Sherell	1	36	none captured	 Need health insurance but don't have coverage through an employer? Whether you're working, self-employed, a 1099 worker, between jobs, or
Health Mutual Network Insurance Solutions	1	32	none captured	BREAKING UPDATE — JUST HAPPENED - Premiums are changing fast — and not in the way most people expect. 📌 Yes, rates are going up nationwide a
Health Revolution	4	31	www.healthrevolution.net	Agency coverage ends the day the contract does — and the gap between assignments is nobody's job to fix. Health Revolution writes private PP
Native American Insurance Specialists	1	25	thrivehealthplans.com	 ATTN: Native Americans with a CDIB card! Qualify for a health insurance plan with zero out-of-pocket cost if your income is between 100%-3
MetroPlusHealth	2	24	none captured	Does your health care plan cost too much and deliver too little? Switch to MetroPlusHealth Gold and save money. Upgrade to \$0 copays MetroPI
GetCoverageFox	1	24	coveragefox.com	See if you qualify for \$0/month health insurance. We'll help you compare plans and enroll. COVERAGEFOX.COM/PLANS See If You Qualify Compare
The Financial Solutions	2	24	none captured	 September Enrollment Is Open! 5G Wi-Fi for only \$9.99 - Stop Over Paying! Why pay full price for home internet when your household can qua

The carriers' own ads · 5 ads · 4 advertisers

Advertiser	Ads	Longest (days)	Destination	Opening line
BCBS Global Solutions	1	95	bcbsglobalsolutions.com	Not all plans are built for life abroad, but ours are. Get the right international health insurance, so you're covered for everyday care and
Blue Cross and Blue Shield of Minnesota	2	39	bluecrossmn.com	Get one card and one plan for a \$0 premium when you choose a Blue Cross health plan that combines your Medical Assistance (Medicaid) and Med
Blue Cross and Blue Shield of Kansas City	1	24	bluekc.com	Blue Cross and Blue Shield of Kansas City gives where we live, supporting the health of the communities we call home. BLUEKC.COM From here.
UnitedHealthcare	1	10	none captured	Choosing your health plan? Learn how a deductible works so you can compare health plan options with confidence. 0:00 / 0:30 What's a deducti

Named local agencies and brokers · 113 ads · 49 advertisers

Advertiser	Ads	Longest (days)	Destination	Opening line
Sackett & Associates Insurance Services	1	1913	none captured	Independent Health Insurance Agency Dedicated to Meeting Your Needs! We're Your Advocate Find a Plan That's Right For You Get Quote
David Cravens Insurance Services	1	1837	none captured	Hello! My name is David Cravens, your trusted insurance professional in San Diego, CA. I have been working with small businesses for 23 year
AVZ Benefit Solutions	1	1447	https://crm.avzbenefits.com/healthcare	Need Affordable Health Insurance? Our insurance brokers access all major carriers to find you the right coverages that best fit your needs a
Tristate Insurance Store	1	1010	api.whatsapp.com	Independent Insurance Broker, Health, Life, Auto and Home. Obamacare & Medicare API.WHATSAPP.COM Tristate

				Insurance Store Send WhatsApp mess
The "REAL" Insurance Lady	2	854	instagram.com	The "REAL" Insurance Lady is excited to extend an exclusive partnership opportunity to you! By joining forces, we aim to provide unparalleled
Plan Advisor	8	549	none captured	Are you <i>self employed</i> , 1099 <i>contractor</i> , <i>truck driver</i> , <i>small business owner</i> or on an expensive <i>cobra</i> plan? If so, then we need to talk! Get h
GRAN Insurance	2	473	graninsurance.com	¿Sabías que hay planes médicos diseñados para ti y tu familia? 💙 Mucha gente ya está aprovechando esta oportunidad para cuidar su salud sin
The Pierce Insurance Group	1	340	none captured	Just released — new PPO plans with real coverage and zero nonsense. These aren't your typical health insurance plans.  Low deductibles  \$0
Sonny Salas Agency, Inc.	1	314	http://www.sonnysalasagency.com/	ACA Open Enrollment is in full swing — and we're here to help! With the government now open, our team of licensed insurance agents are ready
April Griffey-licensed health insurance agent	1	237	none captured	Looking for affordable health insurance WITHOUT all the phone calls? I specialize with small businesses, individuals, and families and can h
Matthews Insurance Advisors	1	219	gmatthewsinsurance.com	🌟 Upgrade Your Health, Save Money! - Claim Your Free Quote NOW! 🌟 Do you crave quality health coverage without breaking the bank? Our exclus
Royal Insurance USA LLC	3	212	none captured	¿Sin seguro médico en California? 🌴 No todo está perdido. Sabemos que el periodo de inscripción general ya pasó, pero muchos no saben que a
Theriot Family Agency, Inc.	1	207	theriotinsuranceagency.com	Protect what matters most with trusted local insurance! From auto and home to business and life — our independent agents compare top carrier
Right Way Insurance Solution	3	197	none captured	Si eres inmigrante, ¡TU SALUD ES UN DERECHO! Conoce cómo Obamacare puede ayudarte a obtener seguro médico accesible y confiable, sin que tu
Business Health Advisors	4	188	none captured	🇺🇸 AMERICAN TRUCKERS KEEP TRUCKIN! 🇺🇸  UNDER 65 TRUCKERS - STOP AND READ THIS  Stay protected on and off the road with an affordable Health
Daniel Smith Health Insurance	1	183	none captured	DO NOT do this when looking for Health Insurance! 0:00 / 0:55 Get a Quote Send Message
Self Employed Health Insurance	15	176	none captured	JUST PASSED 2025!!! Health Insurance designed with business owners and self-employed in mind!  Lower premiums and better coverage than ACA p
O'Myer Insurance Group	2	165	none captured	Affordable Health Insurance for Self-Employed, Small Businesses, 10-99, Independent Contractors, Farmers, Ranchers, Individuals, and Familie
Davidson Insurance Advisors	1	156	none captured	Spending a lot on health insurance every month? If you're under \$300/month, this probably isn't for you. This also works best for people in
Landfair Financial Group	1	149	none captured	Paying \$1,000+ a month for health insurance? This is who this is built for. If you have major health issues or need a lot of care, this usua
Affordable Health Insurance	15	143	affordable-health-insurance.org	Looking for affordable health insurance? Get Blue Cross coverage as low as \$79/month! Fast, free quotes are just a click away. Secure your h

MD Health Insurance	2	119	none captured	📌 Attention Small Businesses: Private health plans starting at just \$160/month! 📌 Are traditional insurance brokers offering plans that are t
UWorld Insurance Group	2	115	none captured	• Paid for by UWORLD INSURANCE GROUP ¿Diabetes, presión alta o asma? Por ley federal, ACA NO puede negarle. Y el plan puede costar \$0/mes si
Tierra - Your Favorite Health Insurance Girl	2	105	none captured	Self-employed doesn't mean you're on your own. Health insurance is one of the biggest stressors for entrepreneurs , and most people are eith
Wynncrest Insurance Agency	2	102	none captured	Americans age 25-64 can now qualify for \$0 health coverage using subsidies and health credits. FB.ME Find out if you qualify in 60 seconds Q
Alba Insurance USA	1	94	none captured	¿Podrías calificar para seguro médico a bajo costo en EE.UU.? 🇺🇸 Con Obamacare, muchas personas acceden a cobertura según su situación. ✓ P
Pets Best Pet Health Insurance	3	92	none captured	With Pets Best, you could get pet insurance for less than \$1 a day. Give your pet the care they need, when they need it. Get a free quote to
Mariana Espina Insurance	1	83	none captured	🌟 Protege a tu familia hoy con Obamacare 🌟 ¿Eres latino y tienes estatus migratorio legal? ¡No dejes pasar esta oportunidad! Accede a un seg
Insurance Medics Health	1	77	none captured	¿Sin seguro médico? ¿Perdió la cobertura de su trabajo? ¿Trabaja por cuenta propia? Puede calificar para un plan de salud con primas de \$0 a
Goodwin Insurance Advisors	2	71	none captured	Most people are overpaying for health insurance coverage...without even using most of what's in their plan. We help our clients save 20-70%
ASPCA Pet Health Insurance	2	66	none captured	Peace of mind starts with reliable and affordable pet insurance. Choose a plan that works for you and your beloved four-legged family member
La Familia Insurance	2	46	none captured	¿Sabías que el seguro de Obamacare pagando \$50 o menos al mes te puede cubrir hospitalizaciones, medicamentos y especialistas? 🏥💊 Muchas fam
Lupac Health Group	1	37	none captured	¡Planes de seguro médico desde \$0 al mes para quienes califiquen, gracias a los créditos fiscales de Obamacare! • Atención médica primaria g
Capital Growth Advisors	1	30	none captured	The Affordable Care Act allows up to 4 out of 5 Americans to have \$0 MONTH HEALTH INSURANCE! See if you qualify today! Have you ever thought
Vemax Insurance Agency	1	28	none captured	Before choosing an insurance plan, know your options. Vemax works with multiple insurance carriers to help you compare Medicare and ACA heal
FOX4 News Kansas City with BBS Insurance	1	24	bbs-insurance.com	Are you overpaying for your health insurance? BBS Insurance helps individuals and small business owners find smarter, more affordable covera
My Viva Insurance with Viva Insurance USA	2	19	none captured	Buscas un seguro DENTAL TODO INCLUIDO???🌟 Envía "DENTAL" y acaba con ese dolor de cabeza y de muela🔥👉 de no tener un #segurodental en este p
Slade Insurance Solutions	1	15	none captured	\$0/month health plans. Enroll yourself with no phone call. See real prices for your income and household size, choose the plan you want, and
Family Health Agency	1	13	api.whatsapp.com	New Jersey-তে Get Covered NJ এবং অন্যান্য State-এ Health Insurance Marketplace/Obamacare সম্পর্কে তথ্য ও আবেদন সহায়তার জন্য আমাদের সাথে যোগ

JBL Financial Services	2	10	none captured	Feeling overwhelmed about Medicare open enrollment? 🤔 Contact us today to schedule a consultation. Let's get you prepared for open enrollmen
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Advertiser type unclear · 178 ads · 108 advertisers

Advertiser	Ads	Longest (days)	Destination	Opening line
The Physical Therapy Institute of Pa	1	889	physicaltherapyinstitute.com	Need Physical Therapy Now??? Click or call 724-850-7587 Physical Therapy Institute – IRWIN No Prescription Necessary!!! Same Day Appointment
Free Health Care Quotes	1	711	none captured	👉 State Approved Health Coverage for UNEMPLOYED Do you need health insurance for your family? Millions of Americans don't have health insura
tyspencer_bankerslifechi	1	631	none captured	Health insurance can be confusing, but it doesn't have to be. Whether you're self-employed, between jobs, or just want better coverage, I ca
Insuremenowdirect	3	519	none captured	Are you an insurance agent? Join the world's first multicarrier, direct to consumer insurance marketplace and start selling insurance online
Heartland Rehabilitation and Care Center- Benton	1	457	heartlandrehabcenter.com	🌟 We're Hiring at Heartland Rehabilitation and Care Center! 🌟 Looking for passionate and dedicated individuals to fill multiple roles at Hea
Dave Ramsey	6	430	ramseysolutions.com	No job? Side job? Dream job? You still need health insurance. An insurance pro can help you find the right coverage. 0:00 / 0:35
Unorthodoc	1	323	www.unorthodoc.com	Real care isn't temporary! Learn more at www.unorthodoc.com #OpenEnrollment2026 #openenrollment2025 #Obamacare #insurancecoverage #insurance
Safety King Air Duct Cleaning	1	287	safetyking.com	Clean air = happy home. Save 50% on Air Duct Cleaning with the purchase of Aeroseal + qualify for up to a \$1200 tax credit! Hurry—offer ends
Loaves and Fishes Ministries of Fremont County	1	279	lfministries.org	Imagine knowing your donation is directly funding crucial services—like warm beds and job assistance—for our neighbors experiencing homeless
Blue Agave Functional Medicine	1	242	instagram.com	Redefining Your Primary Care👩🏻 At Blue Agave Functional Medicine, we go beyond managing symptoms. We help you understand why they're happenin
305 Fenix Taxes Immigration Obamacare	3	239	api.whatsapp.com	🗨️🔍 No tomes decisiones a ciegas. Antes de avanzar en cualquier trámite migratorio, es clave entender tus opciones y tener todo en orden. En
One Community Health	1	233	www.onecommunityhealth.org	Health insurance can feel overwhelming — but you don't have to figure it out alone 🧡 Meet Juana, one of our amazing Patient Care Advocates (
Liberty Academy - Braintree	1	233	mylibertykids.com	Open Enrollment - Ages 15months to 6 years. Looking for more than just childcare? At Liberty Academy, we're an Early Learning School dedicat
Eden Recovery Center	1	228	none captured	Do you or a loved one struggle with substance abuse? 🍀 Achieve the life you deserve, and your health insurance could cover 100% of luxury tr

Maine Army National Guard Recruiting and Retention Battalion	2	224	none captured	Paid for college tuition, affordable health insurance, and job training in over 60 career fields; build your future when you join the Maine
Primrose School of Shady Hollow	1	218	primroseschools.com	Join us for COFFEE, COOKIES, and our OPEN HOUSE on Friday, February 20th! 🍪 Open Enrollment! ✨ Safe and nurturing environment ✨ Learn about o
Mike Van Someren	1	203	none captured	• Paid for by Mike Van Someren We're not all out here binging MRIs. 3 things to make healthcare more affordable: ✅ clear upfront pricing on
LendingTree	2	199	none captured	Customized Coverage for Everyone: Compare Health Insurance Plans Now! 0:00 / 0:22 Get Your Free Comparison Today! Get Quote
Te lo Aseguro Amiga	1	171	api.whatsapp.com	Tu salud y la de tu familia son importantes. Si no tienes seguro médico o sientes que pagas demasiado, puede haber otras opciones disponible
Alibaba.com	3	170	m.alibaba.com	Source Consumer Electronics on Alibaba.com. Alibaba.com-World's Leading B2B Marketplace. M.ALIBABA.COM 3 In 1 Wireless Charger 15W Multi-Fun
Estrella Medical Centers	1	164	none captured	¿Tienes ObamaCare? ¡Aprovecha tus beneficios dentales GRATIS! Te ofrecemos: ✅ 2 limpiezas al año ✅ 2 exámenes dentales completos ✅ Rayos X i
Health For Moms	1	163	www.healthformoms.co	Moms, we're not just caregivers—we're protectors of futures. We know the power of a gentle hand on a feverish forehead or a hug that says, “
Pellegrino Life and Health	1	163	none captured	Spending a lot on health insurance every month? If you're under \$300/month, this probably isn't for you. This also works best for people in
Simple Healthcare Quote	1	163	none captured	Health Insurance You Won't Need (Until You Do) ✅ Rewards Healthy Lifestyles ✅ Lower Prices Than Traditional Insurance 0:00 / 0:19 FB.ME Chec
Life and Med	1	162	none captured	HEALTH INSURANCE for Residents of LAKE COUNTY!!!📞 Looking for the right health insurance but feeling overwhelmed? Our Local office is here
Nevada Health Link	1	162	nevadahealthlink.com	It's all here at Nevada Health Link — savings, selection and free assistance on name-brand health insurance. 0:00 / 0:30 HTTPS://NEVADAHEALT
Pivot Health	1	156	none captured	See most doctors, stay protected, and save money. Find your short-term health plan with Pivot Health today. 0:00 / 1:12 Pivot Health lets yo
Cobertura de Seguros	1	155	none captured	¿Tuviste un cambio reciente en tu vida? Podrías calificar para Obamacare AHORA MISMO. No te quedes sin seguro médico. Haz clic y verifica tu
Nascentia Health	1	149	nascentiahealth.org	Life doesn't stop because getting out of the house is difficult. That's why our team brings expert care to your door, helping you stay comfo
GWC Marketing	1	149	gwcmarketingagency.com	Another insurance client crushing open enrollment. Our lead gen system dropped their

				CPL from \$63 to \$16 — without sacrificing quality. If y
Massage Tools	2	144	massagetools.com	Spa Luxe equipment is built to support your practice every day — trusted by professionals, engineered for durability, and crafted to deliver
After It Training - Tempe	1	141	promo.afterittraining.com	ATTENTION Women in Tempe! 🙌 FREE 30 Day Strength & Tone Program kicking off this month! To promote our gym, we are announcing open enrollmen
Hamilton Volkswagen	1	140	hamiltonvw.net	Timing is everything. The \$7,500 Federal electric vehicle tax credit expires soon. Check our great selection of New electric models in-stock
Jost International, Corp.	3	134	none captured	Looking for a great job? Now Hiring: Robotic Welders - \$19 to start - Up to \$24 / hour with shift premiums! No Experience Necessary Shift pr
Aztec Landscaping, Inc.	1	125	none captured	Landscape Laborer/Irrigation Tech Landscape Laborer/Irrigation Tech Full Job Description: Landscape Management Company, is seeking a qualifi
Choose Better Care	2	122	none captured	🇺🇸 Life Changed Recently? You Have 60 Days to Save \$400+/Month on Health Insurance Lost your job? 1 Lost your job or quit 2 Turned 26 (aged
Classical Charter Schools of Leland	1	121	www.enrollrba.com	Tuition-Free Charter Schools in NC! Open Enrollment starts Dec 1st! 📍 • Leland • Wilmington • Southport • Whiteville Learn more and enroll
Free Health Care Options	1	117	none captured	Do you need a \$0 premium cost health plan today? Plans are still available with a qualifying event. All pre-existing condition covered. Hit
Health First Health Plans	8	116	none captured	Save money with our \$0 plans, copays, and deductibles.
Compass Solar Energy	1	115	compasssolar.com	Important Update for Florida Homeowners As you may be aware, the federal budget passed on July 4th includes significant changes that directl

Dislikes

Complaint	Documents	1–2★ reviews
Premiums they can't pay after the subsidy loss	25	0
Deductibles too high to use the plan	16	4
Owing money back at tax time	8	3
Narrow networks and doctors who don't take the plan	3	3
Marketplace and Medicaid paperwork, verification, errors	0	1
Plan switched or enrolled without consent	0	0

Premiums they can't pay after the subsidy loss

"The scariest part... from someone who works at a health insurance company I work at a large health insurance company, and lately all I hear about is the potential end of ACA subsidies, rising premiums, and skyrocketing healthcare costs. But the part no one's talking about? This could become the new normal. When has any industry ever raised prices and then actually brought them back down once people got used to paying more? Even if healthcare costs drop (and that's a big if), what incentive do insurers have to lower premiums when people are already paying the higher rates? It's like gas... people used to complain about \$2.50 a gallon. Now we celebrate it. That's the scary part. Prices rise, we adapt, and eventually we forget what "reasonable" even looked like. Unless wages start catching up, we're all in serious trouble."

— r/HealthInsurance · 2,664 upvotes · None

"Virginia ACA Rates Posted Today: Share Your Increase In Virginia and rates came up today. Self employed couple 59 & 61. This year our premium was \$1187/month. Same plan next year \$2,109/month. This is more than my mortgage payment and a \$922/month increase brings the total yearly cost to \$50,616. We will have to switch to a high deductible low quality Bronze plan with a \$7,500 deductible EACH with a monthly premium of \$1452/month. This is beyond belief. Continue contacting your elected officials people 🙄 "

— r/obamacare · 584 upvotes · None

"Healthcare Premiums to Skyrocket (Who Can Afford it?) Premium tax credits are set to expire at the end of 2025, which means premiums will be skyrocketing. How can anyone afford this? Premiums are already so high that so many families have trouble affording them, now they will be even higher? Who here can afford an increase in their premiums? All that this will mean is less people will be insured because they can't afford premiums. Subsidies will be reduced a great deal as well for those at or near the poverty line. The subsidies were allowing folks to be insured because premiums were discounted. Remove or reduce the discount, and those people won't be able to be insured. Healthcare is prohibitively expensive already, and it's about to become even more expensive. How can anyone afford this? My guess is that most people can't. Does the gov know what this will do to families' bottom lines? Concerned,"

— r/HealthInsurance · 293 upvotes · None

Deductibles too high to use the plan

"Husband brings home \$5400 a month, health insurance costs \$1300...family of 4. What the hell. It was \$900 a month and I already felt like we were being stretched thin. I am a stay at home mom to two young children, daycare cost more than my paycheck, and I didn't have a career worth staying in. My husband and I both intend on picking up a side gig, probably DoorDash or something, just to get by. But how can we ever get ahead if health insurance keeps rising like crazy? My husbands job does offer health insurance but it's basically the same price with a higher deductible. The plan we are looking at on the Marketplace has a \$0 health deductible and a \$1500 drug deductible, with max OOP of \$19500 for my family. His health insurance as a \$6000 deductible per person, \$12000 for family and the max OOP is the same. So really the biggest question is do we want a lower deductible or lower max OOP, since the premiums are roughly the same...and we think we want the lower deductible. If 96K a year isn't enough for a family of 4 in Ohio now....then the middle class is fuckin dead."

— r/HealthInsurance · 664 upvotes · None

"Virginia ACA Rates Posted Today: Share Your Increase In Virginia and rates came up today. Self employed couple 59 & 61. This year our premium was \$1187/month. Same plan next year \$2,109/month. This is more than my mortgage payment and a \$922/month increase brings the total yearly cost to \$50,616. We will have to switch to a high deductible low quality Bronze plan with a \$7,500 deductible EACH with a monthly premium of \$1452/month. This is beyond belief. Continue contacting your elected officials people 🙄 "

— r/obamacare · 584 upvotes · None

"My new ACA premiums and deductible - considering just not having health insurance for a few years. So I had a life event last month that required me to get ACA. My monthly premium was \$485 and my deductible was \$7600. Just got an email saying my current health insurance will not be offered next year. Instead my new premium will be about \$560 and my deductible will be about \$11000. Also it seems many of my co-insurance will be higher by about \$70. And I'm not sure what else has changed for the worse. At this point I'm seriously considering not having health insurance for a few years. It seems cheaper to just plan a 3-week trip overseas and get better healthcare for much cheaper. You heard me - better! I just don't want to enable this defunct healthcare system anymore. If I'm in an accident I hope EMTALA saves my broke behind - in both senses of the phrase. I'll pay what I can then declare bankruptcy. If not life threatening, I'll take it overseas. A roundtrip ticket to India costs \$1500, \$1000 if you wait a month or so. That's less than three months premium. Over a year I can save up \$7000 in premiums. Saving up for one year buys me a full check up and a vacation trip. What do you think? Anyone considering the same thing? For those with kids - you have my sympathies."

— r/HealthInsurance · 574 upvotes · None

Owing money back at tax time

"Paying for ACA (Obamacare) We're about to go on ACA with no subsidies, it'll be about \$20k a year, \$1600 a month. [Healthcare.gov](<http://healthcare.gov/>) hands the billing off to the insurance carrier (e.g., Blue Cross, Oscar, United, Kaiser). Does anyone have experience using a credit card for full yearly prepayment, or split monthly payments (for example using multiple cards to split the monthly payment) with specific carriers?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 13 upvotes · None

"Need clarification on underestimating income I plan on enrolling my mother in law for 2026 but not sure how to approach her income. I had spoken to broker and I was informed she should show 22k before deductions to get tax credit for 2026. Before I was able to show her income as 2400 a year and get the aca credits. I read posts saying that the repayments of credits are for those who overestimate income not underestimate. Also read the other way around. If I were to sign her up saying her income projected is 22k but let's say at end of 2026 it's 3k. Since the income was underestimated will she need to payback the subsidies? she doesnt qualify for medicaid because she been in USA 2.5 years and you need to be living 5 years to qualify for that"

— r/obamacare · 5 upvotes · None

"Questions about how to file taxes with premium tax credits for a dependent? My taxes have always been super simple and straightforward. I work full time and have 2 kids, but I don't have employer health benefits and have had Medicaid for all 3 of us since my divorce. My 19 year old son was dropped from Medicaid coverage and I signed him up for an ACA policy through a broker who told me it wouldn't affect my taxes. My son is autistic and is a full time college student. He lives at home and I've always claimed him as a dependent. He doesn't have a job, but did have a little income from a summer internship. But since he has this policy does he have to file taxes? He didn't make enough money last year to meet the FPL for an individual and I didn't earn enough to meet the FPL for a family of 3. I think as far as the federal government is concerned he should still have Medicaid, but we live in a red state that didn't expand Medicaid, so there's no coverage for 18-24 year old students who don't have children. Do I file my taxes as usual with my children as dependents and then file taxes for him with his 1095-a and put that he can be claimed as a dependent? Do I not claim him as a dependent even though he is most definitely a dependent? He's the only one with an ACA policy and I do not know what I'm doing and I'm afraid since he didn't make enough money that he'll have to pay back thousands of dollars in subsidies. Thanks for any advice!"

— r/obamacare · 1 upvotes · None

Narrow networks and doctors who don't take the plan

"There is at least one major flaw in ACA. The idea behind ACA was to provide affordable access to healthcare. Unfortunately, it provides just affordable access to insurance, and that insurance is not accepted by many physicians. Seriously. I live in a major metro with a huge base of primary care physicians as well as specialists. And my experience has been that most doctors don't accept my ACA policy. I have to drive 45 minutes to get to my primary care physician, simply because he was the only doctor I could find who accepted my coverage. So when politicians pat themselves on the back for ACA, I submit that they haven't improved healthcare at all. They've just made it easy for us to find insurance."

— YouTube · Early Retirement Health Insurance Before Medicare: A Step-by-Step Framework · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=NAYG0yvzBI8&lc=Ugwov4rykJWpFucCV-B4AaABAq>

"Health insurance is HORRENDOUS this year. Its more dangerous than you stated, so listen up (and so far its not getting better next year): 1. The Cliffs of subsidies, oh the cliffs: Make too much (around 85k GROSS household) and you owe FULL amount of insurance (usually around 21-25k for two people. Thats 25%+ extra "tax" for health insurance!! on top of taxes!!!)... make too little and you owe the FULL amount too. As you know, self employment can be somewhat unpredictable so playing with the tiny financial window for subsidy assistance is nuts. One penny under you owe like 1200 for two for the year... one penny over? you owe 25k. make it make sense! WRITE YOUR REPS! We need at LEAST a Solo small biz option for better and more affordable group health insurance, and the subsidies NOT to have cliffs. 2) Most have access to some better group plans. Solo biz owners are not. We are expected to pay FULL employment taxes on our wages/earnings instead of just HALF if you work for the man, and we dont get access to more favorable group plans. This needs to stop as it is CUTTING to small biz working harder than most (or at least riskier). 3) Middle class is essentially subsidizing poor (ok) and ultra rich (not okay). The richer you get, the less overall cost burden you have. Don't believe me? Lets do the math for a second. if you make 100k as a couple, you'll pay around 22% as highest bracket. Then you also owe roughly 25k of health insurance. **So your overall cost burden for LOWER middle class is 47% of GROSS income.** If you make 25 million dollars a year, your highest tax bracket is around 37%... and your health insurance still costs about 25k. Same same. but that factors into being about .1%. **So ultra rich earners overall cost burden for health insurance we are basically forced to have is drumroll please. 37.1% . LOWER overall COST BURDEN THAN MIDDLE CLASS! at highest bracket. And The richer you get, the less overall cost burden in percent you have.** (Not even mentioning tax breaks and legit loopholes of course. what i said is enough) Sure you pay more dollars, but you pay LESS PERCENT of your income. 25k means very little to a person making 25 million, but it means a TON to the person making 85k. That is NOT fair. **I propose we change it with having everyone just pay a flat tax towards health care. 8%.** We can subsidize the truly poor but definitely not the ultra rich. Thats gotta end of we are essentially forced into the bad health care system we have... **the only thing not universal about our healthcare is that its not universally paid for - the middle class pay overwhelmingly more in cost percent burden than ANYONE else. Facts. WRITE YOUR REPS** 4) short term insurance fine prints: in networks, out of networks... you MUST read it. Agents overwhelmingly do not care or do not know. - or sell fraud insurance. When the rubber hits your road, you may not want an organ transplant cap of 10k, or a emergency airlift of 500 dollars. And you may not even qualify - almost any preexisting disqualifies you. Sure your agent can sign u up but they arent left picking up the pieces when things go wrong. (VERY LITTLE HEALTH AGENT ACCOUNTABILITY) Also once you get sick, you wont get renewed and youre forced back into ACA cesspool. TL:DR **Everyone in the middle class is getting very screwed around health insurance, but solo entrepreneurs are the canary in the coal mine.** We see it first hand how messed up it is, especially this year and next year. Some of us realize it early. The rest will cry at tax time (or when medical bills hit the fan). WRITE YOUR REPS! We need at LEAST 1) Solo small biz option for better and more affordable group health insurance, 2) subsidies NOT to have hard cliffs 3) Maybe most importantly long term reform: We need a fair flat rate where EVERYONE including bezos, pays a flat 8% (or something) of their income towards health insurance. **Right now, it's middle class paying 25% of their income while billionaires pay .00000001% of their income towards it** \- if they even buy our peasant insurance haha. **Effectively we all subsidize the ultra rich too, and have to play the health insurance hunger games.** Its INSANE."

— r/selfemployed · https://www.reddit.com/r/selfemployed/comments/1vk17ni/us_health_insurance_as_a_solo_small_business/p9z8x1m/

"I've gotten 400 calls and texts in a week. And thats for fake insurance. Not ACA Iowa. I've been unemployed to take care of my sick dad. I'm 59 I never thought I wouldn't be not not get a job I guess I won't get insurance and use Good RX for my meds. I'm literally crying and devastated. Ageism it real. The non ACA is still \$500 plus most of medication not covered. MY doctors wont accept non ACA ll the way. I don't trust non ACA. I'm gonna have a heart attack if i can't find a web site where I don't get 40 calls and texts. I've been on cobra \$1000 per month so burnt \$18k I'm healthy."

— YouTube · I Chose My 2026 ACA MARKETPLACE Health Insurance! It's NOT As BAD As I THOUGHT! · <http://www.youtube.com/watch?v=6wQf0o9gkMg&lc=UgzSolhmdmdGTu0UPvF4AaABAq>

Marketplace and Medicaid paperwork, verification, errors

"My broker Carlos R Hernandez. My broker Carlos R. Hernandez signed me up for Cigna health insurance. At least I thought he did. After months of waiting and multiple phone calls, I never received ID cards. I could not log into mycigna.com. I could not log into the Colorado marketplace at connectforhealthco.com. Turns out Carlos entered my information incorrectly. My zip code was wrong. My address was wrong. My email was wrong. After multiple phone calls to Cigna and the Colorado Marketplace, I was finally able to track down all of these errors. I told Carlos. He invited me to find another broker. That is the only good advice Carlos provided!"

— TrustPilot · HealthMarkets · 1★ · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/65bc12c06eb9707ce31b6ad1>

Reviews by Star

Oscar Health

- **Read** TrustPilot 1.4: can't find a PCP, formulary details hidden, back surgery denied as 'not medically necessary', wrong provider lists; five-star reviews single out a customer-care rep.
- **What should change** Provider lists that are accurate; formularies visible before purchase.

ambetterhealth.com

- **Read** TrustPilot 1.2: providers suddenly not covered, paper policy never mailed, the plan overriding the doctor; four- and five-star say it saved them after years uninsured (some at \$0.59 a month with subsidy).
- **What should change** In-network search that works; decisions that follow the doctor.

HealthCare.com

- **Read** TrustPilot 1.8: asked for prices online and got a phone call; calls every 30 minutes after leaving a number.
- **What should change** Show the price online; call once, with consent.

Why They Buy

1. Why they buy

Open enrollment, a job or Medicaid loss, early retirement, and the fear of a medical bill without coverage.

- Tab 1 · Getting sick and not being able to pay · 16 documents None

- “(I’m now 31) Without this insurance, I wouldn’t have been able to get diagnosed with ADHD, get help with my anxiety and depression, treat my Hypothyroidism and ” None
- Tab 6 · Managing income to keep the subsidy · 41 documents None
- “At 84k for a family of 4, I would pay 42% of my total income in premium payments” None

2. Recurring problems and frustrations

Premiums that doubled or tripled, deductibles too high to use, and the feeling the system is rigged.

- Tab 5 · Premiums that doubled or tripled · 26 documents None
- “This is not even mentioning how the new student loan rulings will add hundreds of dollars per month of financial burden, nor how I will forever be priced out of” None
- Tab 5 · Deductibles so high the plan is useless · 18 documents None
- “We will have to switch to a high deductible low quality Bronze plan with a \$7,500 deductible EACH with a monthly premium of \$1452/month.” None
- Dislikes · Premiums they can’t pay after the subsidy loss · 25 documents None

3. Questions and objections

Will I have to pay the subsidy back? What counts as income? Can I keep my doctor? Is this ad a scam?

- Silent layer · Paying the subsidy back at tax time: 35 autocomplete phrases, 54 title-relevant videos, 160,469 views, 8 own-voice documents <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=w8Xz4V0k-7A>
- Silent layer · Premiums they can’t pay (subsidy loss, doubling): 48 autocomplete phrases, 39 title-relevant videos, 320,593 views, 30 own-voice documents https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=lsxxWGpc_fE
- Silent layer · Plan switched or enrolled without consent: 0 autocomplete phrases, 24 title-relevant videos, 301,205 views, 4 own-voice documents https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=mt4pvvQq_VE

4. Hooks and formats in the market

Measured over 414 ads (108 video, 306 static): \$0 / low-cost coverage, question hooks, open-enrollment deadlines, named audiences (self-employed, families, lost coverage) and subsidy language.

- 177 ads · 70 advertisers use '\$0 / low-cost coverage', e.g. AVZ Benefit Solutions: “Need Affordable Health Insurance?” <https://www.facebook.com/ads/library/?id=3343879169233398>
- 177 ads · 70 advertisers use '\$0 / low-cost coverage', e.g. National Help Resources: “We can help you find an affordable health insurance plan.” <https://www.facebook.com/ads/library/?id=7110939302334879>
- 99 ads · 35 advertisers use 'Named audience (self-employed, families, lost coverage)', e.g. Free Health Care Quotes: “👉 State Approved Health Coverage for UNEMPLOYED Do you need health insurance for your family?” <https://www.facebook.com/ads/library/?id=1915090575559032>
- 99 ads · 35 advertisers use 'Named audience (self-employed, families, lost coverage)', e.g. tyspencer_bankerslifechi: “Health insurance can be confusing, but it doesn’t have to be.” <https://www.facebook.com/ads/library/?id=1668022260761702>

5. Features and benefits to demonstrate (hypotheses)

Their real price after the subsidy change — demonstrate it: a quote screen with the tax credit line. Consent — demonstrate it: the signed consent and the agent’s name before any enrollment. Network check — demonstrate it: their doctor found in the plan. Caveat: price reaction not measured.

- Tab 4 · 'Use a broker, it costs nothing' · 7 documents None
- "In my 14th call, they told me that - actually - I have no enrollment request, and that all of the previous agents were just attaching additional notes on the te" None
- Tab 4 · 'Watch your income' · 6 documents None
- "I went to HealthCare.gov, and as soon as I say I have no income, all they do is redirect me to sign up with State Medicaid?" None

Sources, Method & Gaps

One corpus and one voice router (hi_voice.py) for the three pages; every document carries exactly one voice.

Precision reads

- Voice router (hi_voice.py), hand-read of 15 random documents per voice after five rounds of rules: Medicare shopper 13/15, family helper 12/15, agent 12/15, life / final-expense agent 11/15, ACA shopper 12/15 (was 10/15 before the personal-detail rule), aspirant 9/15 before the last fix (licensing advice from working agents; rule tightened, not re-sampled).
- Agent-facing ads: the full list read by hand once (67 page overrides with a reason each), then a fresh random 30: audience 30/30 agent-facing, seller type 27/30 with the three misses pinned.
- Themes: frame and object in the same sentence; broad objects that counted any mention (a spouse, a phone, a video) were moved to framed themes after reading the capture lists; themes under five documents are dropped, not padded.
- Metrics tab: the page JS and the Python model agree on 252 priced fields across six input sets (0 mismatches).

What was not pulled, and why

- Facebook agent groups: the group feeds did not load for the research account (member-only groups, throttled feed pages), so only 17 publicly indexed posts were read with their comments (20 agent documents). A warmed account that joins the groups would add the largest missing agent source.
- Insurance-Forums.com: the first page of each thread only (up to ~10 posts), from the Senior Insurance, Health Insurance Exchange, Insurance Leads, Final Expense and Health Care Reform subforums.
- No count of independent agents selling Medicare or ACA was found in a citable source; the pages do not estimate one.
- TrustPilot pages were pulled per star level, so star counts are a reading sample; several vendors have no TrustPilot page (Inboundcore, Digital Senior Benefits, Integrity, Ritter, HealthSherpa). BBB was not pulled.
- Meta Ad Library: active US ads on quoted phrases only, no spend or impressions for US commercial ads; Meta's own policy page blocked the scripted fetch, so the special-ad-category rule is cited from PSM Brokerage and Data-Axle.
- Vince's feed: none yet (no agent-facing ads seen), so every advertiser comes from the Library search.
- Quora (403), LinkedIn (not logged in) and BiggerPockets were not read.

Tool status (D0)

- 2026-09-25: Tavily 968 of 1,000 monthly credits already used, so Facebook discovery went through web search restricted to facebook.com instead; Apify: three fresh accounts (\$5 each) used for consumer Reddit (harshmaur~reddit-scraper, calibrated at ~\$0.002 per record; ~\$12.40 spent in total including one duplicate

test run aborted at \$0.87); YouTube Data API: ~9,900 of 10,000 daily units; SerpAPI not used; research Chrome (CDP 18800) for Reddit agent subs, Facebook permalinks, TrustPilot and Insurance-Forums.com (relaunched once after a CDP timeout); Ad Library read headless and logged out.

Sources

- CMS CY2027 agent & broker compensation memo, June 1, 2026 (psmbrokerage.com copy)
- 42 CFR 422.2274 (eCFR) — compensation recovery / chargebacks
- KFF, Medicare Advantage in 2026: Enrollment Update
- CMS press release, 23.1 million enroll in 2026
- KFF, What we know about 2026 ACA marketplace enrollment
- Vendor and FMO benchmark pages: OneLife Marketing Solutions (2026 lead prices, Medicare benchmarks, channel benchmarks), SixtyFiveLeads, InsureLeads, AllCalls, Plura AI, Aged Lead Store, Quotely, Lead Distro AI, HyperTarget, Ritter, BenaVest, Pandora — flagged as vendor-sourced on the Metrics tab